

Professional Scrum PRODUCT OWNER

@ScrumDotOrg

[Trainer Name]– [Date] | [Location]

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Helping people and teams solve complex problems.

"If you haven't found it yet, keep looking. Don't settle. As with all matters of the heart, you'll know when you find it."

- Steve Jobs



1

Introductions

Why Are You in This Class?

- Introduce yourself
- Have you used Scrum before?
- Are you a Product Owner?
- Your professional background:
  - Development?
  - IT?
  - Other?



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Agenda

- Agile Product Management
- Value-Driven Development
- Scrum Theory & Empiricism
- The Scrum Framework
- Product Backlog Management
- Releases and Forecasting

With joyful exercises along the way!

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Exercise

It's Your Experience. Own it.

5 minutes

Develop guidelines for how to work together during this class.

How will the class deal with:

- Off-track discussions
- Lunch, break times, and signals
- Electronics such as phones, tablets, and laptops
- End of day timing

This course is collaborative.

Talk to me, talk to each other.

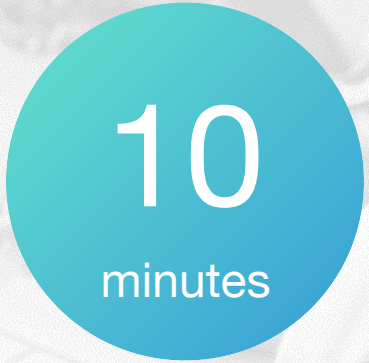


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Exercise

Team Start-Up



Make roughly even-sized, multi-disciplinary teams of 5 members or less.

Organize your working environment.

Post for all to see:

- The purpose of a Product Owner
- 3 things you want to learn in this class

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Professional Scrum Competencies

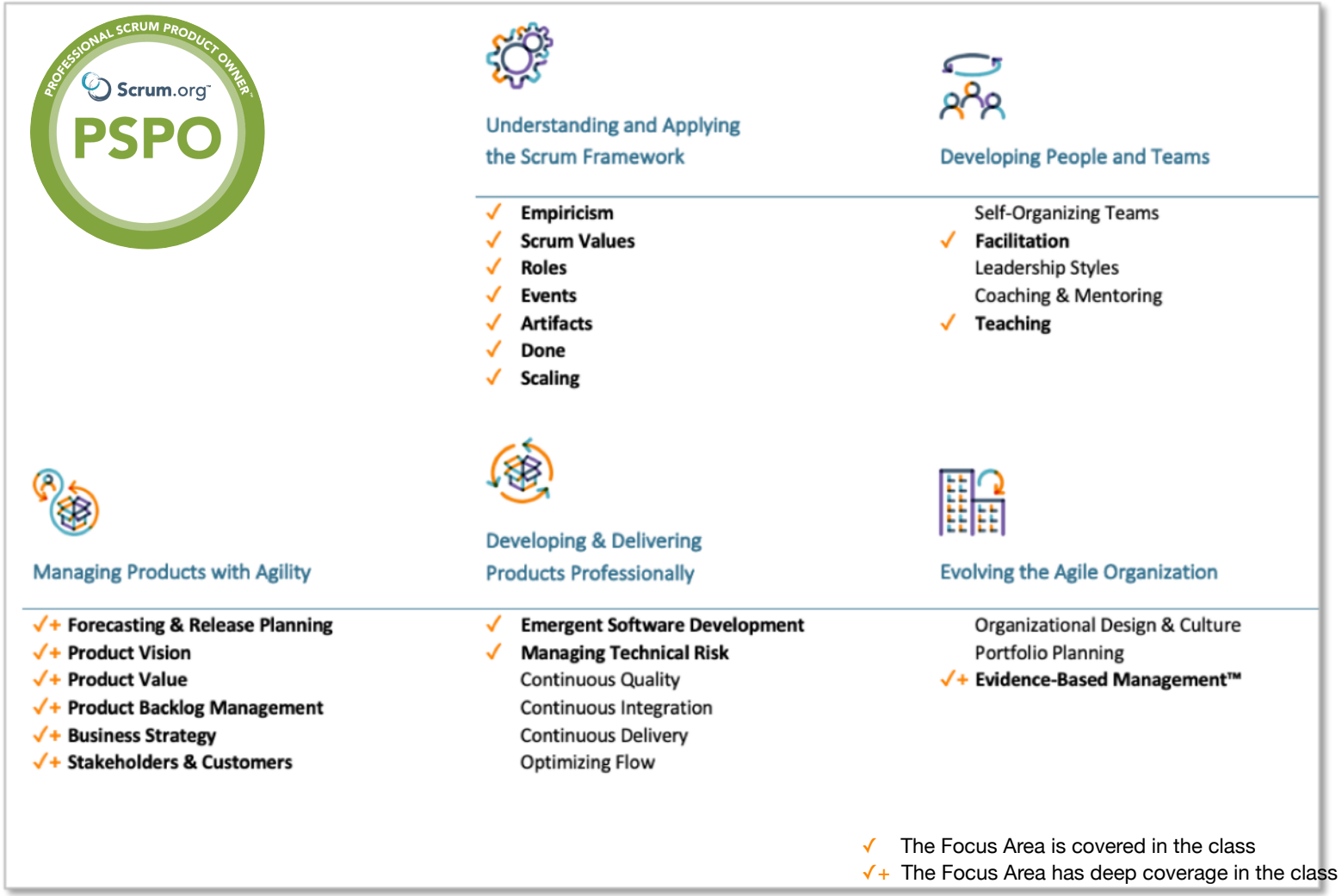
www.scrum.org/professional-scrum-competencies

The Professional Scrum Competencies help guide an individual's personal development with Scrum.

Benefit from a common understanding of the competencies and focus areas to evaluate and balance your team's proficiencies based on your unique needs.

See how all Scrum.org courses map to the competencies and focus areas by visiting:

www.scrum.org/courses/professional-scrum-training-competency-mapping



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Professional Scrum Product Owner Course

PURPOSE

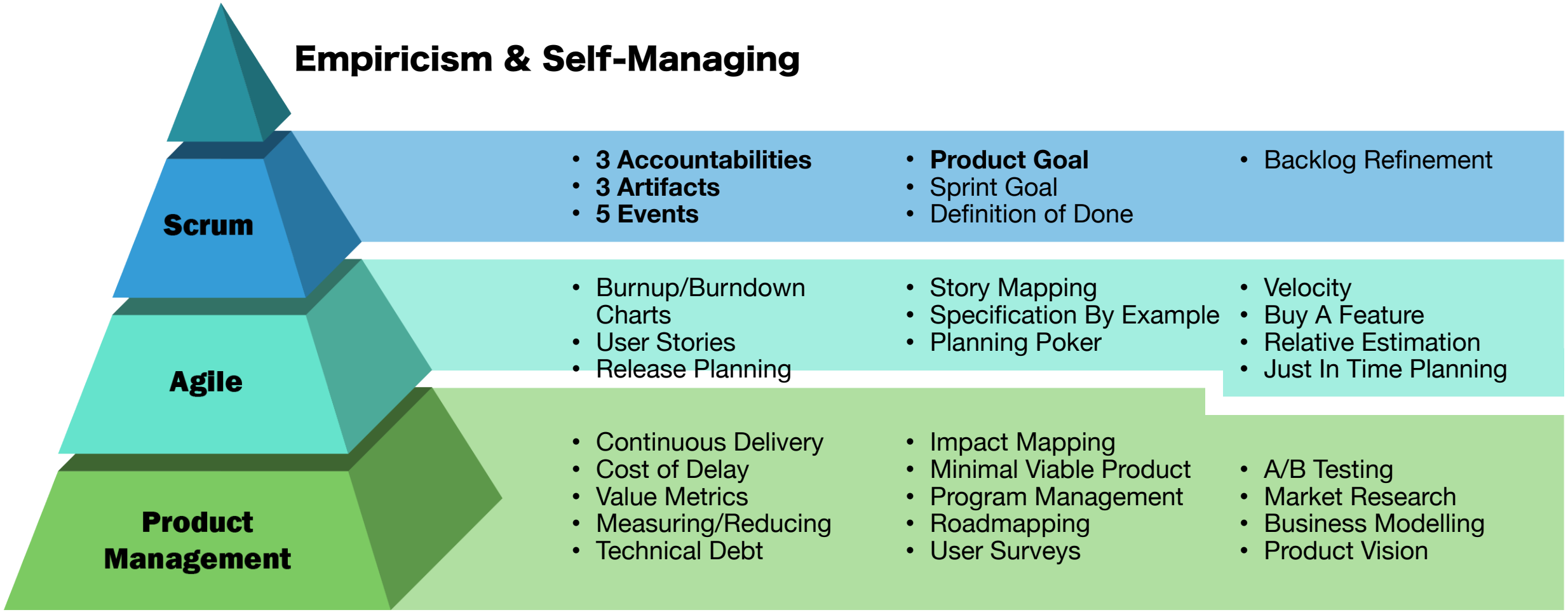
- Teaches how to wring more value out of a product using agile product development with the Scrum framework.
- Understand the application of Scrum theory and principles to improve product management.

AUDIENCE

- For those responsible for the success of a software product or service by optimizing its value.
- *Ideally, attendees have passed the Scrum Open and the Product Owner Open assessments.*

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Scrum Is Complemented by Many Practices



… and many, many more.

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“Someone’s sitting in the shade today because someone planted a tree a long time ago.”

- Warren Buffett



2

Agile Product Management

Thoughts on These Companies?







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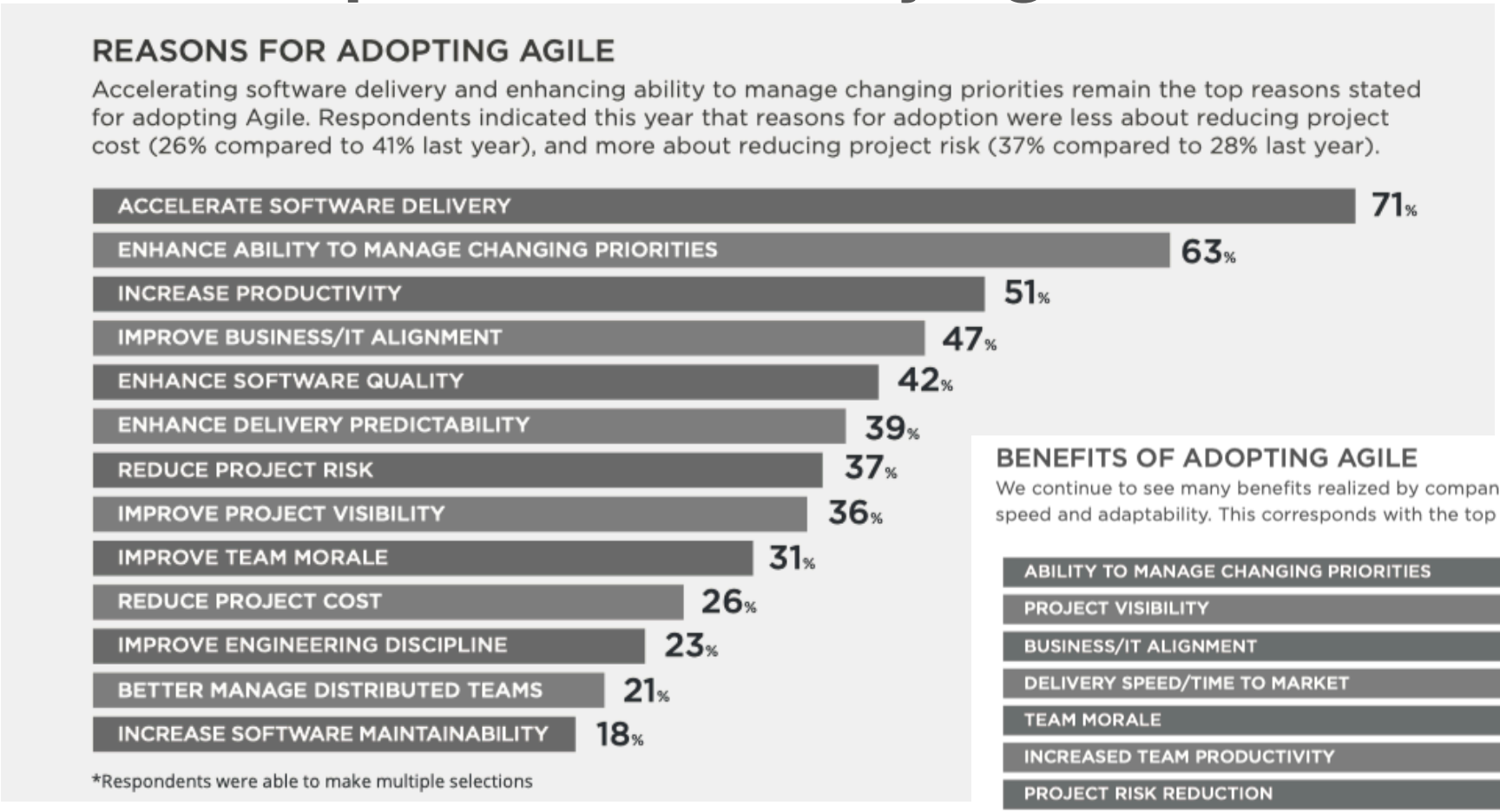
Purpose Helps in Pursuing Agility

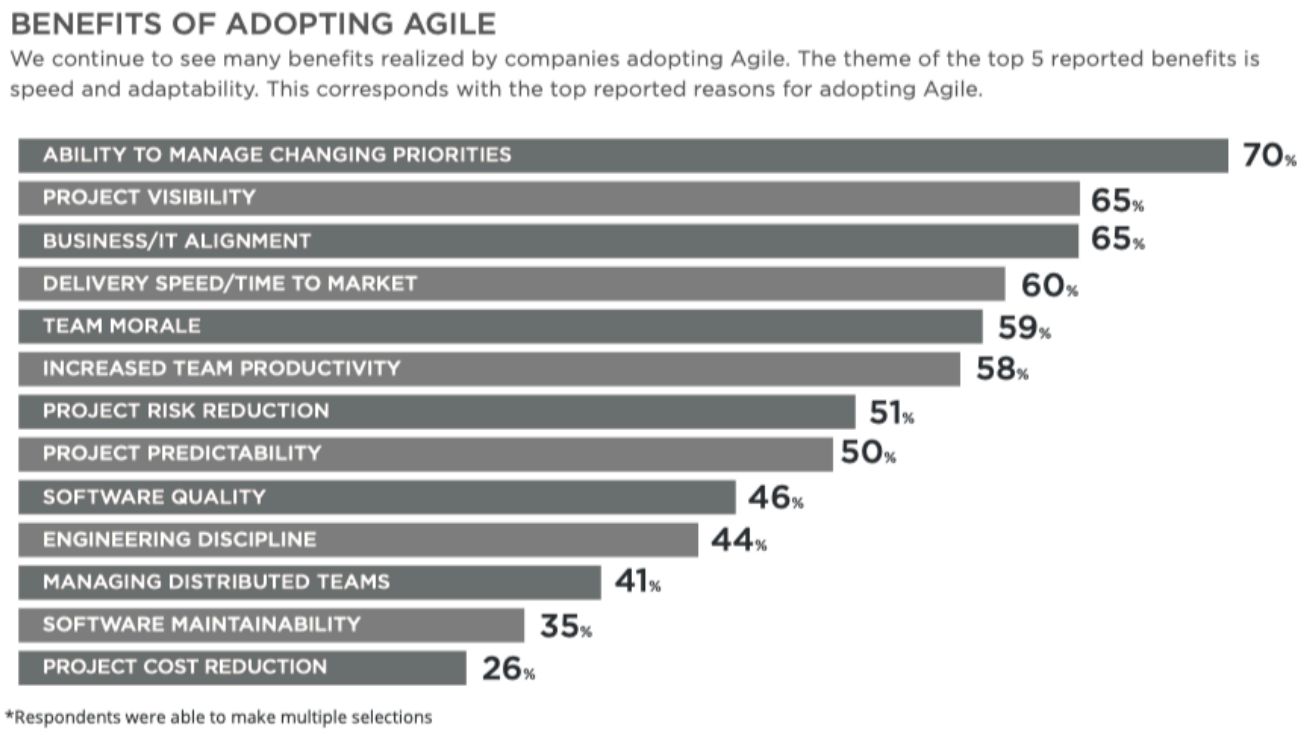
2 minutes

As a product owner, what are you trying to achieve with agile?

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What are practitioners saying?





”14th Annual State of Agile Report” - Digital.ai - 2020

Product Owners Have a Product Mindset

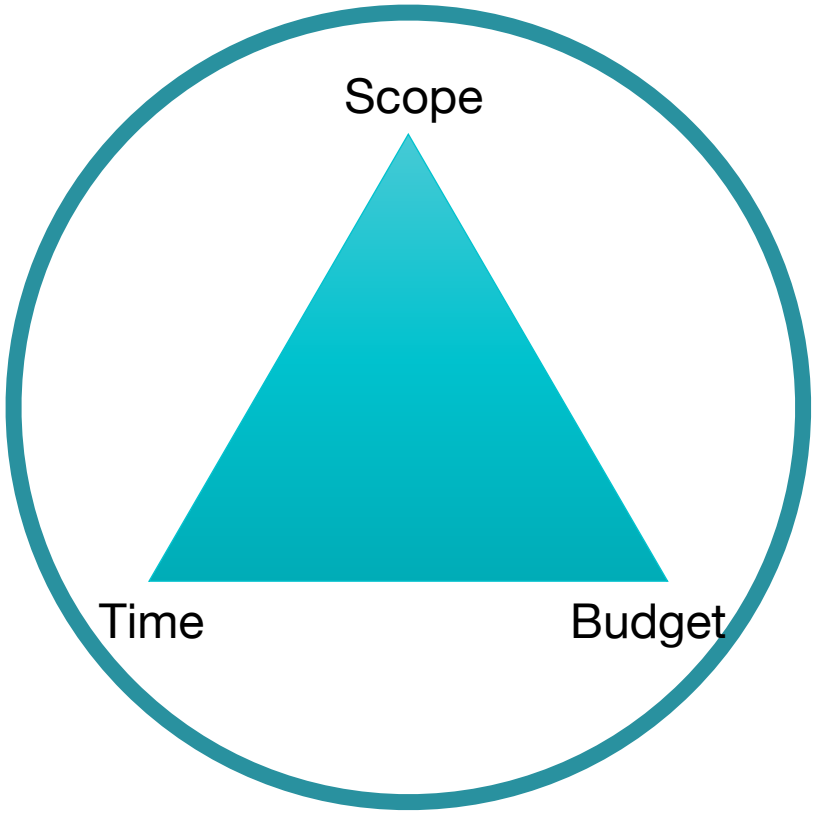
Product Mindset

Driven by outcome

Success *continuously* driven by *business metrics* outside in:

- User adoption/retention
- Revenue
- Cost savings per feature

Leads to less waste, more creativity, and more releases.



Project Mindset

Driven by output

Success *upfront* defined inside out:

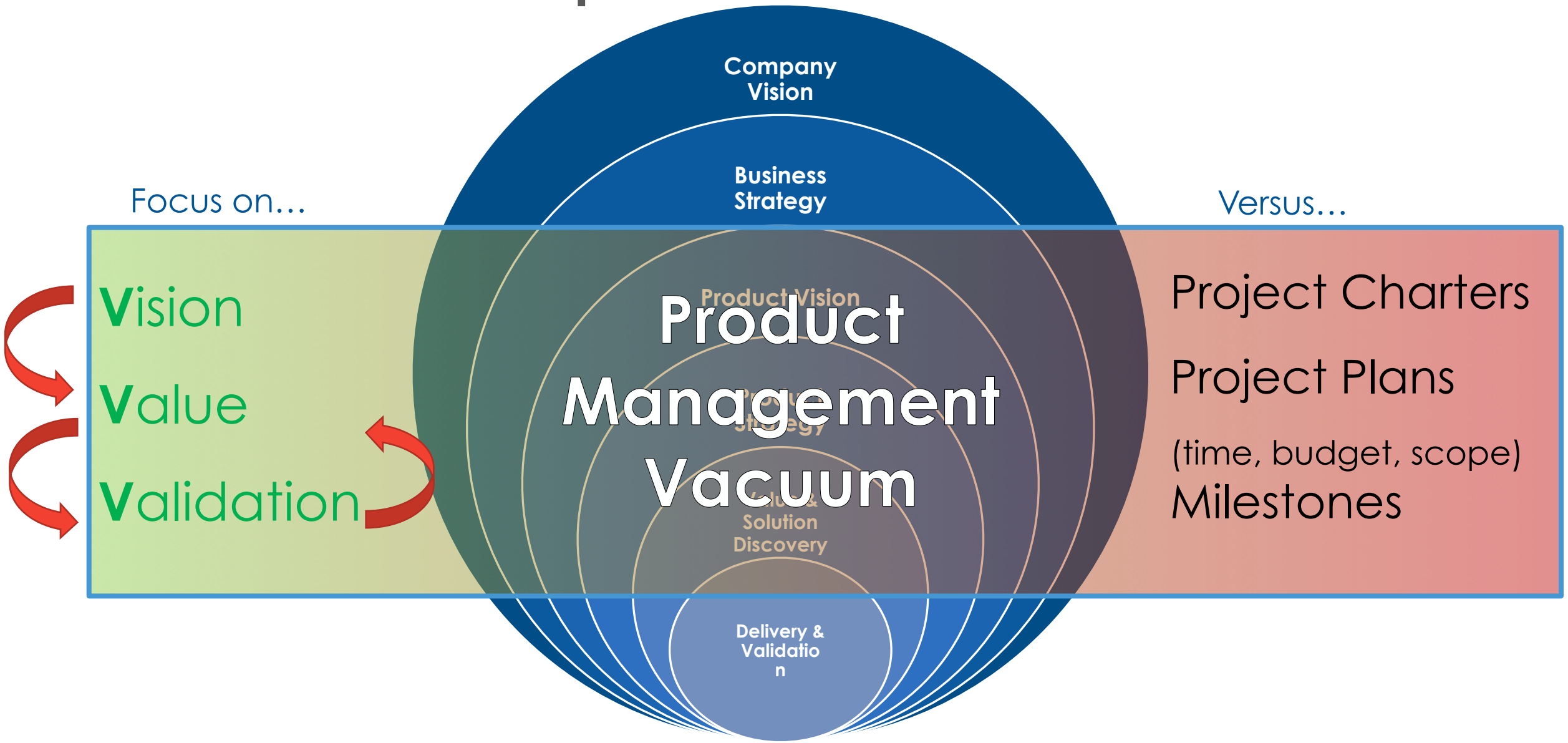
- Scope
- Time
- Budget

Leads to less business involvement, more task management.

On time, within scope, and within budget doesn't automatically equal product success

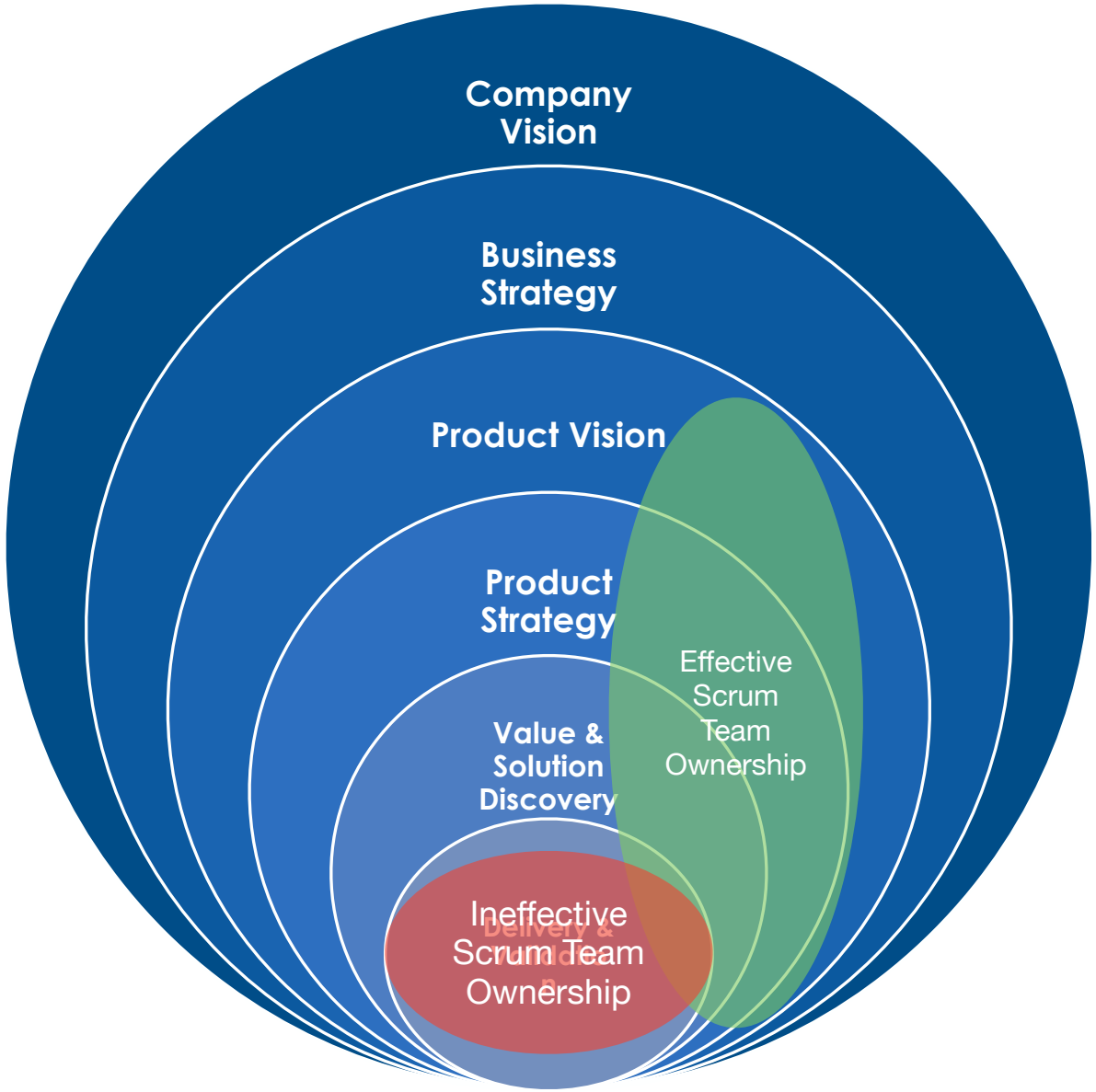
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A Product Mindset requires a different focus



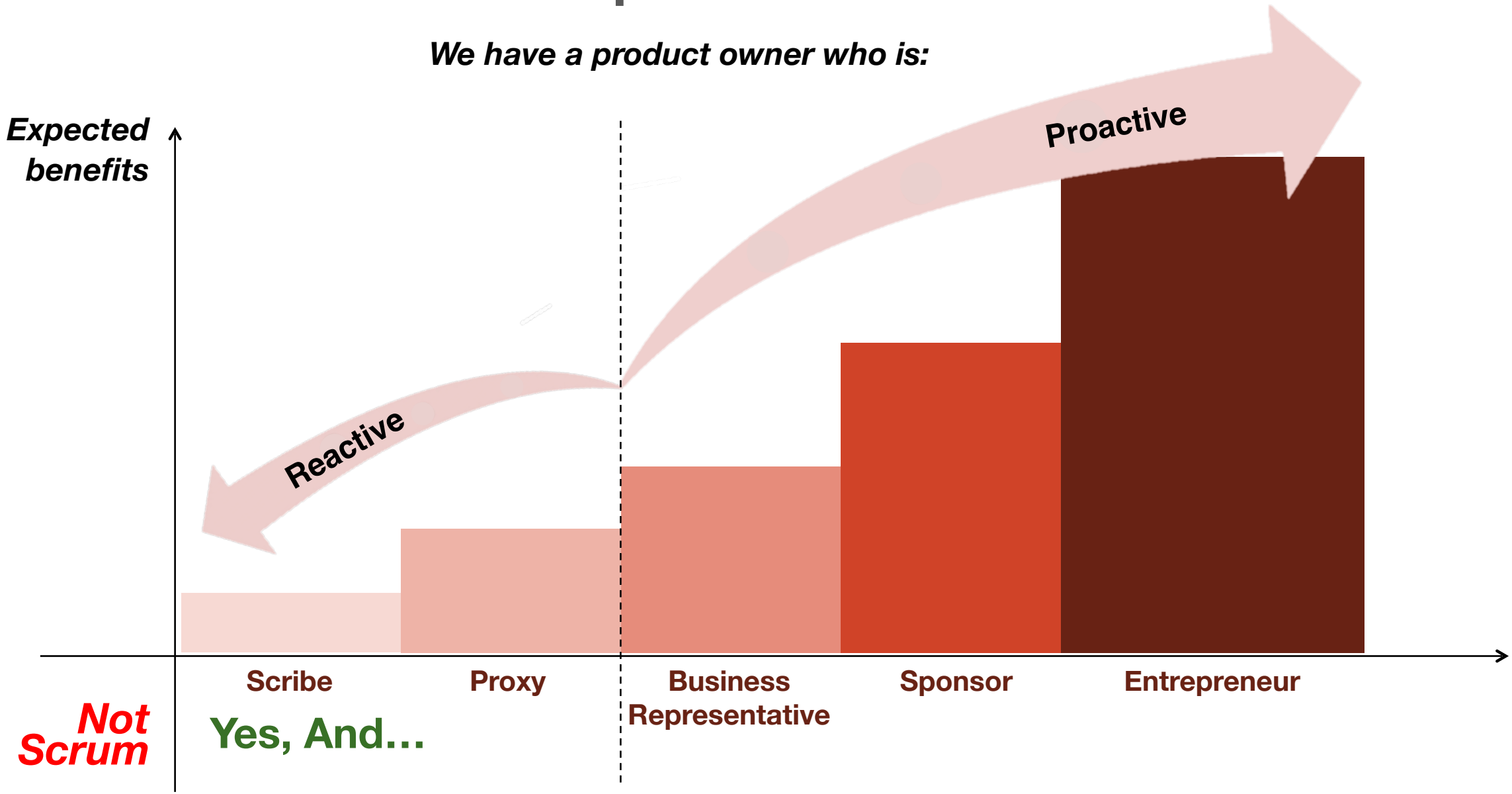
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Product Development is a Strategic & Tactical Team Engagement



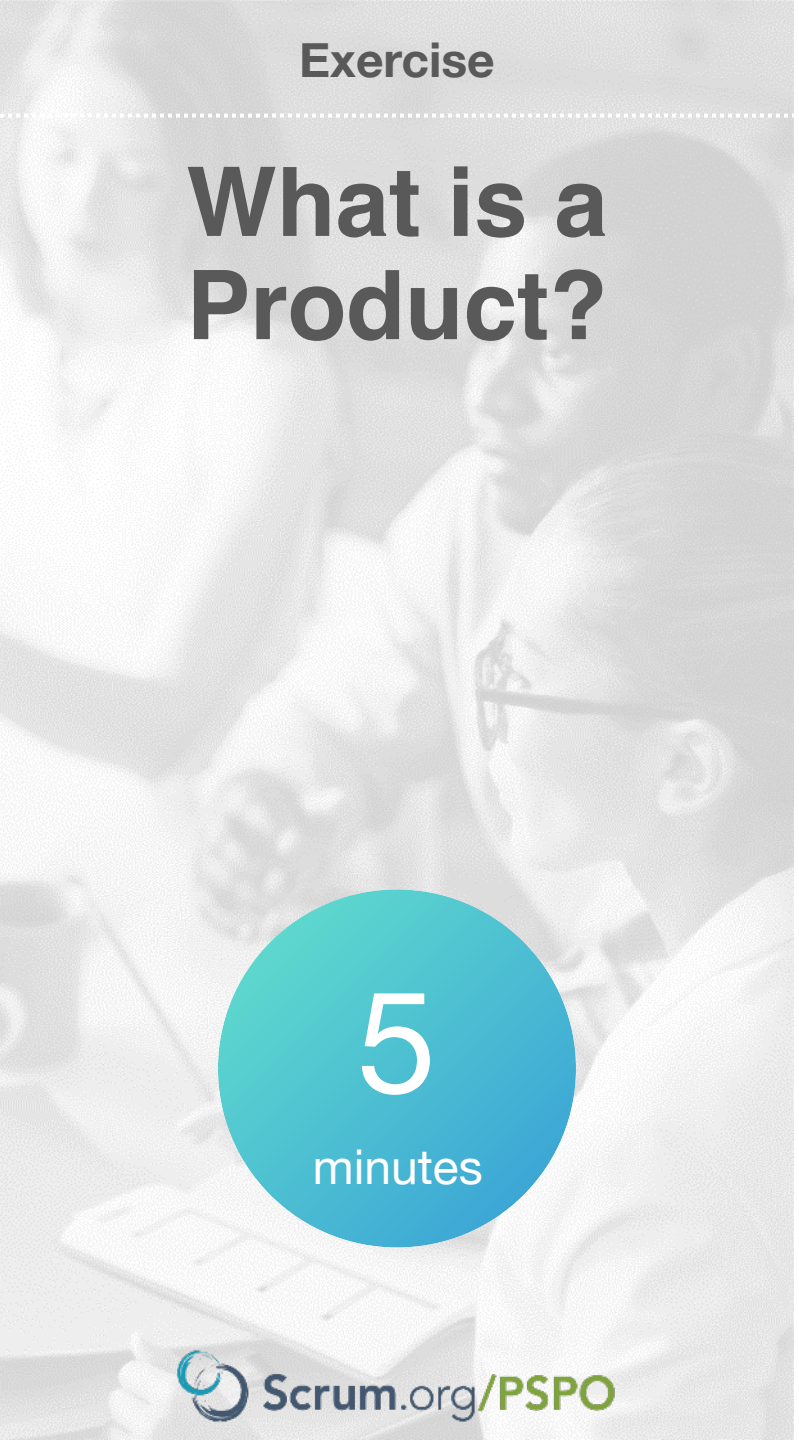
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More Product ‘Ownership’ Leads to More Effectiveness



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What is a Product?



5 minutes

Come up with a definition for a product

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There Is Always a Product

There is always a product.

- It may not always be obvious, but it is there, and it needs to be identified.

Every product has a customer who is a:

- ***User***: Anyone who gets value from your product, whether or not they pay for it
- ***Buyer***: Anyone who pays for your product, whether or not they use it
- ***Both***

Every product has a producer who receives a core benefit through:

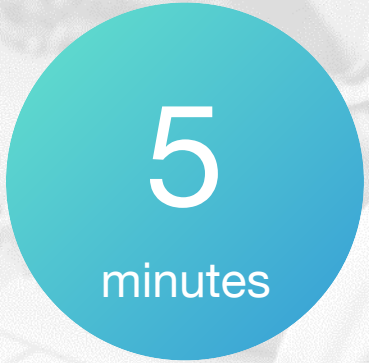
- Revenue increase
- Cost decrease or avoidance
- Societal benefit



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Exercise

Product Management Activities



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Come up with a list of activities that are (should be) part of Product **Management**.

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Product Management Encapsulates Many Things

Analyzing the Industry & Competition

Product Strategy

Maximizing Revenues & ROI

Release Planning

Identifying Customers & Their Needs

Forecasting & Feasibility

Creating the Business Case

WHICH ARE EXPLICITLY PART OF SCRUM?

Strategic Product Planning

Identifying Product Requirements

Creating a Roadmap

Release Execution

Auditing Results

Sustaining the Product

Product Launch

Customer Retention

Naming & Branding

Outbound Messaging

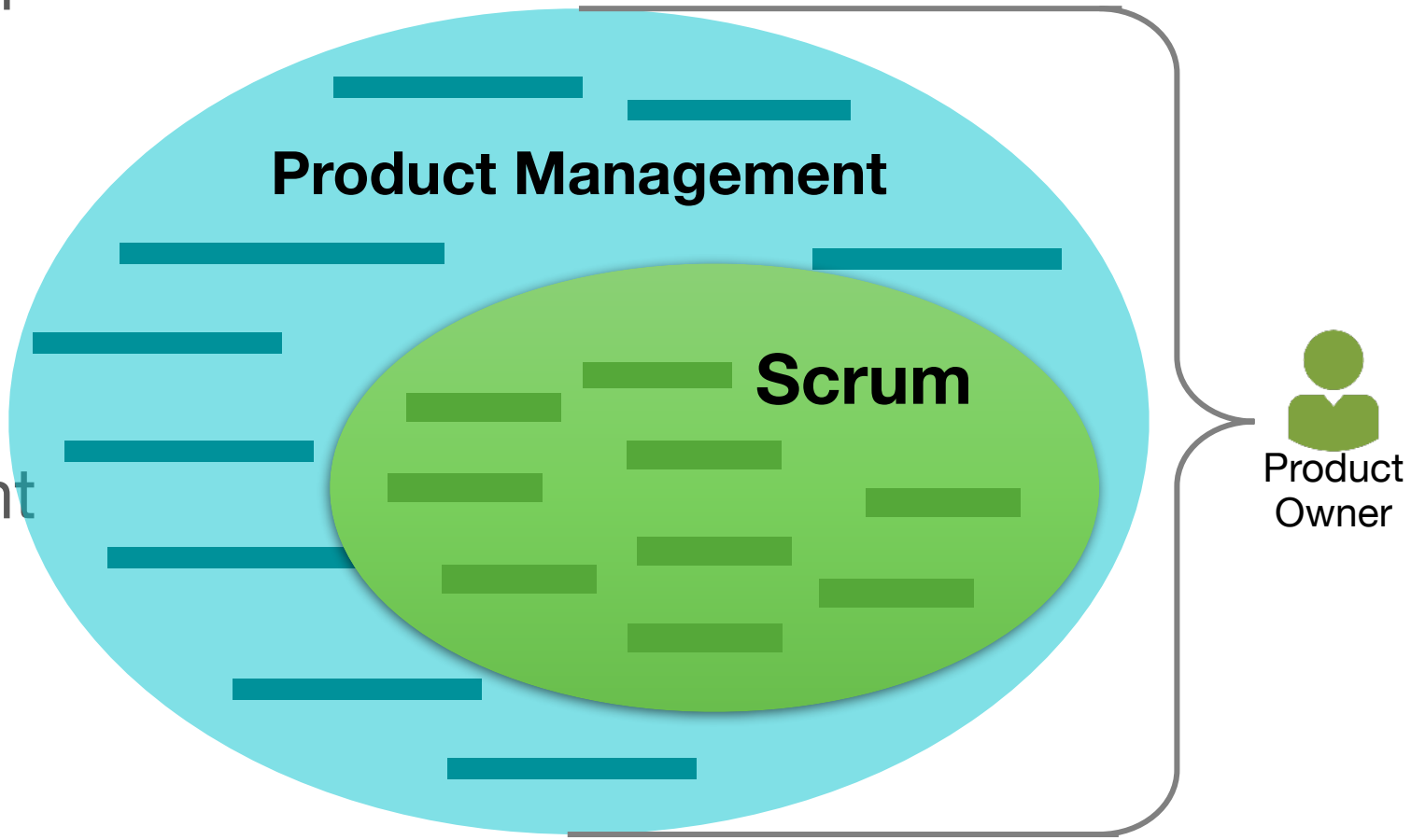
Defining Product Features

Product Retirement

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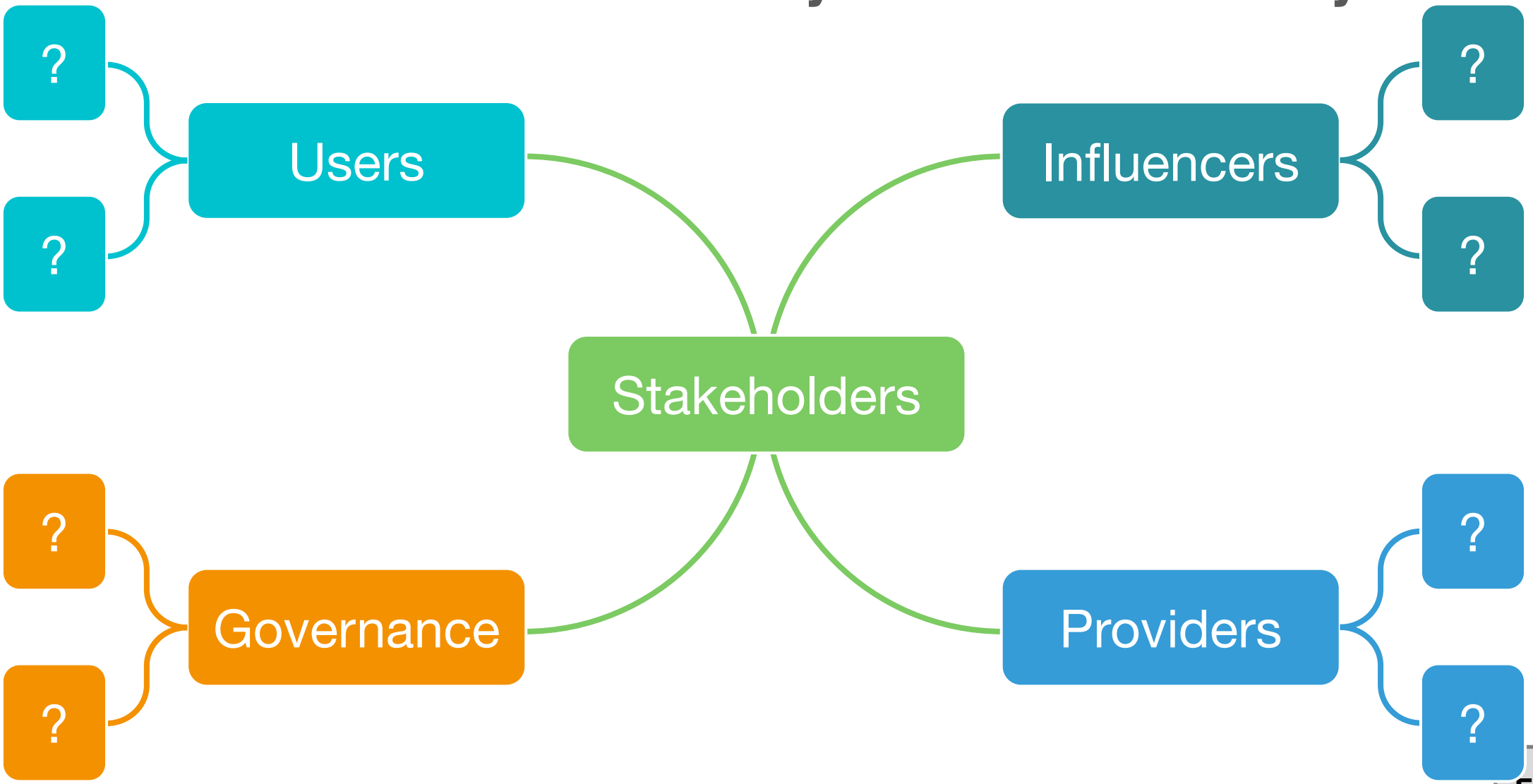
Effective Product Owner Focuses on Product Management

- Approaches the product with a holistic product management mindset
- Creates shared understanding with ***vision***, ***product goal*** and ***value***
- Leverages Scrum for frequent product ***validation*** through inspection & adaptation



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Stakeholders – Who Are They and What Do They Want?



For more o
this topic

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Techniques For Creating A Product Business Model



Business Model Canvas

A strategic management template for developing and adapting business models

Lean Canvas

A business modeling tool created to help deconstruct a new idea into its key and most risky assumptions

Value Proposition Canvas

A framework which can help ensure that a product or service is positioned around what the customer values and needs

Have you used any others?

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Business Model Canvas

KEY PARTNERS

- Who are our partners?
- Who are our key suppliers?
- Which key resources are we acquiring from our partners?
- Which key activities do partners perform?

MOTIVATION FOR PARTNERSHIP

Optimization and economy
Reduction of risk and uncertainty
Acquisition of particular resources and activities

8

KEY ACTIVITIES

- What key activities do our value propositions require?
- Our distribution channels?
- Customer relationships?
- Revenue streams?

CATEGORIES 7

Production
Problem Solving
Platform/Network

KEY RESOURCES

- What key resources do our value propositions require?
- Our distribution channels?
- Customer relationships?
- Revenue streams?

6

TYPES OF RESOURCES

Physical
Intellectual (brand, patents, copyrights, data)
Human
Financial

VALUE PROPOSITIONS

- What value do we deliver to the customer?
- Which one of our customers' problems are we helping to solve?
- What bundles of products and services are we offering to each segment?
- Which customer needs are we satisfying?
- What is the minimum viable product?

CATEGORIES 2

Newness
Performance
Customization
"Getting the Job Done"
Design
Brand/Status
Price
Cost Reduction
Risk Reduction
Accessibility
Convenience/Usability

CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS

- How do we get, keep, and grow customers?
- Which customer relationships have we established?
- How are they integrated with the rest of our business model?
- How costly are they?

EXAMPLES 4

Personal assistance
Dedicated Personal Assistance
Self-Service
Automated Services
Communities
Co-Creation

CHANNELS

- Through which channels do our customer segments want to be reached?
- How do other companies reach them now?
- Which ones work best?
- Which ones are most cost-efficient?
- How are we integrating them with customer routines?

3

CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

- For whom are we creating value?
- Who are our most important customers?
- What are the customer archetypes?

Mass Market 1
Niche Market
Segmented
Diversified
Multi-sided Platform

CHANNEL PHASES

*1. **Awareness** - How do we raise awareness about our company's product and services?*
*2. **Valuation** - How do we help customers evaluate our organization's Value Proposition?*
*3. **Purchase** - How do we allow customers to purchase specific products and services?*
*4. **Delivery** - How do we deliver a Value Proposition to customers?*
*5. **After Sales** - How do we provide post-purchase customer support?*

COST STRUCTURE

- What are the most important costs inherent to our business model?
- Which key resources are most expensive?
- Which key activities are most expensive?

9

SAMPLE CHARACERISTICS

Fixed Costs (salaries, rents, utilities)
Variable Costs
Economics of Scale
Economics of Scope

IS YOUR BUSINESS MORE

Cost driven (leanest cost structure, low price value proposition, maximum automation, extensive outsourcing)
Value Driven (focused on value creation, premium value proposition)

REVENUE STREAMS

- For what value are our customers really willing to pay?
- For what do they currently pay?
- How are they currently paying?
- How would they prefer to pay?
- How much does each Revenue Stream contribute to overall revenues?

TYPES

Asset sale
Usage fee
Subscription fees
Lending/Renting/Leasing
Licensing
Brokerage fees
Advertising

FIXED PRICING 5

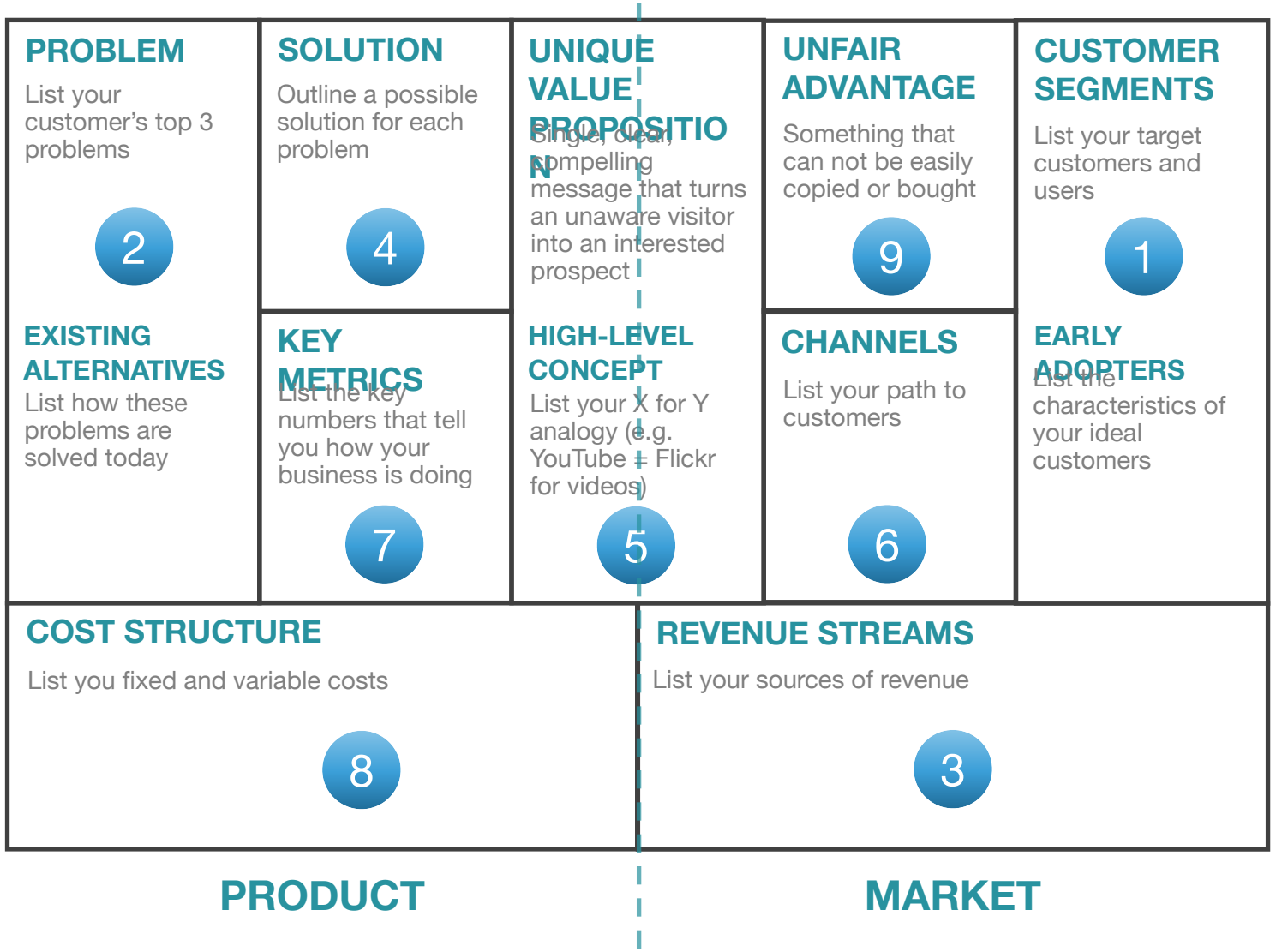
List Price
Product feature dependent
Customer Segment dependent
Volume dependent

DYNAMIC PRICING

Negotiation (bargaining)
Yield Management
Real-time-Market

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Lean Canvas



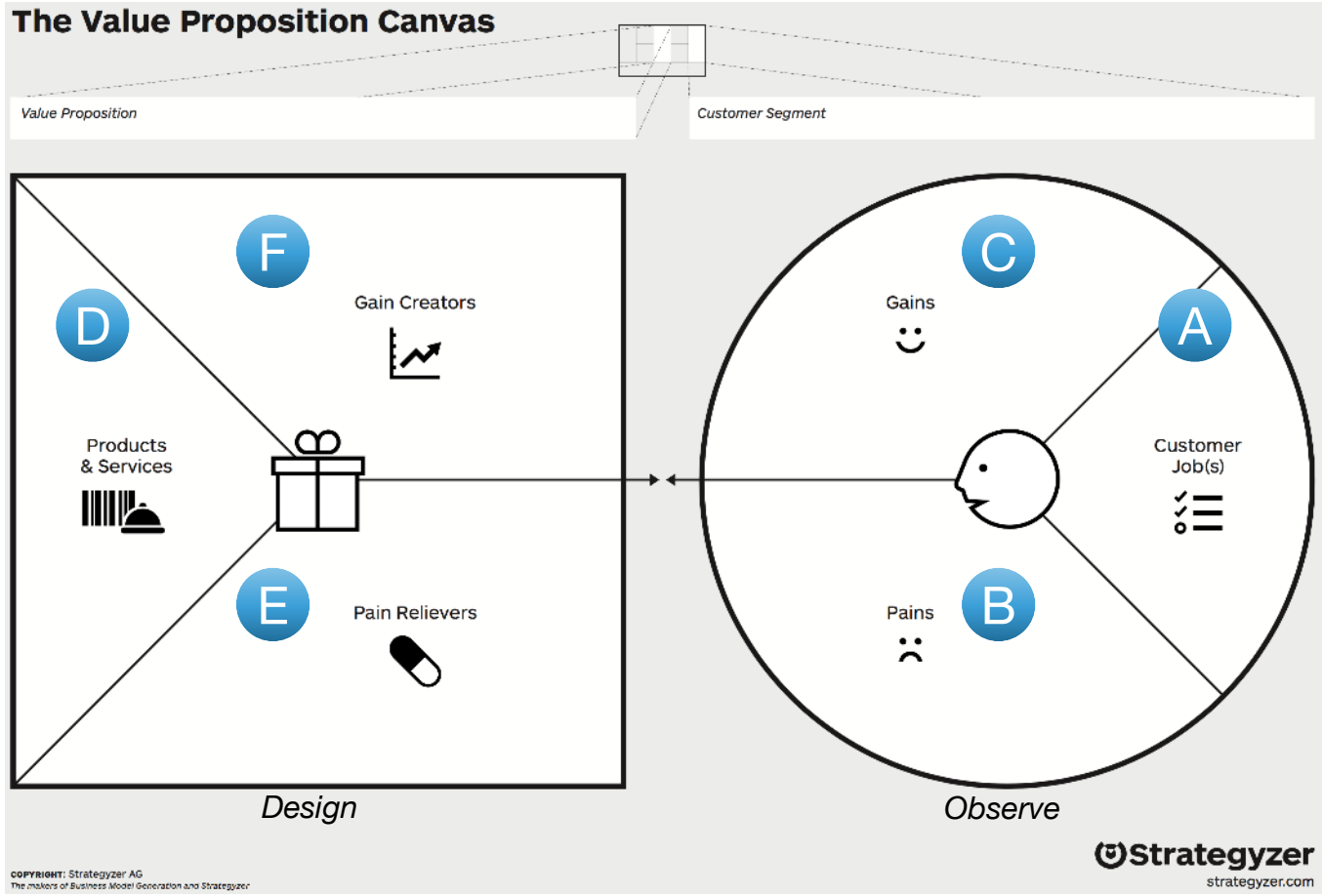
leanstack.com

1. Identify and describe main customer/buyer
   Who are the early adopters?
2. List top 1 to 3 problems
   What are the existing alternatives?
   How do they solve the problems today?
3. Come up with revenue stream but keep it simple
   What is the product worth to your clients?
4. List solutions for each problem
   How will you deliver value?
5. Create your UVP, the underlying 'Why'
   How will you get noticed?
6. Identify a couple of possible channels
   How will you build a path to customers?
7. Identify key value metrics
   How will you measure success?
8. Identify your costs and break-even point
   How will you afford your initiative?
9. Something that cannot easily be copied or bought
   How will you defend against competition?

Lean Canvas is adapted from The Business Model Canvas (http://www.businessmodelgeneration.com) and is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution-Share Alike 3.0 Un-ported License

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Value Proposition Canvas



D Product & Services:

- Which specific products or services can we create to help this customer get their jobs (tasks) done?
- We do not need to fix it all, decide on one or two jobs that are the most important to address first.
- Is the customer the buyer, user or maybe a co-creator?

E Pain Relievers:

- Make your customer feel better?
- Produce Savings?
- Fix underperforming solutions?
- Eliminate risks your customers fear?

F Gain Creators:

- Produce outcomes your customer expects or even exceeds?
- Create saving which makes your customer happy?
- Make your customer's job life easier?
- Do something customers look for?

A Customer Job(s):

- What functional jobs are you helping your customer get done?
- What social jobs are you helping your customers get done?
- What emotional jobs are you helping your customer get done?
- What basic needs are you helping your customer satisfy?

B Pains:

- What makes your customer feel bad?
- What does your customer find too costly?
- How are current solutions underperforming for your customer?
- What are the main difficulties and challenges your customer encounter?

C Gains:

- What outcomes does your customer expect and what would go beyond his/her expectation?
- Which savings would make your customer happy?
- How do current solutions delight your customer?
- What could make your customer's job or life easier?

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Business Strategy

15 minutes

Explore a Business Strategy for your product.

Important topics to consider:

- **Customer Needs**
- **Who Benefits**
- **How**
- **Revenue**

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Techniques For Creating A Product Vision



Product/Vision Box

A collaboration tool for identifying the most important features and a vision for a product

Elevator Pitch Template

A popular template to help organize thoughts about the vision

Have you used any others?

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Innovation Games® Product Box

Front

- Product Name
- Image(s)
- Clear Target Customer
- Clear Value Proposition

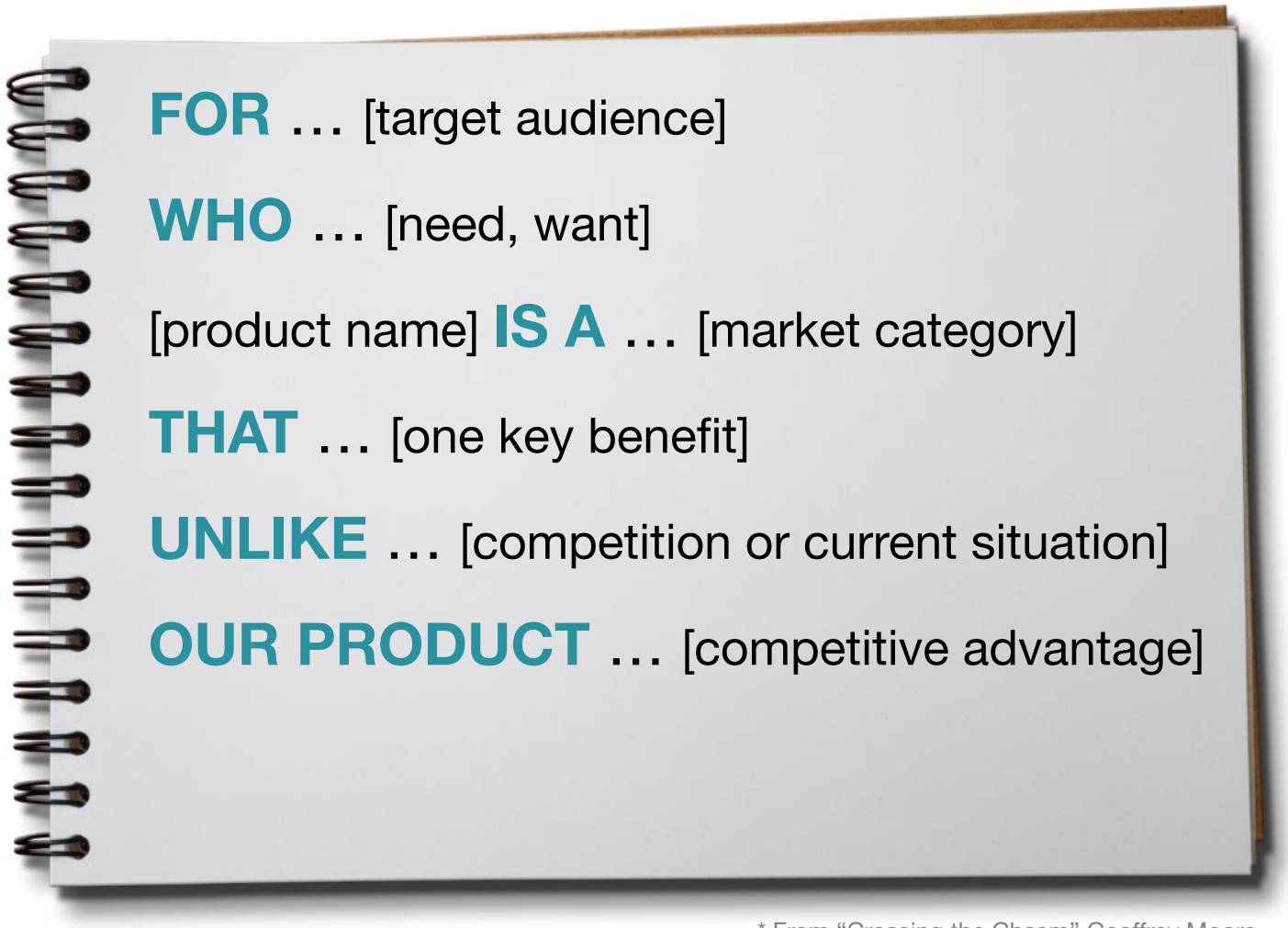
Back

- Sub-features



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Product Vision Template



* From “Crossing the Chasm” Geoffrey Moore

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Class Project

Product Vision



15 minutes

Craft a Vision for your product:

1. **Select a technique**
2. **Collaborate on a vision for your product**
3. **Prepare to pitch your product to the class**

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Exercise

Product Owner and Technology

5 minutes

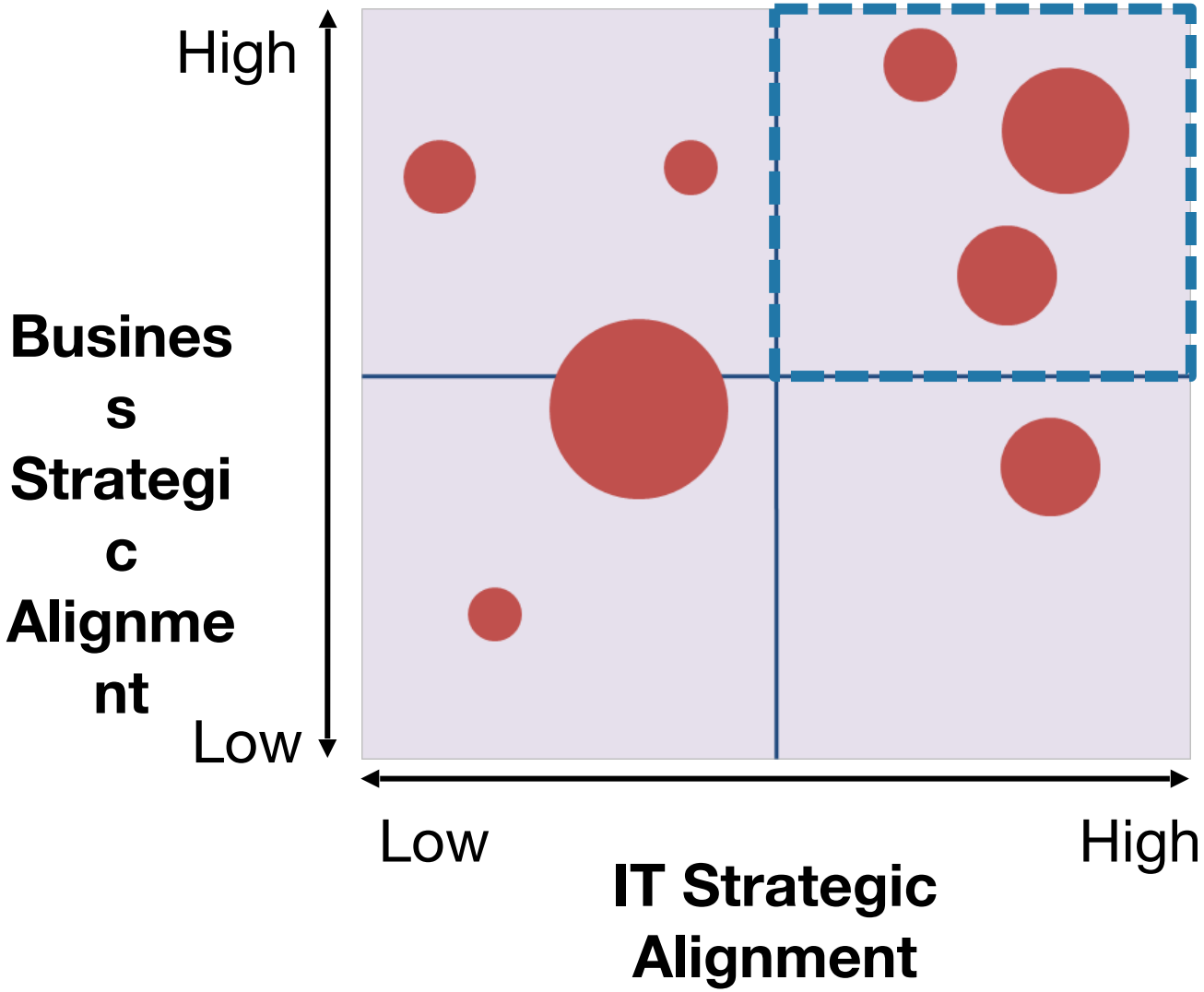
Should a Product Owner be technical?

PROS	CONS

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Strategic Alignment Index



Highest benefits are most likely realized when building these products or features

Size of bubble = TCO

Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) and value are variables used in development prioritization.

Source: “Measuring the Business Value of Information Technology” , Intel Press

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Discontinuing Products Is Not What Kills You

Discontinuing a product is a healthy business decision (unless you rely on too few products)

- Apple Newton
- Apple iPod classic
- Google Glass
- Google Wave
- Google+
- iGoogle
- Google Reader
- Amazon Fire



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Great CEO Leverage Technology for Business Agility

"Technology skills do not necessarily mean hands-on skills, though they can arise from hands-on experience. It means simply understanding the technical state of play in the environment in a way that you can make exceptional decisions."

"Technology changes suddenly expand the strategy canvas and offer new ways of doing old things, or entirely new things to do."

Great CEOs Must Be Either Technical or Financial – Forbes Article
http://www.forbes.com/sites/venkateshrao/2012/03/09/great-ceos-must-be-either-technical-or-financial/

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What About These Product Managers?











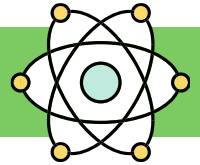
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Agile Product Management Recommendations



TRY

- Try involving the whole Scrum Team early with value and validation
- Start learning and experimenting with early adopters
- Using the canvases to focus on customers needs, problems, or desires



FAVOR

- Making your business model assumptions explicit
- Seeing validation as ongoing – even after product delivery
- When defining product as components or suites, aligning toward consistent end user value



AVOID

- Building products without validating your most risky assumptions early on
- Building the canvases without team and stakeholder involvement
- Defining products around organizational structures

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TAKE AWAY

Agile Product Management

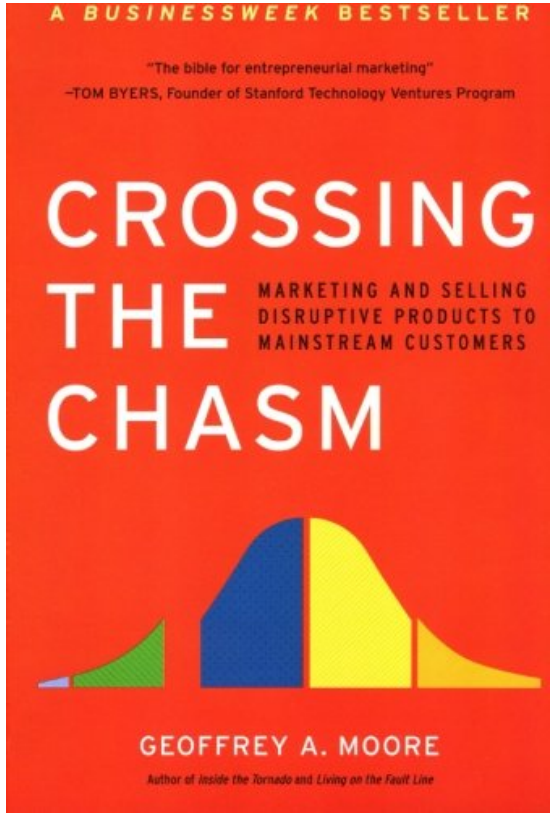
- Agility can be a competitive advantage for an organization.
- Product Management is an essential practice for Scrum Product Owners.
- Organizations should take on more of a Product Mindset over a Project Mindset.
- There are advantages to having a technical Product Owner in this Digital Age.
- Foundations of Product Management are an inspiring Product Vision, Strategy and entrepreneurial Mind-Set.



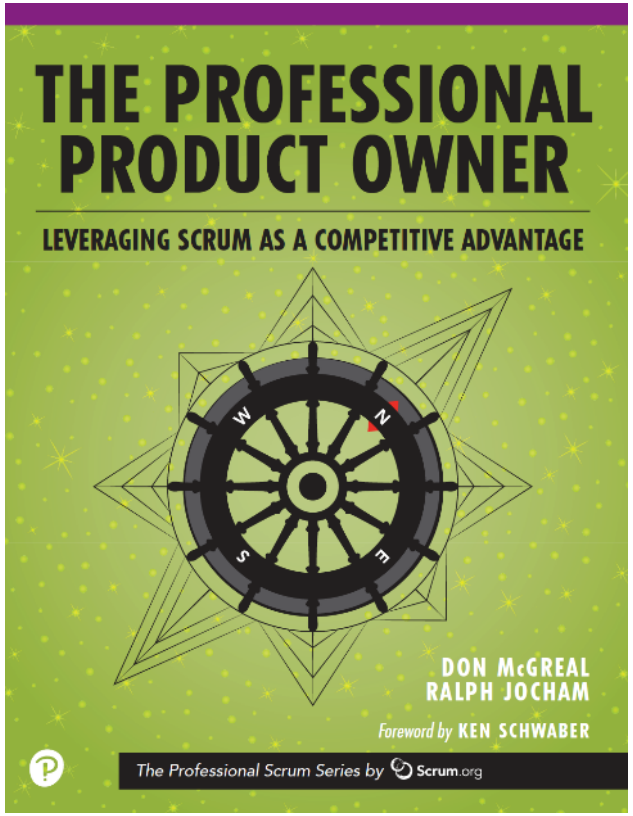
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Suggested Reading

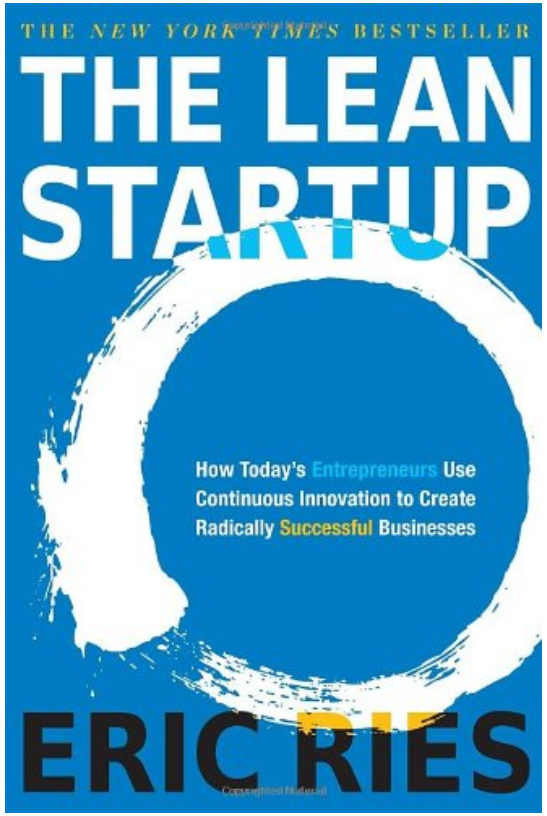
“Crossing the Chasm” (Geoffrey Moore)



“The Professional Product Owner” (Don McGreal & Ralph Jocham)



“The Lean Startup” (Eric Ries)



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“Price is what you pay. Value is what you get.”

- Warren Buffett



3

Value-Driven Development

Exercise

Value



3

minutes

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What is value?

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For organizations, value is…

The benefit to the customer, represented in terms of **happiness**, that results from the use of a product or service.

The benefit to the organization, represented in **money** terms, that results from the use of a product or service.

The **benefit to society**, not necessarily represented in money terms, that results from the use of a product or service.

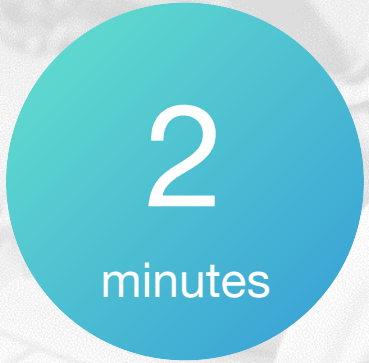
Favor **Value Creation** over Revenue Extraction

For more on this topic



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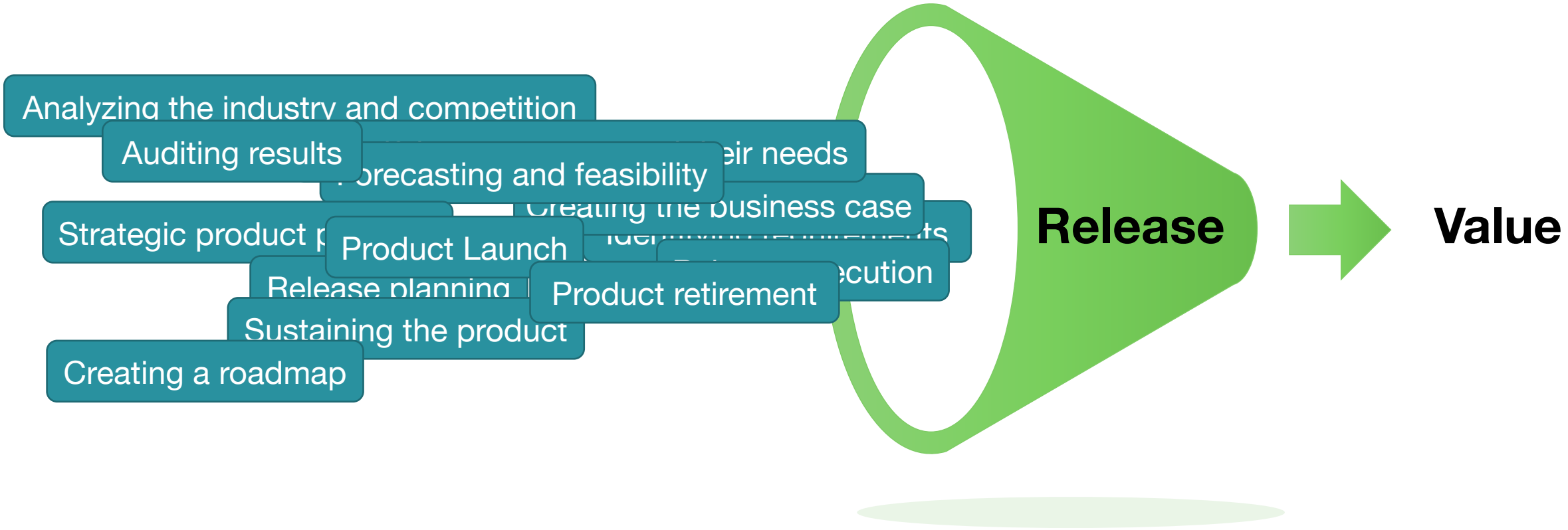
Delivering Value



What is the only way for a Scrum Team to deliver value?

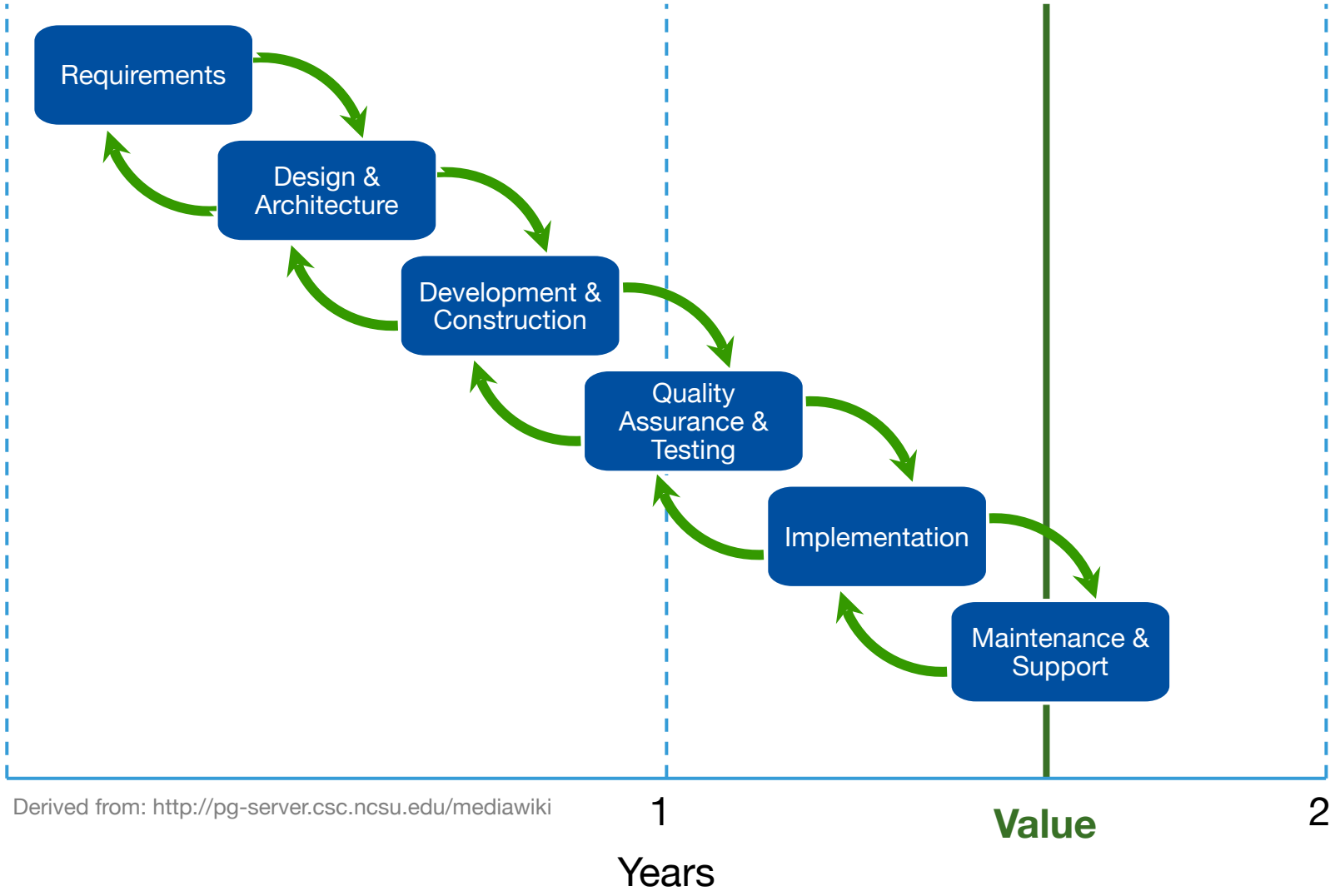
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A Release Is Needed to Realize Value



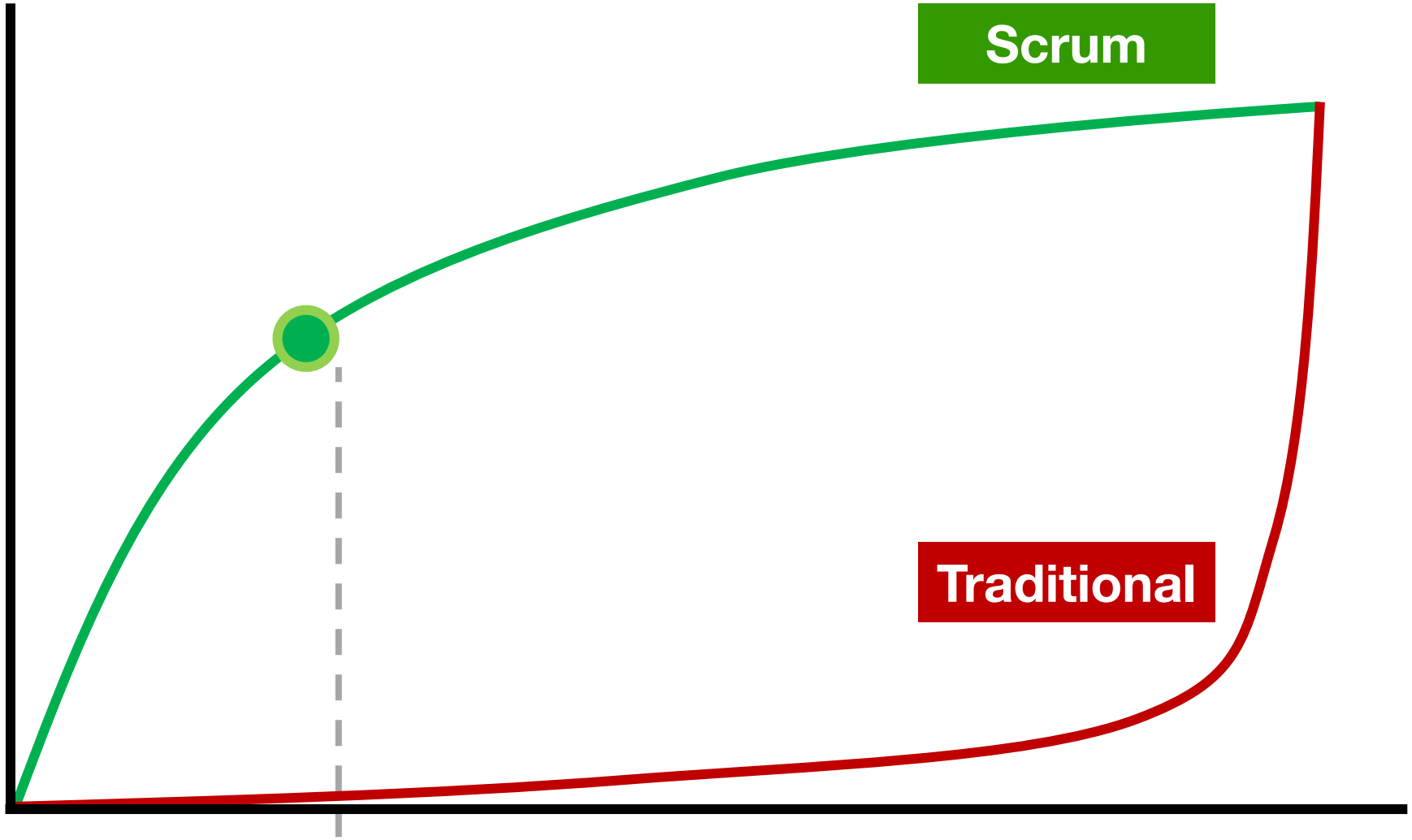
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Traditional Development Delays the Realization of Value



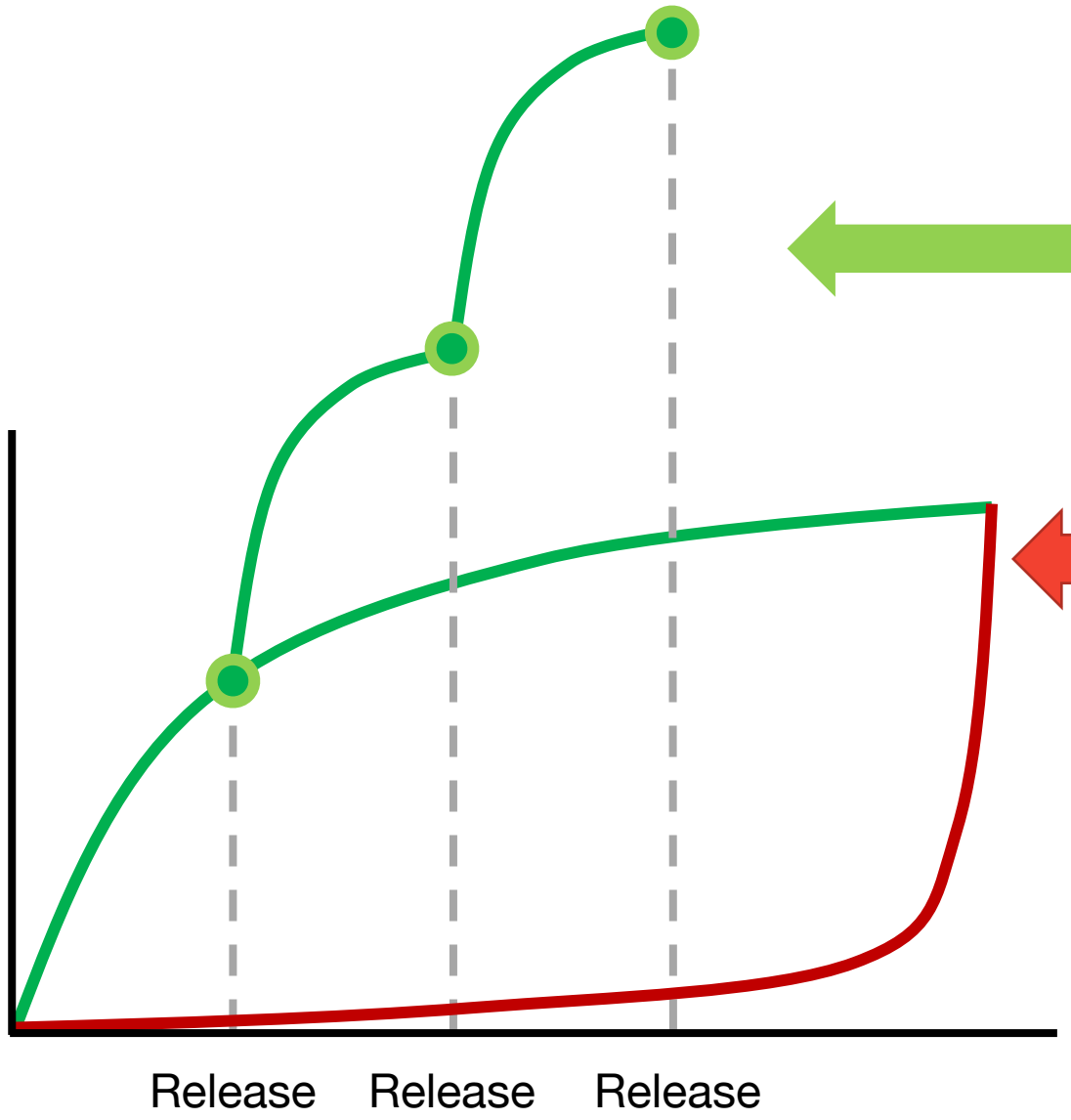
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Business Value Over Time



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Business Value Over Time – Leveraging Feedback Through Releases



Multiple opportunities to see how the customer uses product

No opportunity to see how the customer uses product

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Exercise

How Do You Know Your Product Is Creating Value?

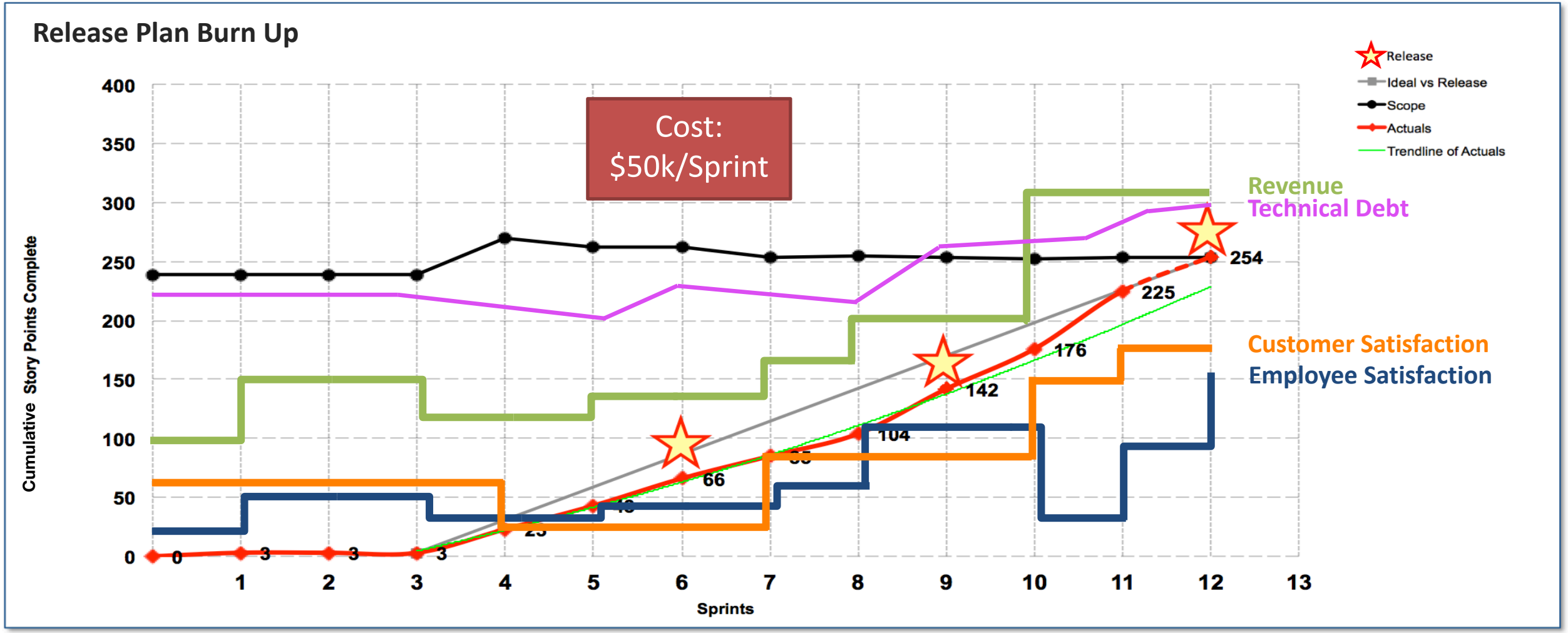
- What are you currently measuring?
- Do you apply any metrics?
- Are incentives in place for any of them?

5 minutes

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The Right Metrics Can Provide Insight Into Actual Value Delivered

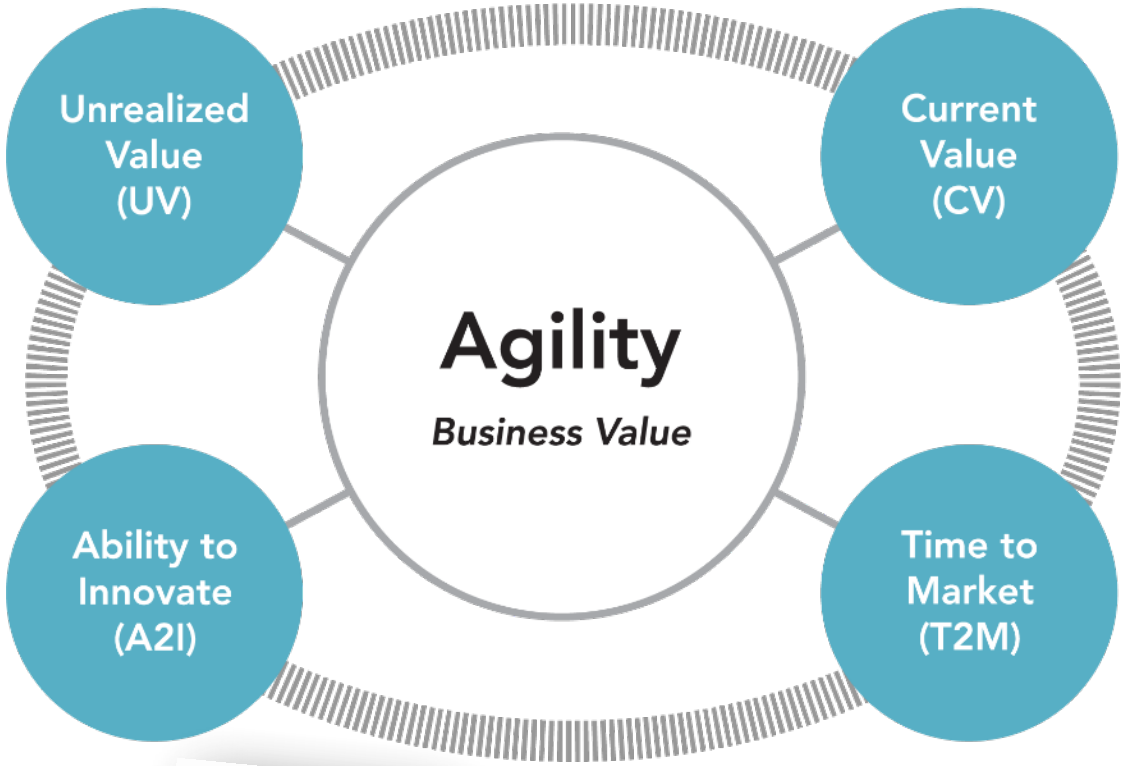


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Candidate Value Measures

EBMgt™ | Evidence-Based Management for Software Organizations

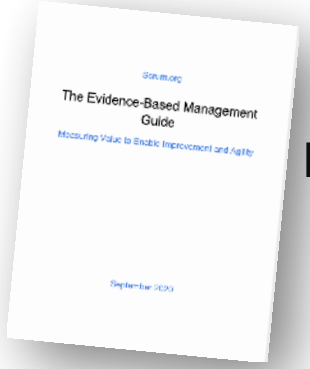
- Market Share
- Customer or User Satisfaction Gap



- Revenue per Employee
- Product Cost Ratio
- Employee Satisfaction
- Customer Satisfaction
- ***Usage Index***

- ***Innovation Rate***
- Time spent context switching
- ***Installed Version Index***
- Technical Debt
- Defect Trends
- Production Incident Count
- ***On-Product-Index***

- Build & Integration Frequency
- Release Frequency
- Release Stabilization Period
- Mean Time to Repair
- Cycle Time
- Lead Time
- Time to Learn



Read the EBM Guide at:
scrum.org/ebm

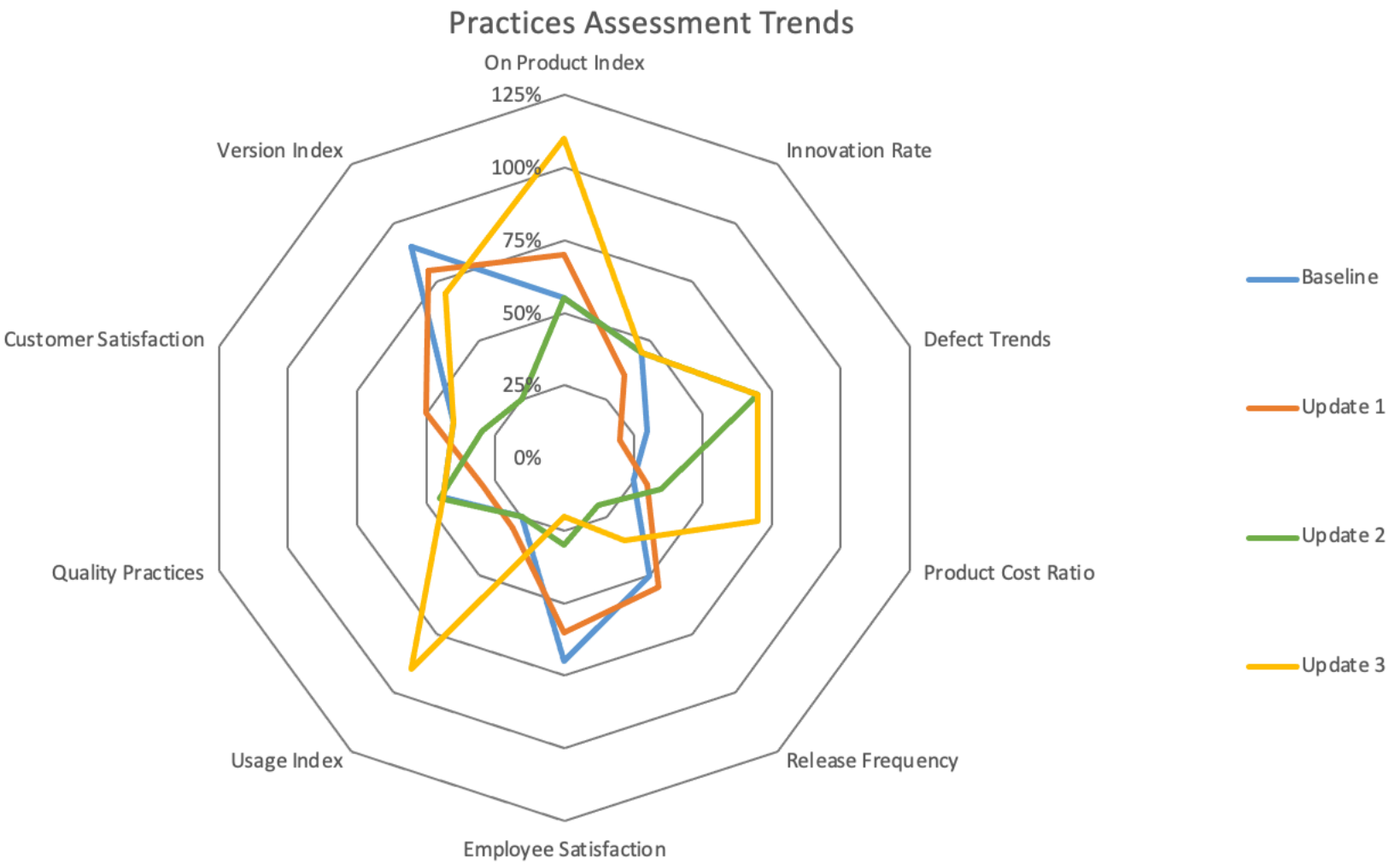
For more o this topic



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Look at Trends and Interrelationships



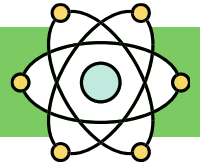
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Value-Driven Development Recommendations



TRY

- Finding patterns and relationships in metrics that help understand how to improve value delivery
- Managing value direction by using leading and lagging indicators
- Starting customer and stakeholder discussions with outcomes



FAVOR

- Linking goals to value
- Using additional tools such as impact mapping to link outcome to possible output
- Using the definition of value in Backlog Refinement, Sprint Planning, and Sprint Review
- Differentiating Customer segments, and what they consider as valuable
- Using trends in metrics, not absolutes



AVOID

- Defining features as value
- Accepting business value as an organizationally dictated number without analysis and understanding
- Believing you know value without data
- Mistaking velocity (output) and value (outcome)

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TAKE AWAY

Value-Driven Development

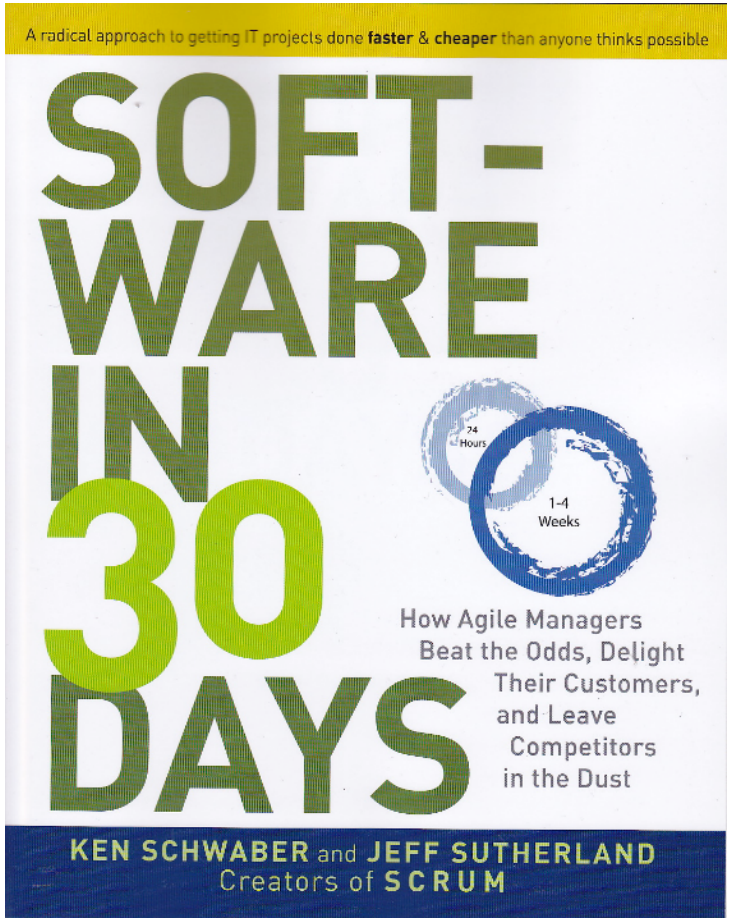
- Value in itself is difficult to quantify.
- Value remains an assumption until validated by the marketplace.
- Leverage metrics that provide you with insights about whether value is being delivered.
- Favor Value Creation over Revenue Extraction



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Suggested Reading

“Software in 30 Days” (Ken Schwaber, Jeff Sutherland)



“The Elements of Value” (Almquist, Senior, Bloch)



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Insanity: Doing the same thing over and over again and expecting different results.

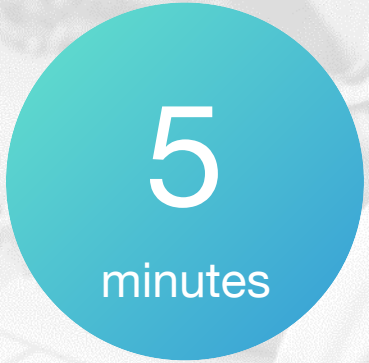
- Albert Einstein

4

Scrum Theory & Empiricism

Exercise

The Complexity of Product Development



List the variables that have to be considered in product development.

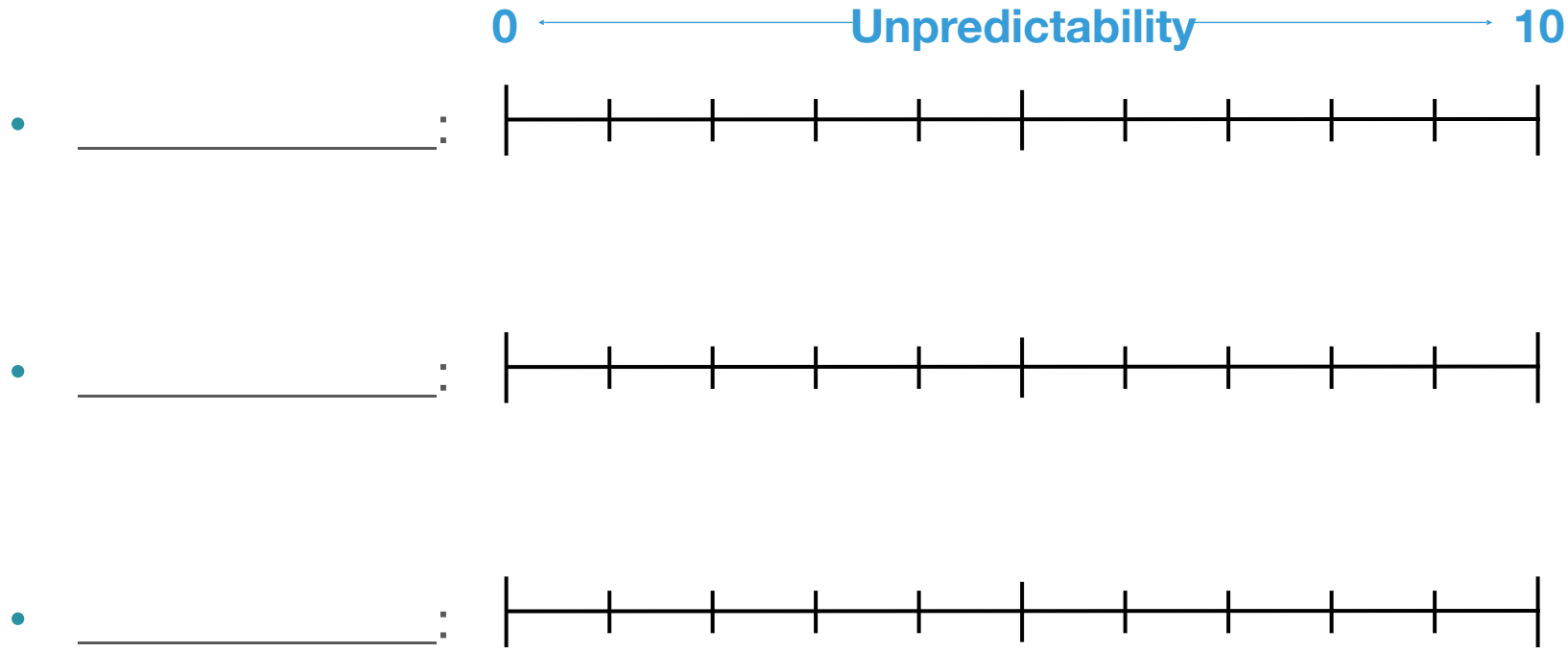
- **How predictable are they?**
- **What would you do to control them?**

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The Predictability of Product Development

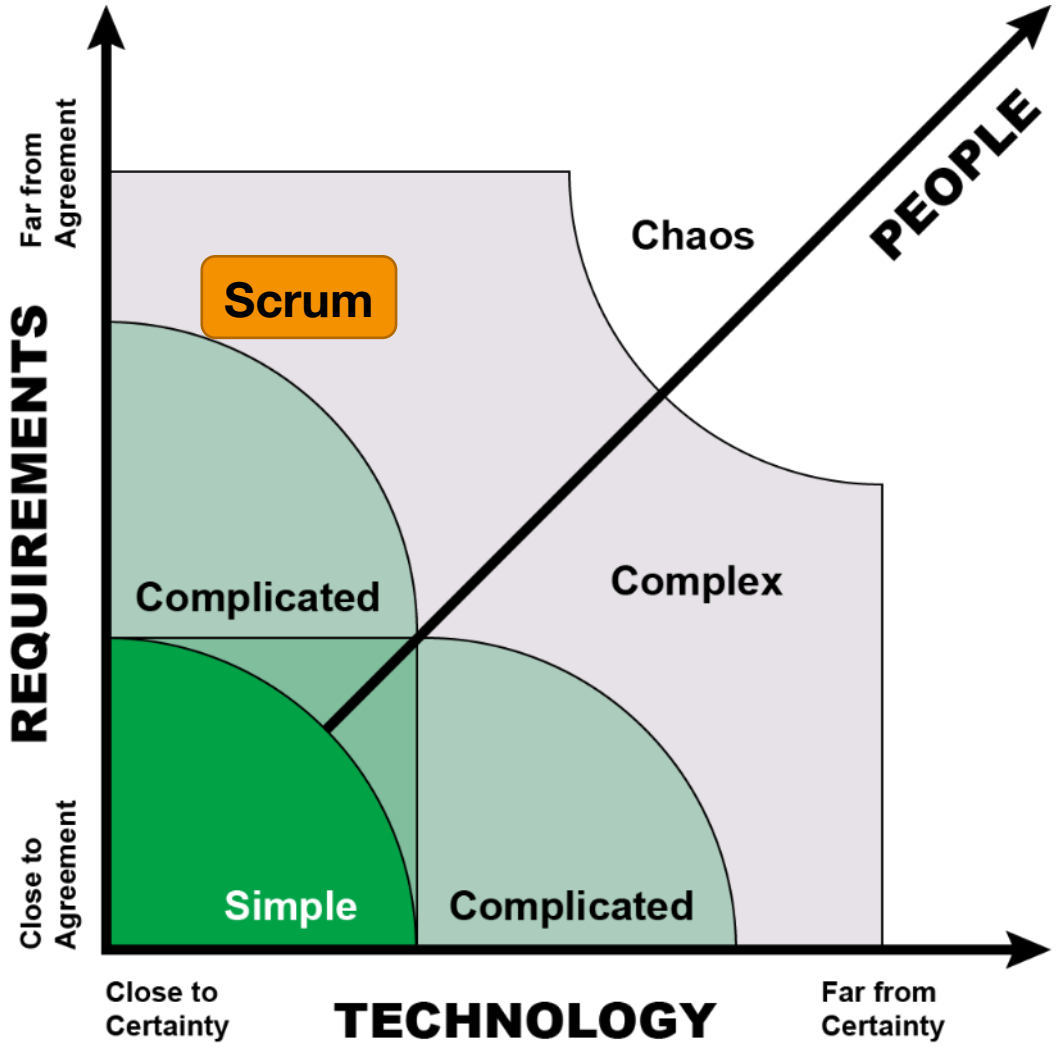
5 minutes

Put a slider (▼) at 0-10 for the 3 major variables in product development on the scale of unpredictability:



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The Complexity of Product Development



Based on the original chart by Ralph Stacey
(source: **Strategic Management and Organisational Dynamics, Pearson, 2015)**

- Simple
  everything is known
- Complicated
  more is known than unknown
- Complex
  more is unknown than known
- Chaotic
  very little is known

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Situation Dictates the Type of Process

DEFINED

- Given a well-defined set of inputs, the same outputs are generated every time
- Follow the pre-determined steps to get known results

Examples: Assembly line, construction, accounting

EMPIRICAL

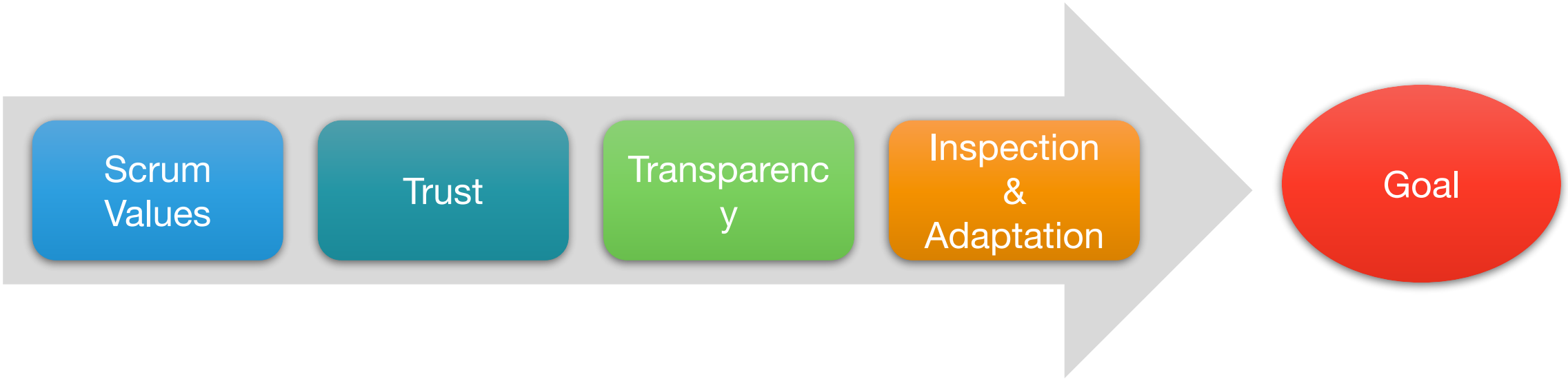
- Frequent inspection and adaptation occurs as work proceeds
- Outputs are often unpredictable and unrepeatable

Examples: Sales, marketing, theater, creative writing

This class focuses on the empirical approach

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Empirical Processes Require Trust & Courage



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Scrum Values

- The Scrum Values are the foundation for behavior and practices in Scrum.
- They are closely related to the theory and first principles of Scrum and support teams in their work.
- The Scrum Team can always fall back on these essentials.



Scrum Values are the life blood of the Scrum Framework.

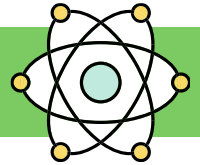
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Scrum Theory Recommendations



TRY

- Allowing details to emerge as needed instead of detailing everything upfront
- Steering clear of giving guarantees or promises about when something will be delivered



FAVOR

- Having the courage to be transparent and respect others
- Understanding the impact and reasons of complexity
- Embracing empiricism as a mindset
- Fostering faster feedback loops for more complex and risky endeavors



AVOID

- Seeing creative work as simple
- Trying to drive complex or complicated work to become simple
- Looking for best practices for non-simple work

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TAKE AWAY

Scrum Theory & Empirical Process Control

- Product development resides in the complex domain.
- The best fit for complexity is the empirical process.
- The 3 pillars of empiricism are transparency, inspection, and adaptation.
- Transparency requires trust and courage.



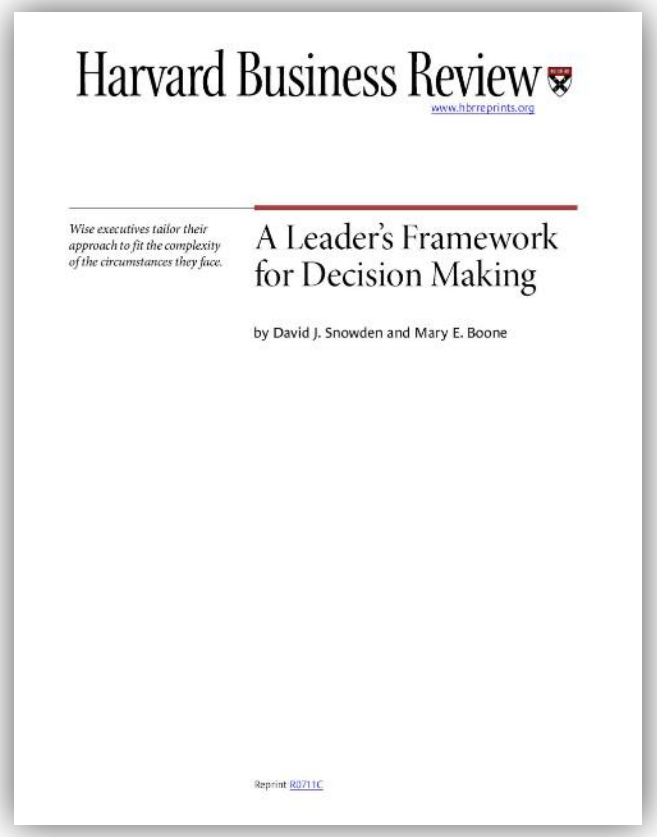
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Suggested Reading

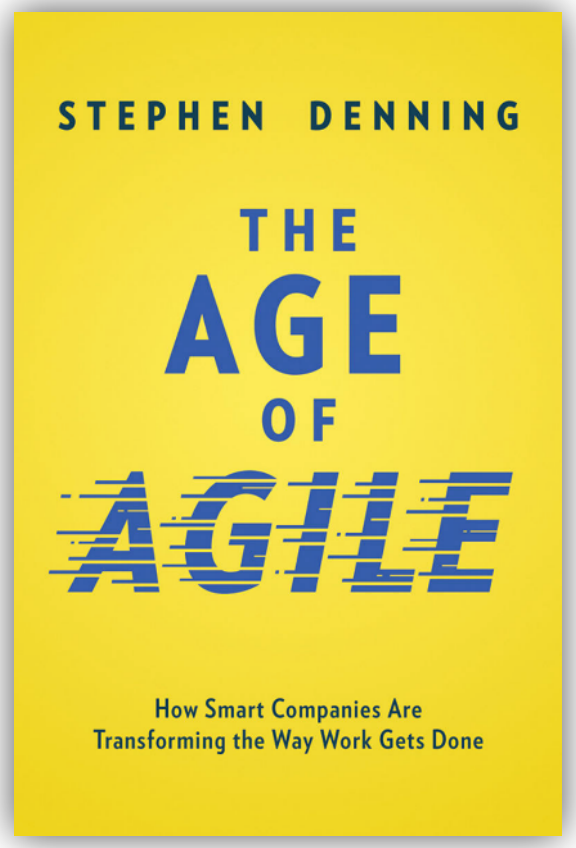
“The New New Product Development Game” (Takeuchi, Nonaka)



“A Leader’s Framework for Decision-Making” (Snowden, Boone)



”The Age of Agile” (Stephen Denning)



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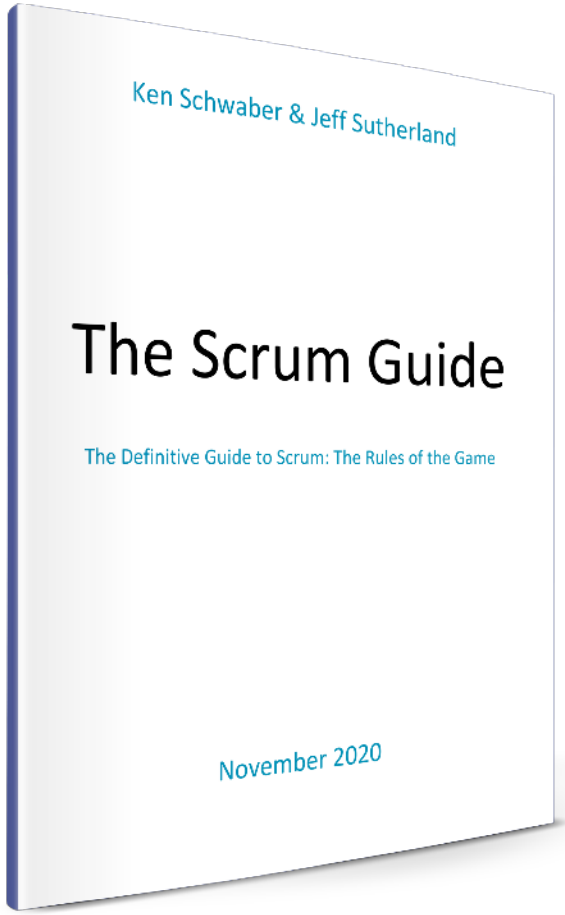
*"If you haven't found it yet, keep looking.
Don't settle. As with all matters of the heart,
you'll know when you find it."*

- Steve Jobs

5

The Scrum Framework

Definition of Scrum



www.scrumguides.org

Scrum (*noun*):
A lightweight framework that helps people, teams and organizations generate value through adaptive solutions for complex problems.

Scrum is

- Lightweight tool for enabling business agility
- Simple and purposefully incomplete

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What is Needed for Scrum?

5 minutes

Do you know the elements of the Scrum framework?

Team	Artifacts	Events
•	•	•
•	•	•
•	•	•
		•
		•

What else do you associate with Scrum?

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Accountabilities, Artifacts, Events, Commitments, and Other Concepts

Accountabilities

- Product Owner
- Developers
- Scrum Master

Artifacts

- Product Backlog
- Sprint Backlog
- Increment

Events

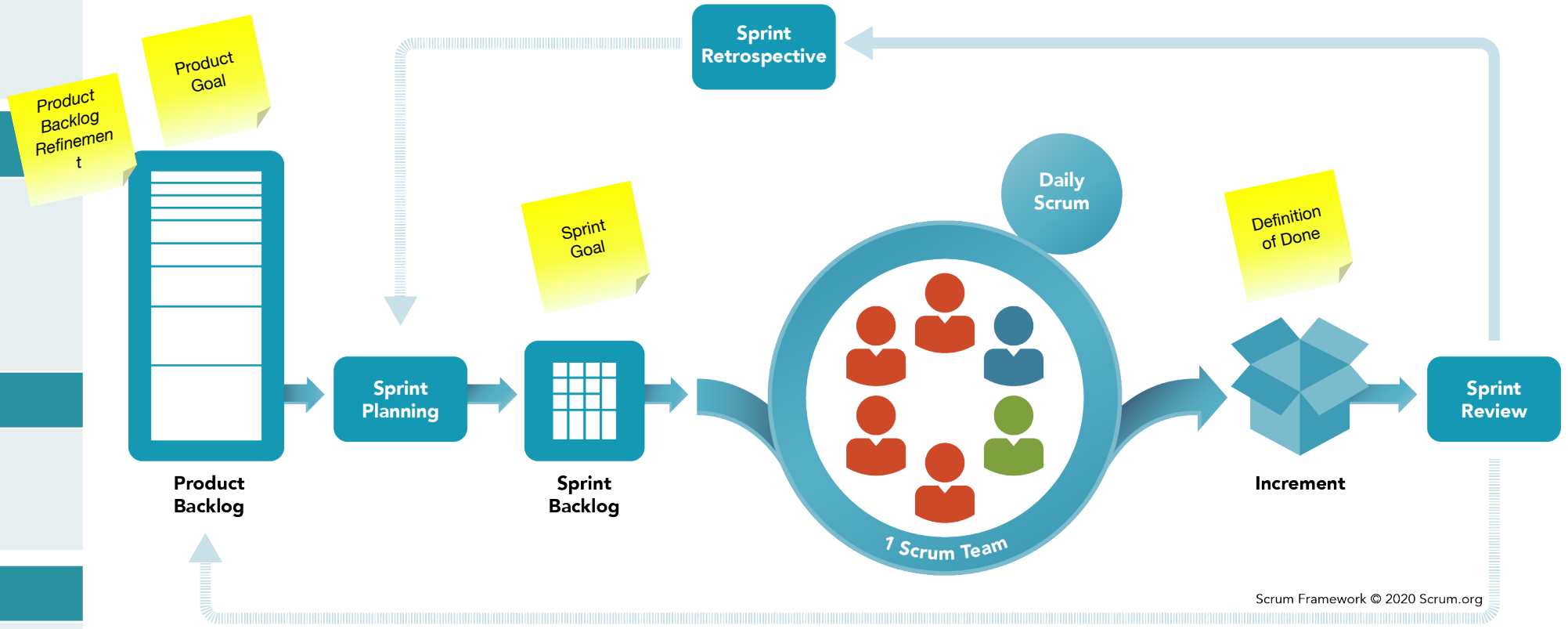
- Sprint
- Sprint Planning
- Daily Scrum
- Sprint Review
- Sprint Retrospective

Commitments

- Product Goal
- Sprint Goal
- Definition of Done

Other

- *Product Backlog Refinement*



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Exercise

The Rewrite Fallacy

PURPOSE

Discover the need for a Product Backlog

5 minutes

Your organization has a legacy application that “works fine” but is getting increasingly difficult/expensive to support. It is going to be re-written using modern technologies. Larry is the Product Manager.

Larry says the users are completely happy with the existing system and use all its features (though usage statistics are not available).

Larry claims that the new system must “do exactly what the old system did.” Because of this, he says there is no need for a Product Owner or a Product Backlog, let alone any need for assigning business value.

Question: Is Larry helping or hindering? How?

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Exercise

Judi Is in Trouble

PURPOSE

Demonstrate accountabilities in Scrum

5 minutes

Judi is CEO of a community portal in San Francisco. The portal has over 20m subscribers.

Other than content changes, there hasn't been a release of new functionality in over 5 months.

There are five directors, responsible for advertising, dating, community, vacations, and classified functionality. They each receive commissions on the revenue from their respective areas.

They cannot agree on what strategic direction to take next.

What would be your recommendation for Judi?

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Exercise

David Saves the Day

PURPOSE

Demonstrate the authority of the Product Owner

5 minutes

The company is trained in Scrum. David is now Product Owner. David works with the other directors and creates an ordered product backlog that is agreeable to all the directors.

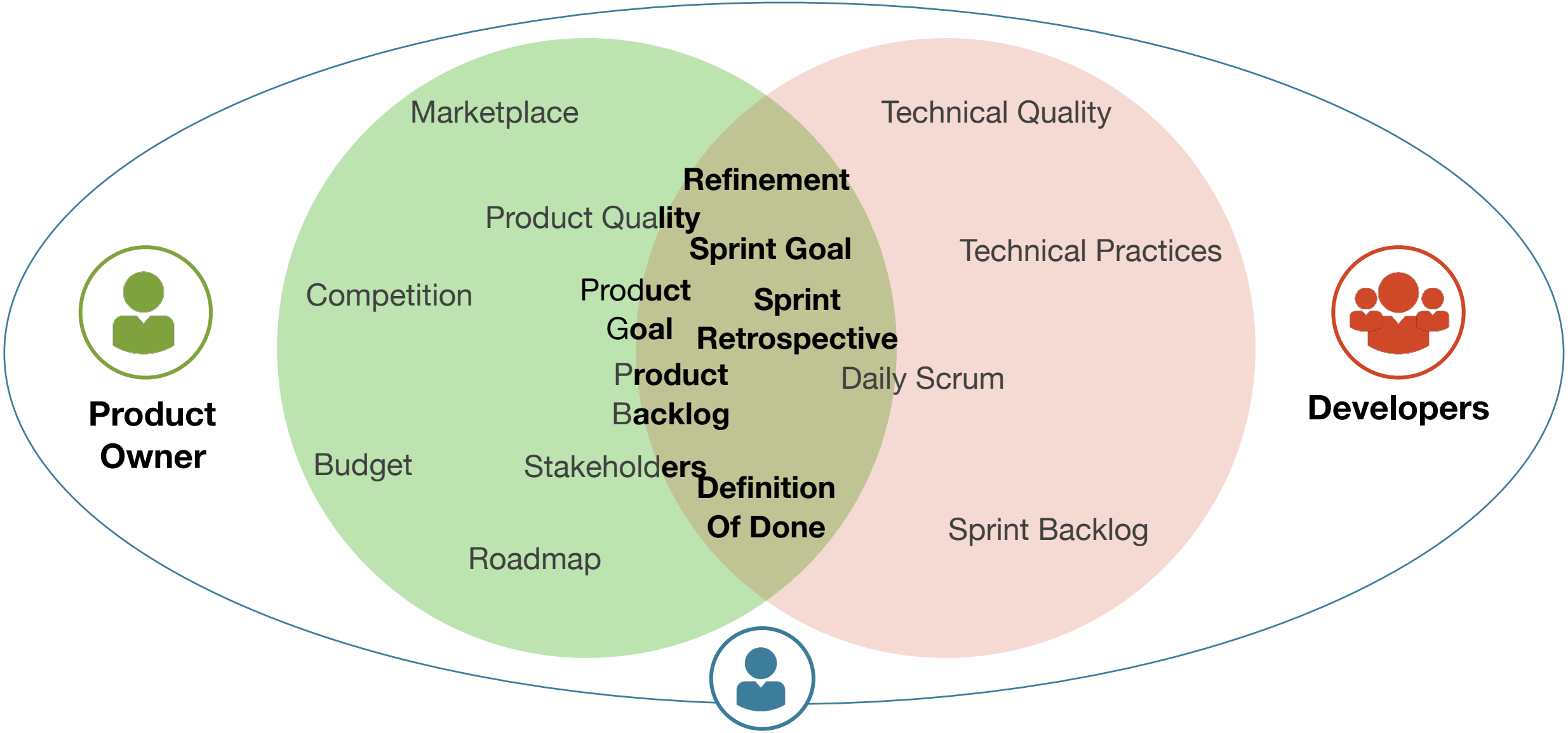
At Sprint Planning, David presents a Product Backlog different from what he and the other four directors agreed on earlier. This product backlog will provide David with the best commission at the expense of the other directors.

The directors, attending the meeting, express their disagreement. After hours of bickering, they are nowhere.

What does Scrum call for?

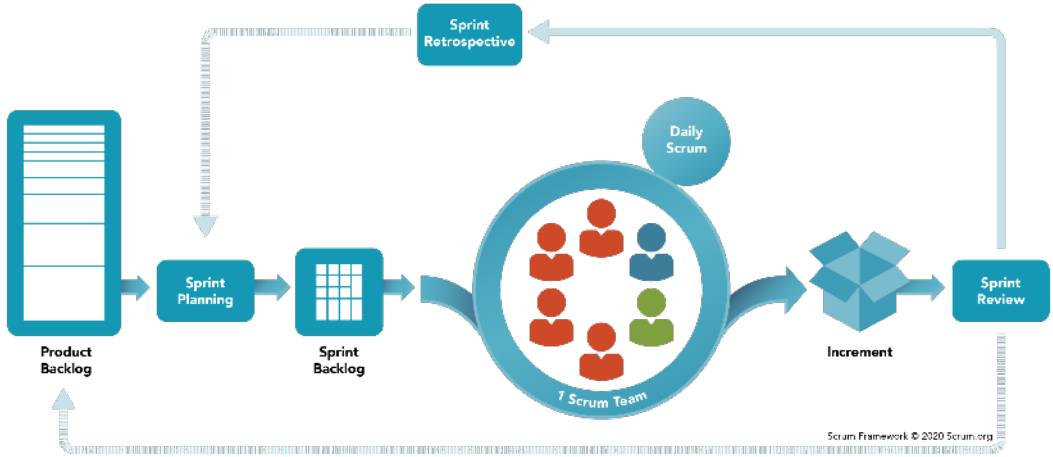
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Scrum Team Relationship



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What Is a Sprint in Scrum?

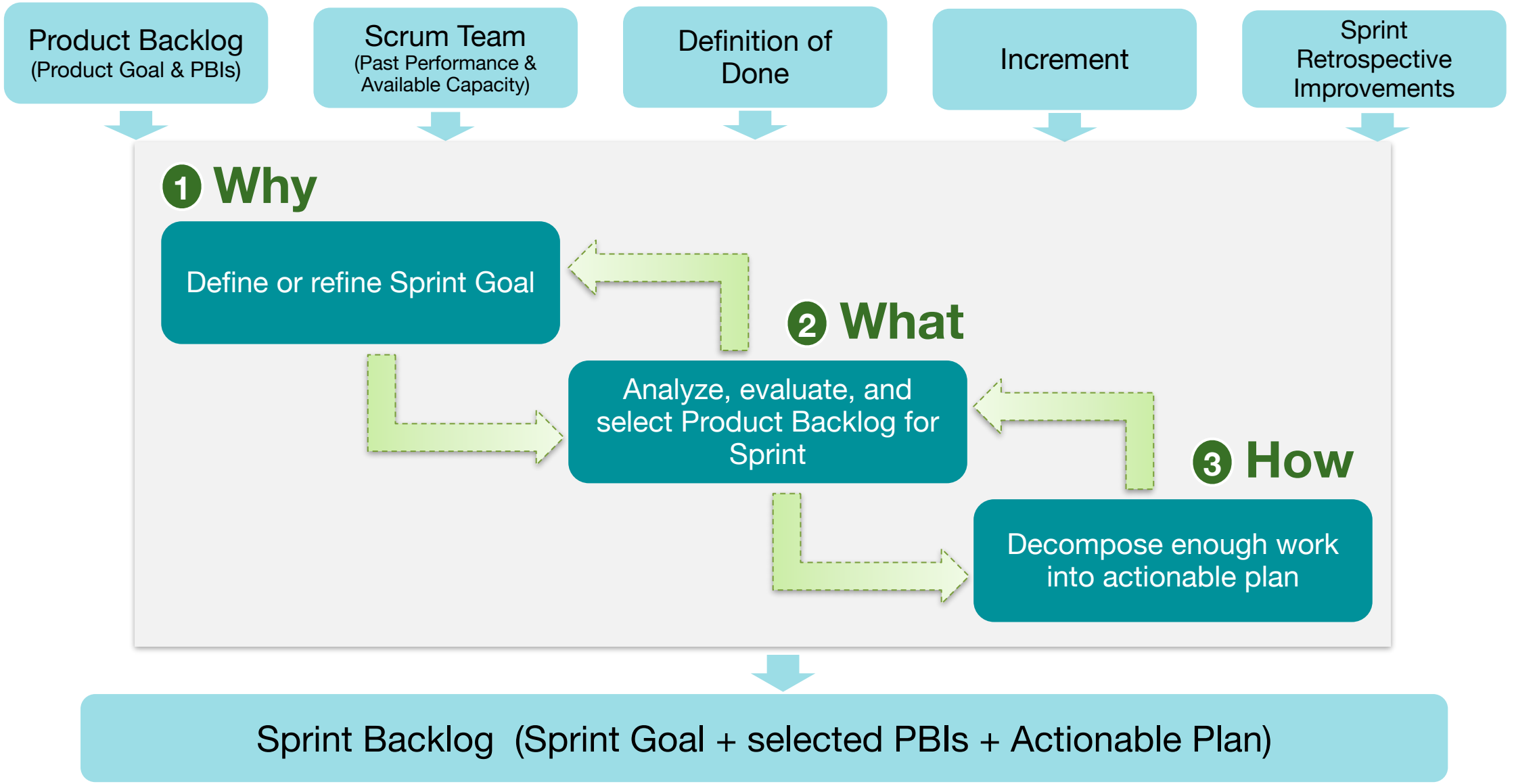


Sprints serve iterative-incremental development.

- All development is done within a Sprint
- A Sprint has a consistent duration of 1 month or less
  - Sprint length is determined by acceptable planning horizon, risk, and unknowns
  - Sprint length is NOT set by the number of items, but by the factors above
- Scrum knows no phases, only Sprints
  - No testing, hardening, analysis Sprints

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Sprint Planning Meeting Flow



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Exercise

Sprint Goal Explorations

Understand what a sprint goal is and how it works

5 minutes

Create a Sprint Goal for Your Product

It's time for your first Sprint Goal.

With the help of the following format, create a Sprint Goal for your Class Product

At the end of our sprint,
We will share <**Achievement**>
Which has a value of <**Impact**>

Our focus is on <**Outcome**>
We believe it delivers <**Impact**> to <**Customer**>
This will be confirmed when <**Event happens**>

https://www.scrum.org/resources/blog/sprint-goal-template

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Some Sprint Goals

An **objective** to be met in the Sprint	• Through the implementation of the PBIs selected in Sprint Planning • Providing guidance to the Scrum Team • Acts as a step towards the Product Goal
Allows **flexibility** in delivering the Increment	• Allows flexibility for exact implementation of PBIs • Although the Sprint Goal is fixed
Is **sacrosanct** throughout the Sprint	• As the Scrum Team works, it keeps this goal in mind • Each Daily Scrum assesses the Team's progress toward meeting the Sprint Goal

Set up deployment pipeline & release an empty site to production

Enable visitors to search for properties

Show top-selling products on the homepage

Can we build the hazard warning line assistance with the new hardware sensor for our trucks?

A visitor can order a product

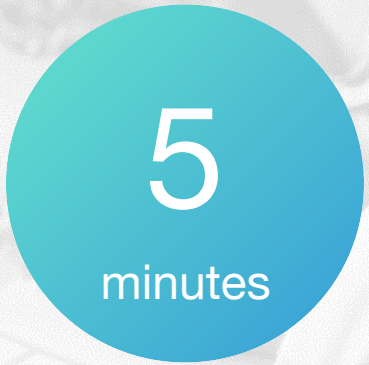
Allow users to order by using pre-paid credits

Additional reading: https://www.scrum.org/resources/blog/10-powerful-questions-create-better-sprint-goals

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Exercise

Product Owner and Sprint Backlog



During the Sprint, the Product Owner is nervous about the way the Developers are working.

The PO believes that they are not focused on the Sprint Goal and would like to question the Developers about their approach and possibly have them change their Sprint Backlog.

Question: What is the Product Owner allowed to do?

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Cancelling a Sprint

- Sprints may be cancelled early, i.e. before the time-box expires.
  - Only by the Product Owner
  - Prefer adjusting Sprint Scope
- A Sprint would be cancelled if the Sprint Goal becomes obsolete.
- Reasons to cancel may include changes in competition, business, or technology feasibility.
- After a Sprint cancellation, re-plan the Sprint.



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Exercise

A Sprint Is a Feedback Loop

5 minutes

Connect the statements to the Scrum events.
Cross out incorrect statements.

- Inspect the Increment
- The Product Owner informs the team of the Velocity required for the next Sprint
- Figure out how to make the next Sprint more enjoyable
- The Scrum Team inspects itself
- Progress is discussed towards Product Goal
- Adapting the Definition of Done to increase product quality

Sprint Review

Sprint Retrospective

- A demo to promote the product to the stakeholders
- Inspect how the Sprint went with regards to people and relationships
- Inspect marketplace changes and potential use of the product
- Adapt the Product Backlog
- A status meeting for the steering committee

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Flow of the Sprint Review Meeting

This is a collaborative working session, not a demonstration





Sprint Goal



Increment & Definition of Done

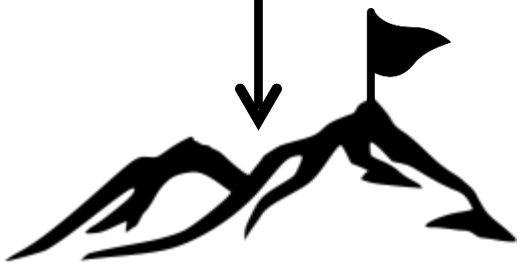


Product Backlog & Product Goal



Current Business Conditions

Review, discover & rearrange info



Updated Product Backlog

Purpose: steer product direction based on feedback & common understanding

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Exercise

Exploring Product Cohesion

5 minutes

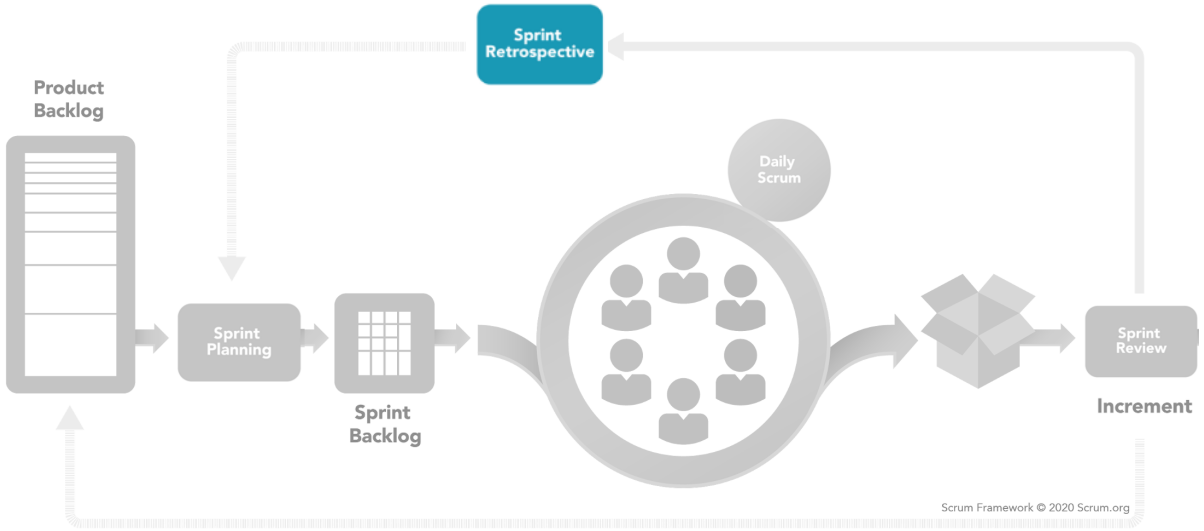
As an observer, you go to a Sprint Review and see multiple stakeholders attending. The stakeholders are all annoyed because none of them got “enough” functionality.

Although stakeholders participate in Product Backlog refinement, it seems what is created during the Sprint only partially satisfies any of the stakeholders.

What elements of Scrum would help the Product Owner?

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Sprint Retrospective



The Product Owner is required to attend

- Scrum Team inspects how the last Sprint went
  - People & Relationships
  - Process
  - Environment (tools)
  - Quality
- Adapt the Definition of Done if appropriate
- Scrum Team selects the most impactful improvements are addressed as soon as possible.

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Exercise

Exploring "Done"

5 minutes

How should the Product Owner be involved with the Definition of Done?

Do they create it?

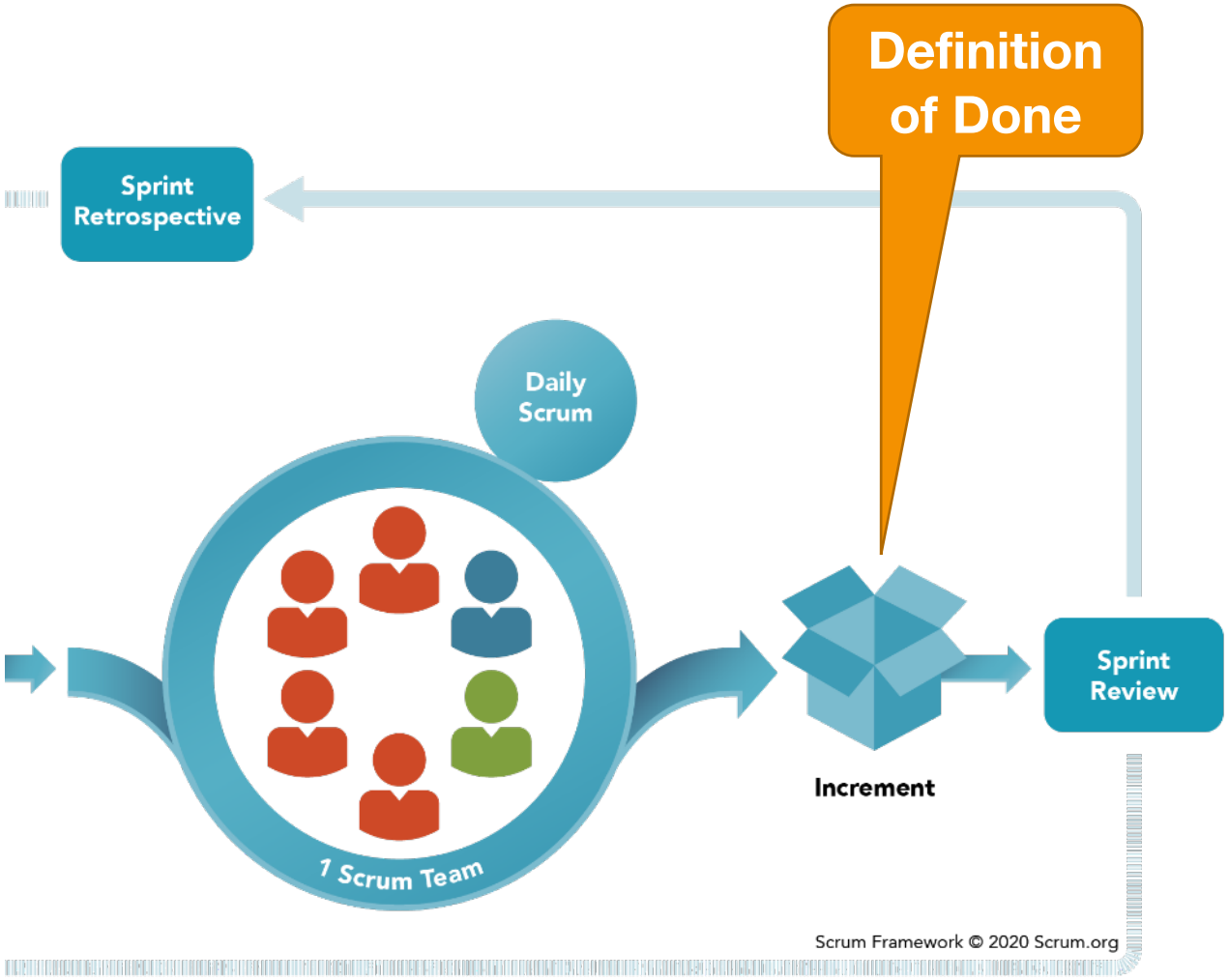
Can they change it?

Why do they care about it?

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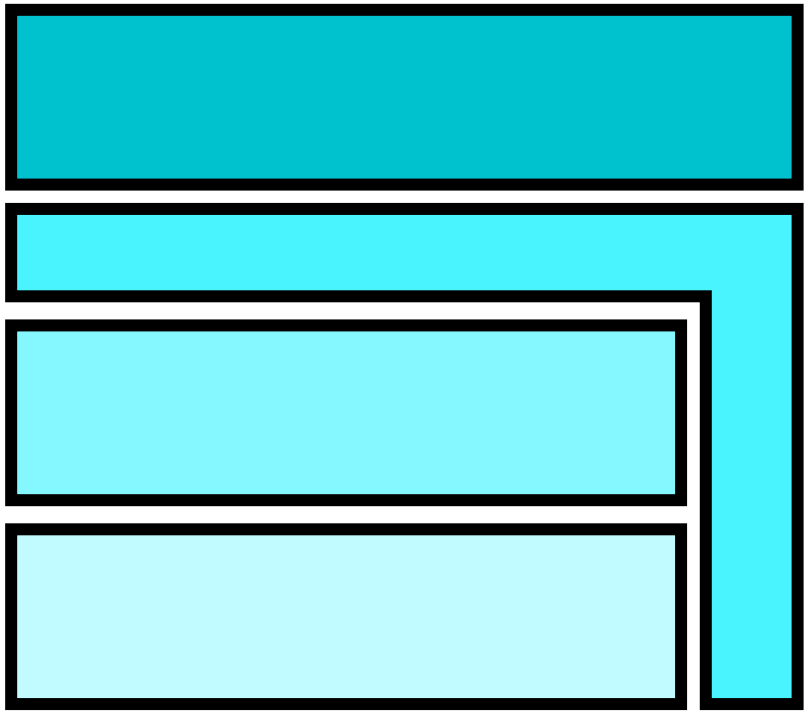
Incremental Requires Transparency

- Increment must be transparent to Product Owner and stakeholders
- Increment must be “Done” in adherence with the Definition of Done
- Increment must be potentially releasable, or usable by stakeholders

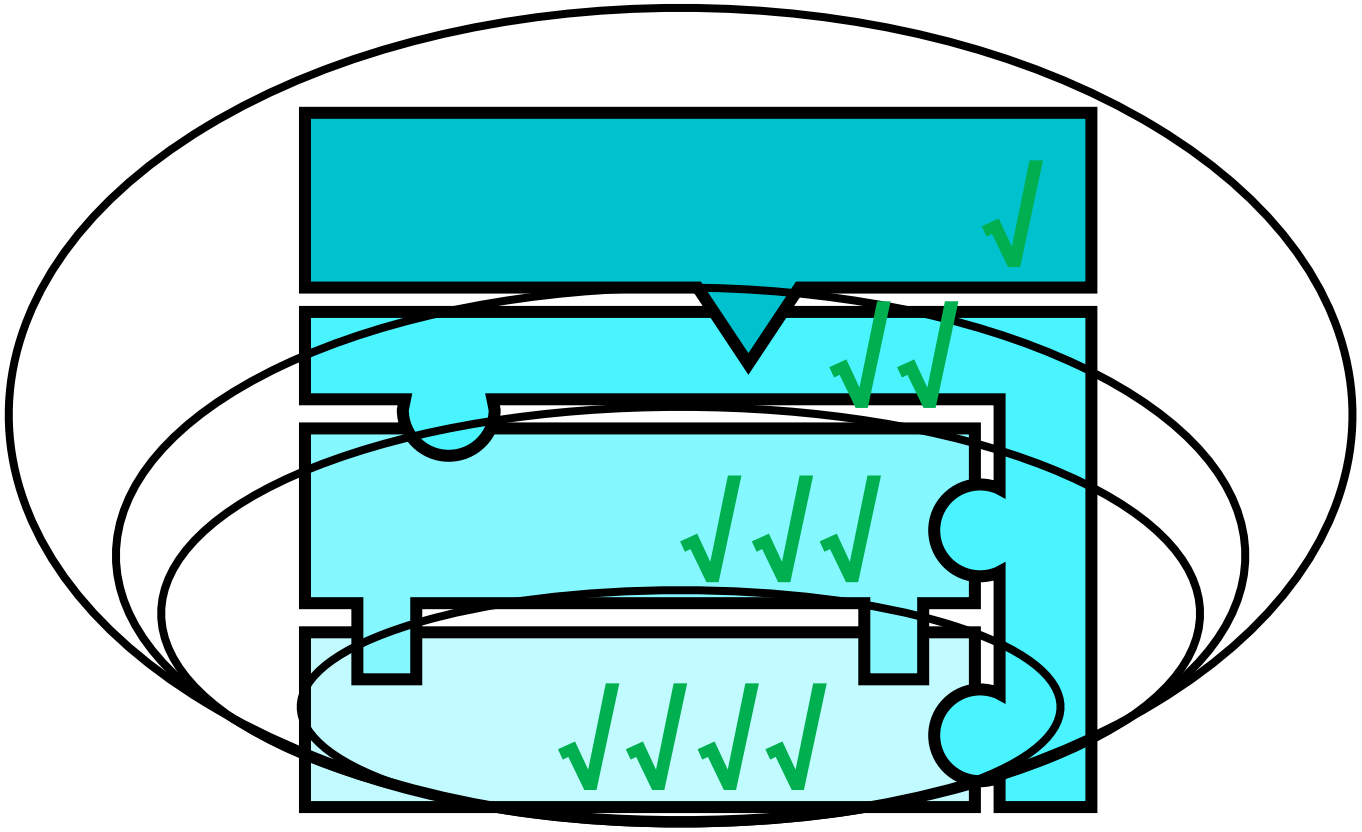


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Increment Grows Over Time Iteratively – Always Done



Incremental



Iterative & Incremental

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Scrum Events Quick Reference

Event	Inspection	Adaptation	Who Attends	Timebox for 1 Month
Sprint Planning	Product Backlog, Product Goal, Definition of Done	Sprint Backlog, Sprint Goal	Scrum Team	8 hours
Daily Scrum	Progress toward Sprint Goal	Sprint Backlog	Developers	15 minutes (always)
Sprint Review	Increment, Sprint, Product Backlog, Progress toward Product Goal	Product Backlog	Scrum Team Stakeholders	4 hours
Sprint Retrospective	Sprint, Definition of Done	Actionable improvements, Definition of Done	Scrum Team	3 hours

Every element of Scrum serves empiricism.

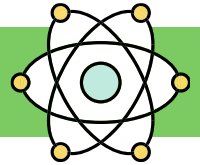
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Scrum Framework Recommendations



TRY

- Picking Sprint work driven by the Sprint Goal
- Relating Sprint Goal to Product Goal



FAVOR

- Focus on communicating value with the scrum team in the Scrum events
- Conceptualizing a Sprint as a risk box, not a feature box
- Making a single cohesive Sprint Goal for a sprint



AVOID

- Using only comfortable parts of Scrum
- Using Sprint Review as a showcase or educational session for stakeholders
- “Managing” the Scrum Team
- Not using Scrum Values as guides
- Bowing out of retrospectives
- Consistently carrying work over from Sprint to Sprint

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TAKE AWAY

The Scrum Framework & Product Owner

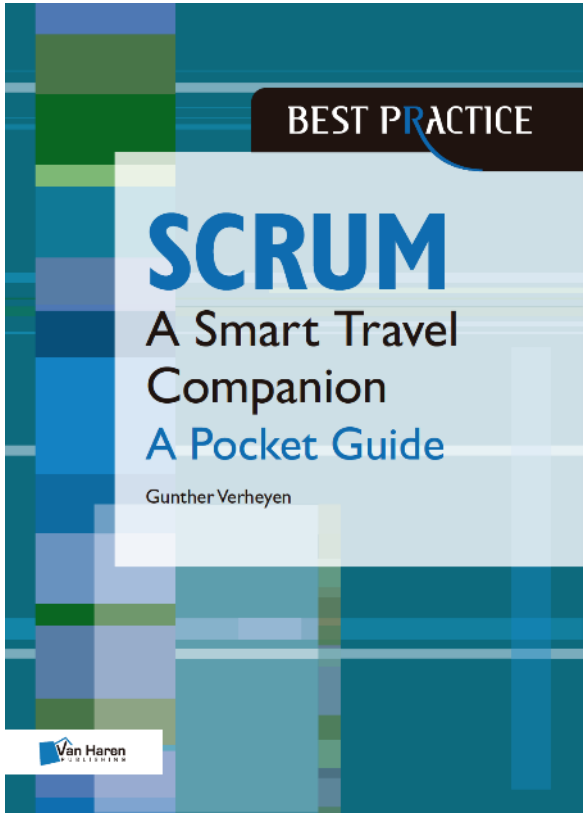
- Scrum enables empiricism for an agile business.
- A Sprint is a window of opportunity.
- The length of the Sprint controls risk
- Every Scrum Team member has clear accountability.
- The Product Owner is the value optimizer.



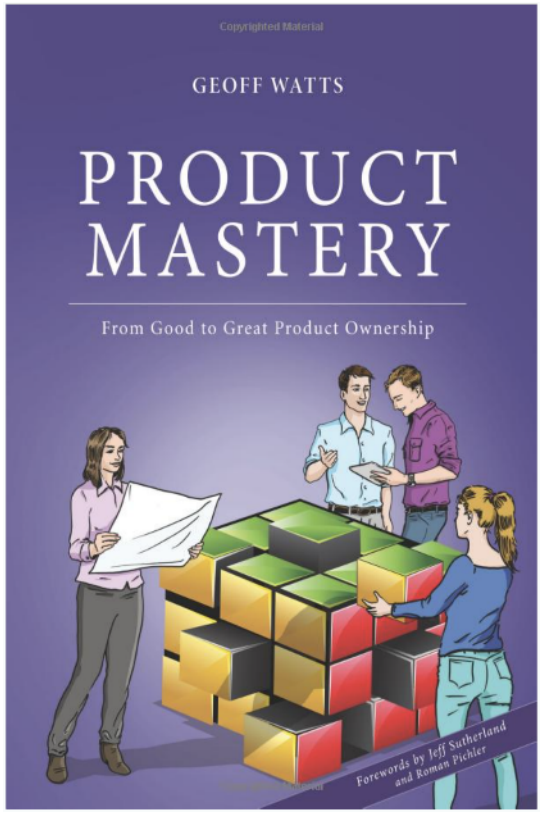
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Suggested Reading

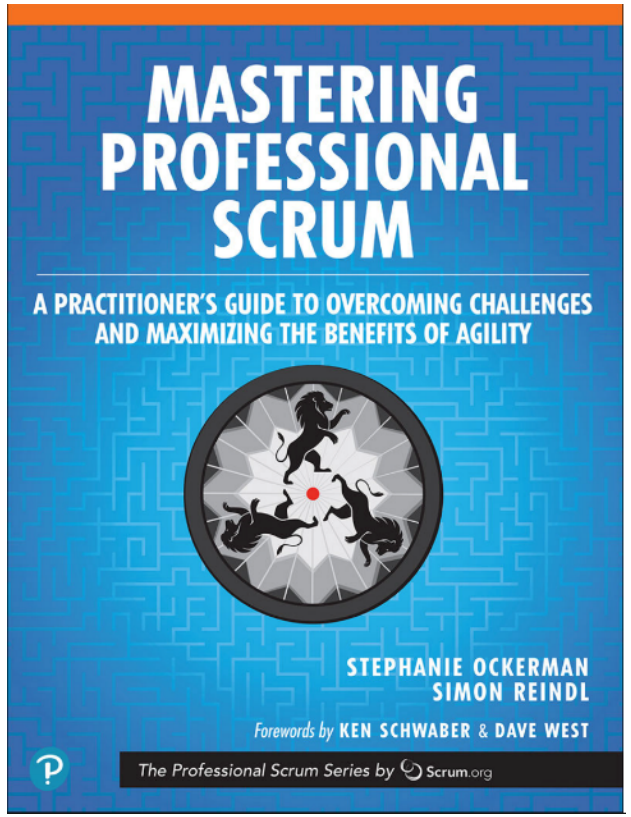
“Scrum – A Pocket Guide” (Gunther Verheyen)



“Product Mastery” (Geoff Watts)



“Mastering Professional Scrum” (Ockerman and Reindl)



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"If you pick up a starving dog and make him prosperous, he will not bite you. This is the principal difference between a dog and a man."

- Mark Twain



6

Product Backlog Management

Exercise

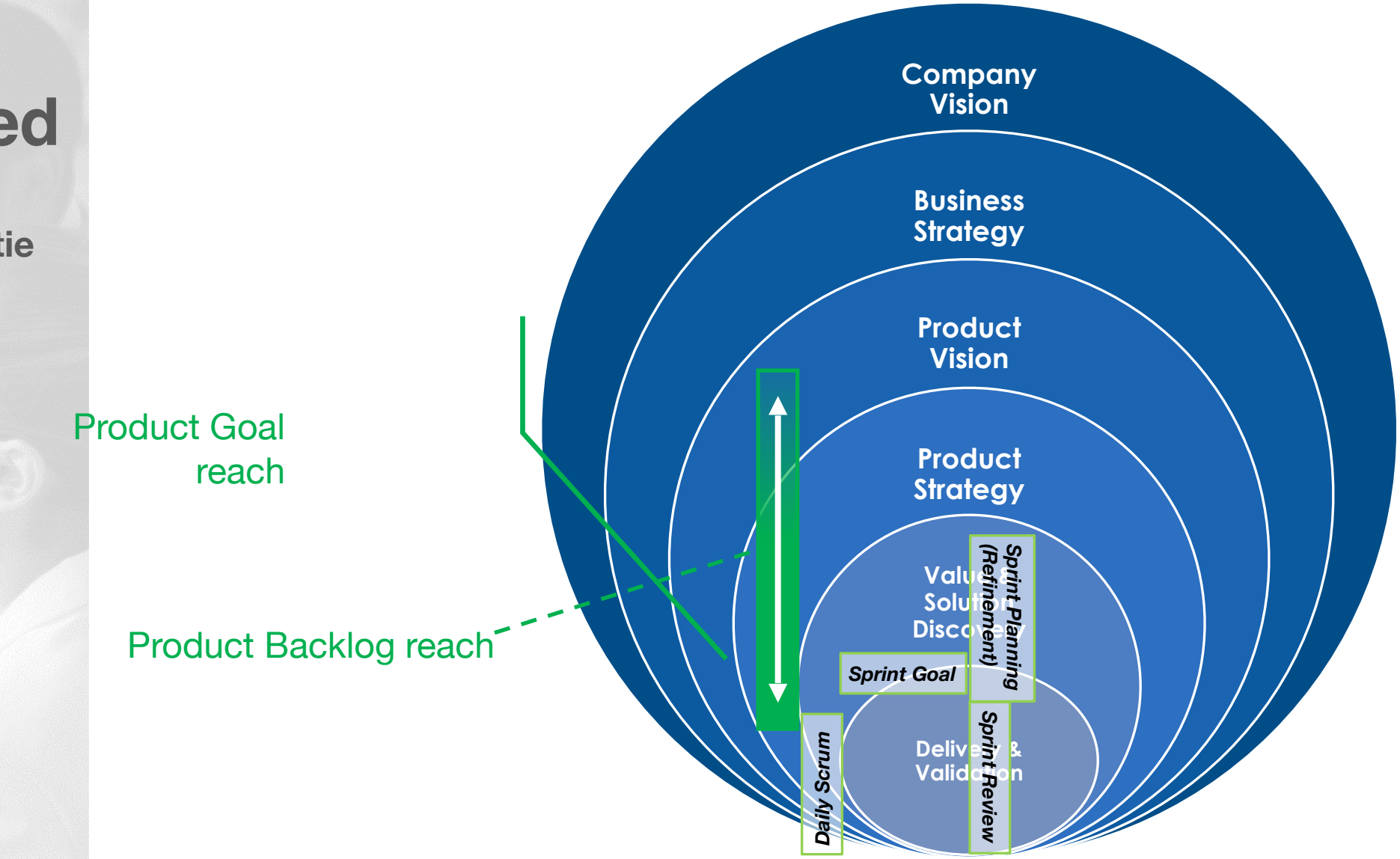
The Bigger Picture Revisited

What tools, techniques, and practices would you use to tie the layers together?

Examples:

- Business model canvas
- Vision statement
- Product roadmap
- User Stories
- Acceptance criteria
- User survey
- Impact mapping
- User story map

5 minutes



Scrum.org/PSPO

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Product Vision, Product Goal, and Sprint Goal Relationship

Product Vision

Save lives by reducing accidents at traffic lights

Product	Product Goal	Sprint Goal	PBIs in the sprint
Autonomous Traffic Light Coordinator	Autonomously change traffic flow via traffic lights depending on volume	Establish core communication with traffic lights	Send simple ping between two TL Centrally determine state of TLs Centrally Determine Geolocation of TL

- Strategy to achieve the vision can be expressed in goals for the Product
- Product Goals are measurable and serve to focus the work of the team over a longer period
- There can be only one Product Goal (at a given time)

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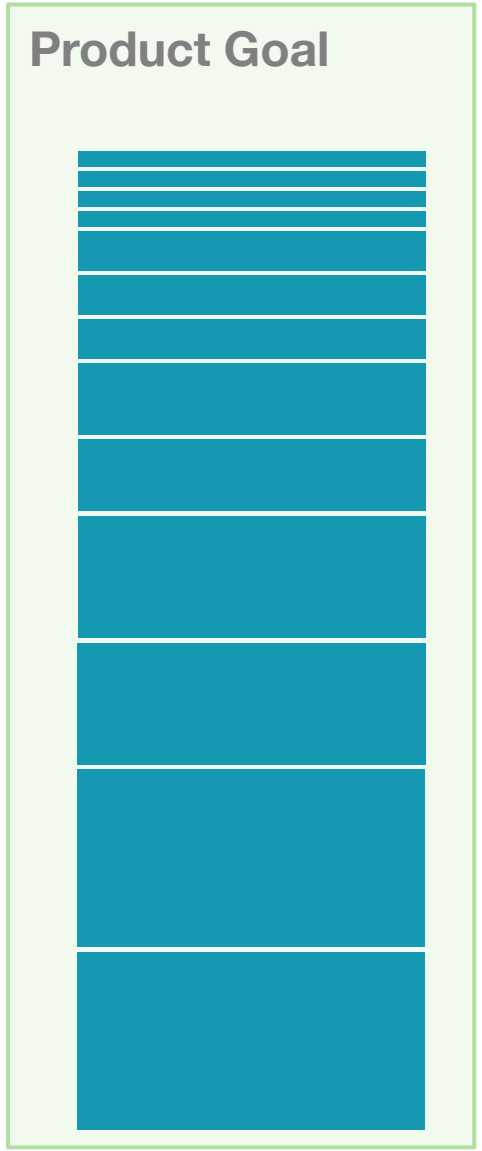
A Good Product Goal

1. If we have many items in the Product Backlog that don't contribute towards the Product Goal, do we have the right Product Goal?
2. If we wouldn't have another release after this one, what would be a Product Goal to support and drive this release in order to return optimal value?
3. If we were paying for this Product with our own money, what Product Goal would give us the highest chance to get that money back?
4. When we achieve this Product Goal, what has clearly changed or improved from the perspective of customers?
5. Is the least amount of work required to achieve our Product Goal feasible?
6. With our current Product Goal, can we reduce the possibility of abandoning it later?
7. Does our Product Goal excite you and your customers with opportunities?
8. Can we use the Product Goal to prevent increasing risk or wasting time and money?
9. Given our current Product Goal, what would indicate that you should abandon it?

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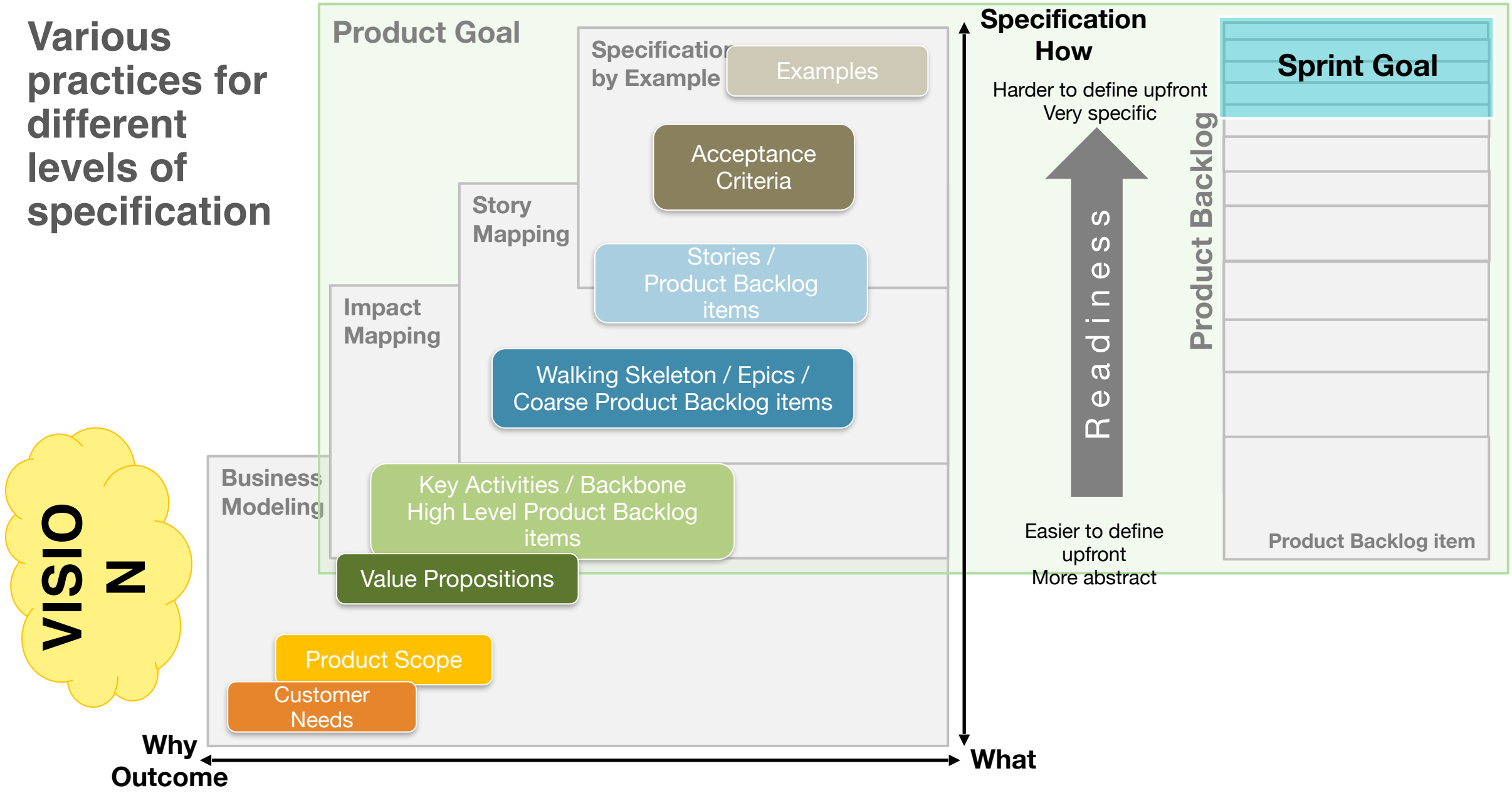
Characteristics of a Product Backlog

- Based on a Product Goal – but not constrained by it
- Single source for valuable items to deliver
- Transparent to Scrum Team & Stakeholders
- Ordered based on value, dependencies, and risk
- Product Backlog items are sized
- A vehicle for starting conversations
- May reference other artifacts like:
  - Specifications, Mockups, Architecture Models



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Various practices for different levels of specification



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Valid Product Backlog Items

Feature Requests

Non-Functional Requirements

Experiments

User Stories

Bugs/ Defects

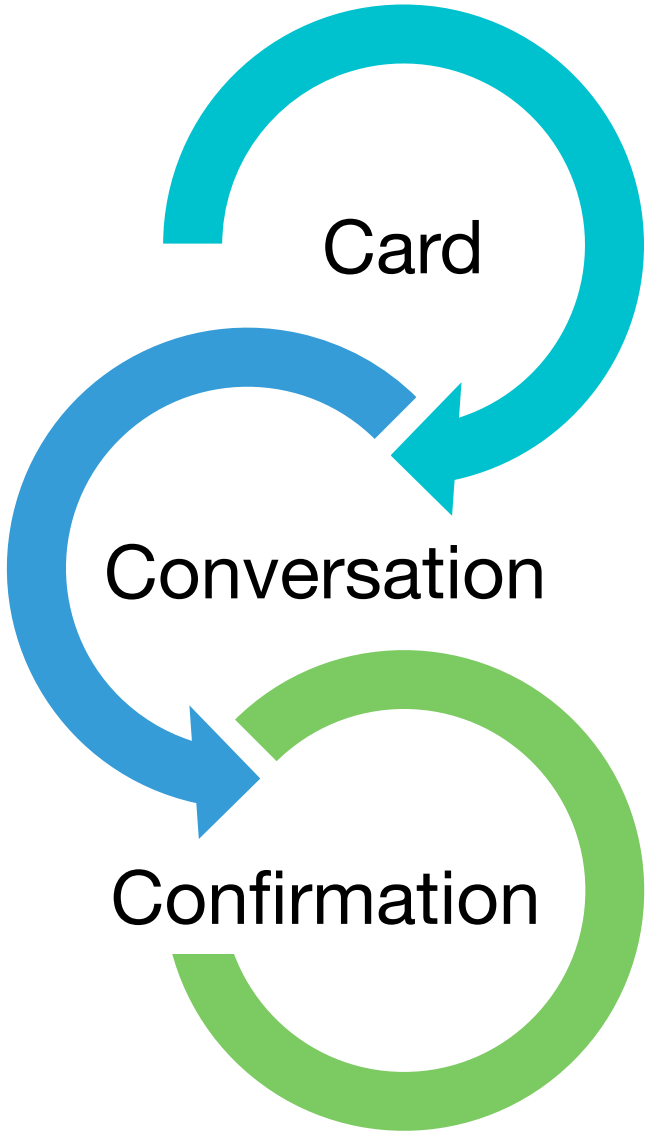
Use Cases

Capabilities

…

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The Three C's of User Stories



TITLE: Derive Racing Time

As a *casual Runner*

I want *to be able to derive the race time for a new distance based on past times*

So that *I can better plan my training*

Stories are **about** the **shared understanding**
***NOT* about documentation**

As a user

I want to book a hotel reservation

So that I can be sure to have a room

As a frequent traveler

I want to book a recurrent room in a hotel

so that I can spare time in administration

As a father

I want to book connecting room in a hotel

so that I can be sure my children are next to my room

TITLE: Derive Racing Time

As a *casual Runner*

I want *to be able to derive the race time for a new distance based on past times*

So that *I can better plan my training*

Acceptance Criteria

- *Calculated time is rounded to next half or full minute for all distances of less than 1 hour racing time*
- *Calculated time is rounded to next minute for all distances of more than 1 hour racing time*
- *Time of calculation is < 1 second*
- *Maximal allowed distance is a Marathon*
- *Shortest allowed distance is 1km*

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Build Experiments Into the Process

Customer testing

TITLE: Flash Design Experiment



https://www.scrum.org/resources/psu-support-nordstrom-video

A/B Testing

TITLE: Upfront Postage increases Sale

Determine if showing the postage for each preselected catalog item increases sales compared to only showing the total postage on the order confirmation page.

Technical Spike

TITLE: Does library XYZ meet our needs

Implement library XYZ as a proof of concept to see if it:

- has Right data precision
- it meets our performance requirements
- is threadsafe

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Differentiating DOD, Sprint Goal, Acceptance Criteria

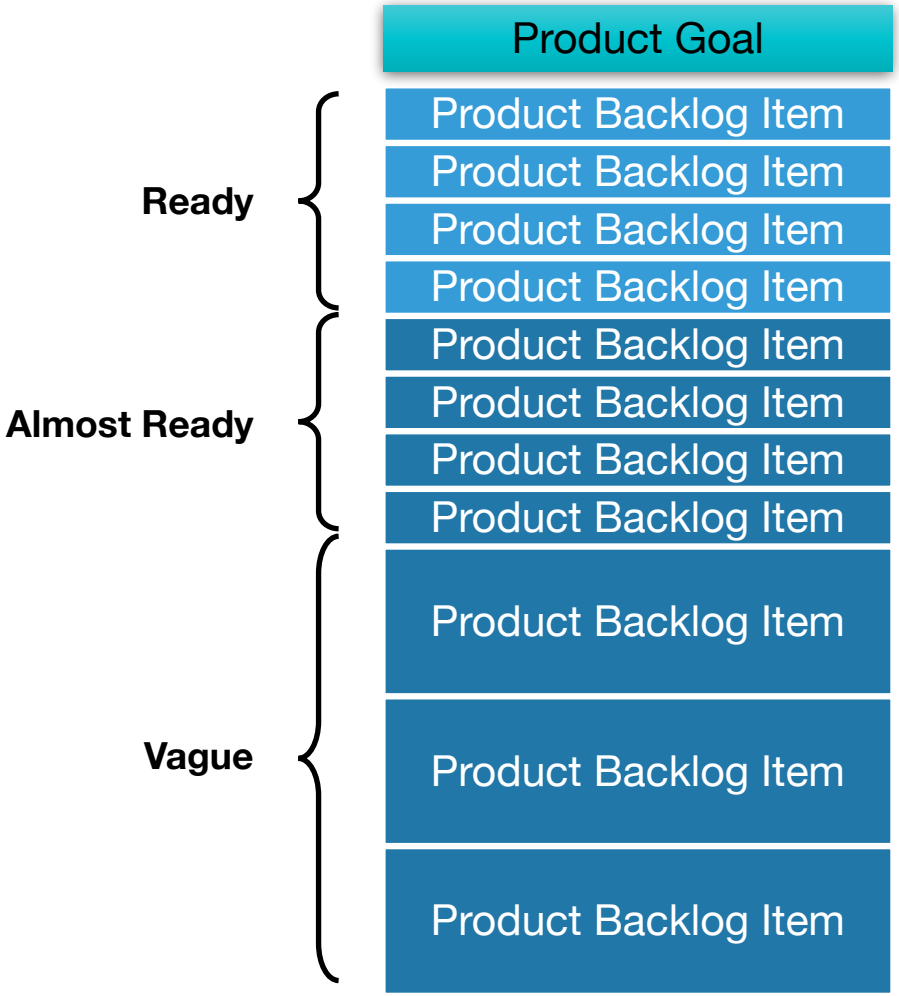
5 minutes

Connect the statements to the agile practices

Increase product responsiveness	Definition of Done
Complies with legislation on drug interactions	Definition of Done
Documentation is updated	Definition of Done
Data collection is set up to support validations	Sprint Goal
Works with keyboard and gamepad	Sprint Goal
Accepts Visa, Mastercard, American Express	Acceptance Criteria
Use UK English on screens	Acceptance Criteria
Should use hamburger menu style on iPhone	Sprint Goal
Address debit card overdrafts	Acceptance Criteria
Increase capacity to 100K customers	Sprint Goal
Use latest Yuan to Euro conversion algorithm	Definition of Done
User Acceptance Test instructions are updated	Definition of Done
Reviewed by the stakeholders	Acceptance Criteria
No unreachable components	Acceptance Criteria

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Refining the Product Backlog



- Product Backlog is continuously refined to increase understanding, granularity and transparency.
- Larger Product Backlog Items are broken down into consumable pieces of value.
- Product Backlog Items that can be Done by the Scrum Team within one Sprint are deemed ready for selection in a Sprint Planning event.

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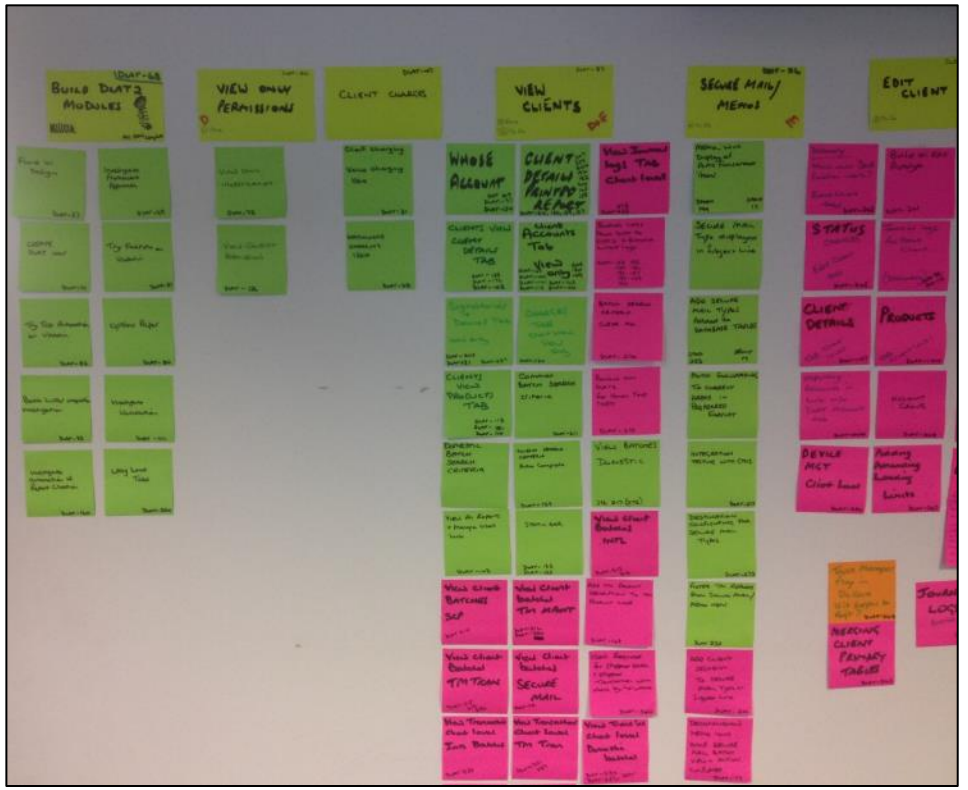
Story Mapping

Product Backlogs are one-dimensional

- This makes it difficult to see the workflow, relationships, and dependencies

Story maps help visualize and plan upcoming work

- They foster collaboration by providing a different perspective



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Create a Product Backlog

15 minutes

Create a preliminary Product Backlog for your team's Product.

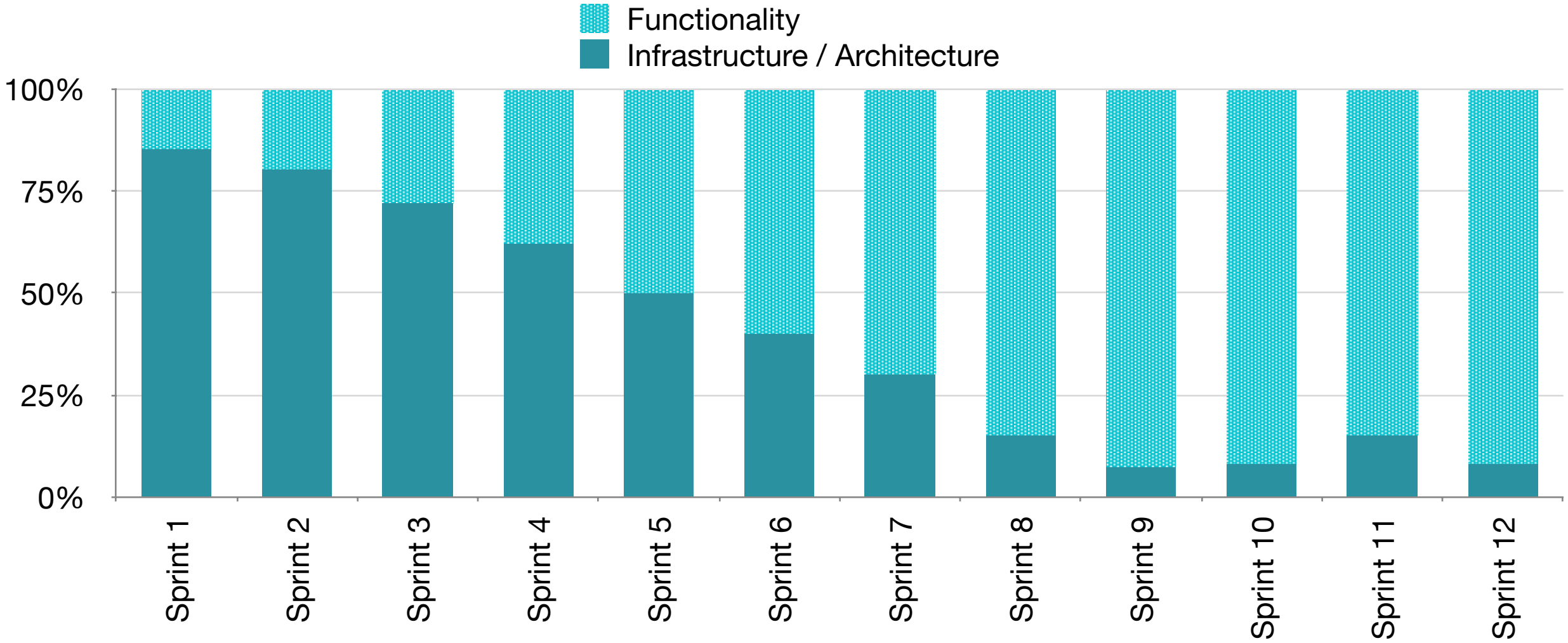
- What is your Product Goal?
- Create a card for each Product Backlog Item
- Consider both functional and non-functional capabilities

Prepare to present your Product Backlog to the class.

Do not strive for perfection, just do the best you can!

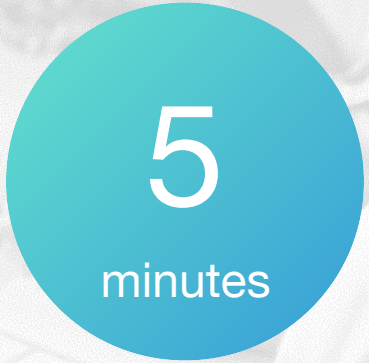
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Product Backlog Supports Emergent Architecture Development



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How Do You Prioritize Work?



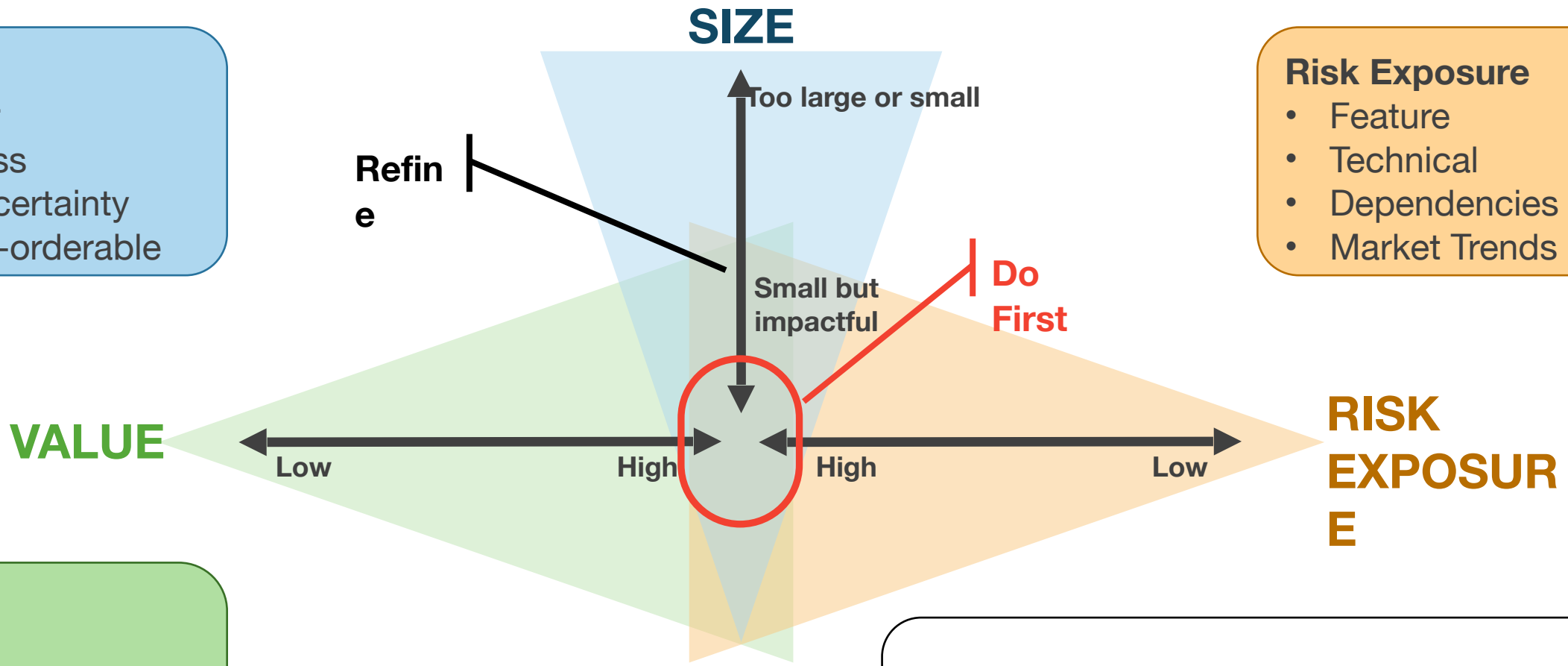
Why is it important that the Product Backlog is always ordered?

- Discuss in your team how your company or product area prioritizes work?
- How do you resolve conflicts that occur when people think their “stuff” is more important than other people’s “stuff”?
- Do you quantify the results?
- How do you handle dependencies?

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Product Backlog Order Influenced by Many Factors

Size
- Smaller
  - Less uncertainty
  - Re-orderable



Risk Exposure
- Feature
- Technical
- Dependencies
- Market Trends

Value
- ROI
- Existing Customers
- Prospects
- Cost of Delay
- Discovery

$$\frac{\text{Value} + \text{Risk Exposure}}{\text{Size}} \approx \text{Order Rank}$$

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Techniques for Product Backlog Ordering & Value



Business Value Poker (aka Planning Poker)

Assign relative value points (instead of size)

Buy a Feature

Innovation Game using money

20/20 Vision

Innovation Game for simple ordering

Thirty Five

Collaboration activity for ordering

RICE Score

Simple technique to quickly assess priorities

Have you used any others?

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Product Backlog Ordering



10 minutes

Order your Product Backlog:

1. Select a technique for ordering by Value
2. Add value to each PBI card
3. Sort PBI cards

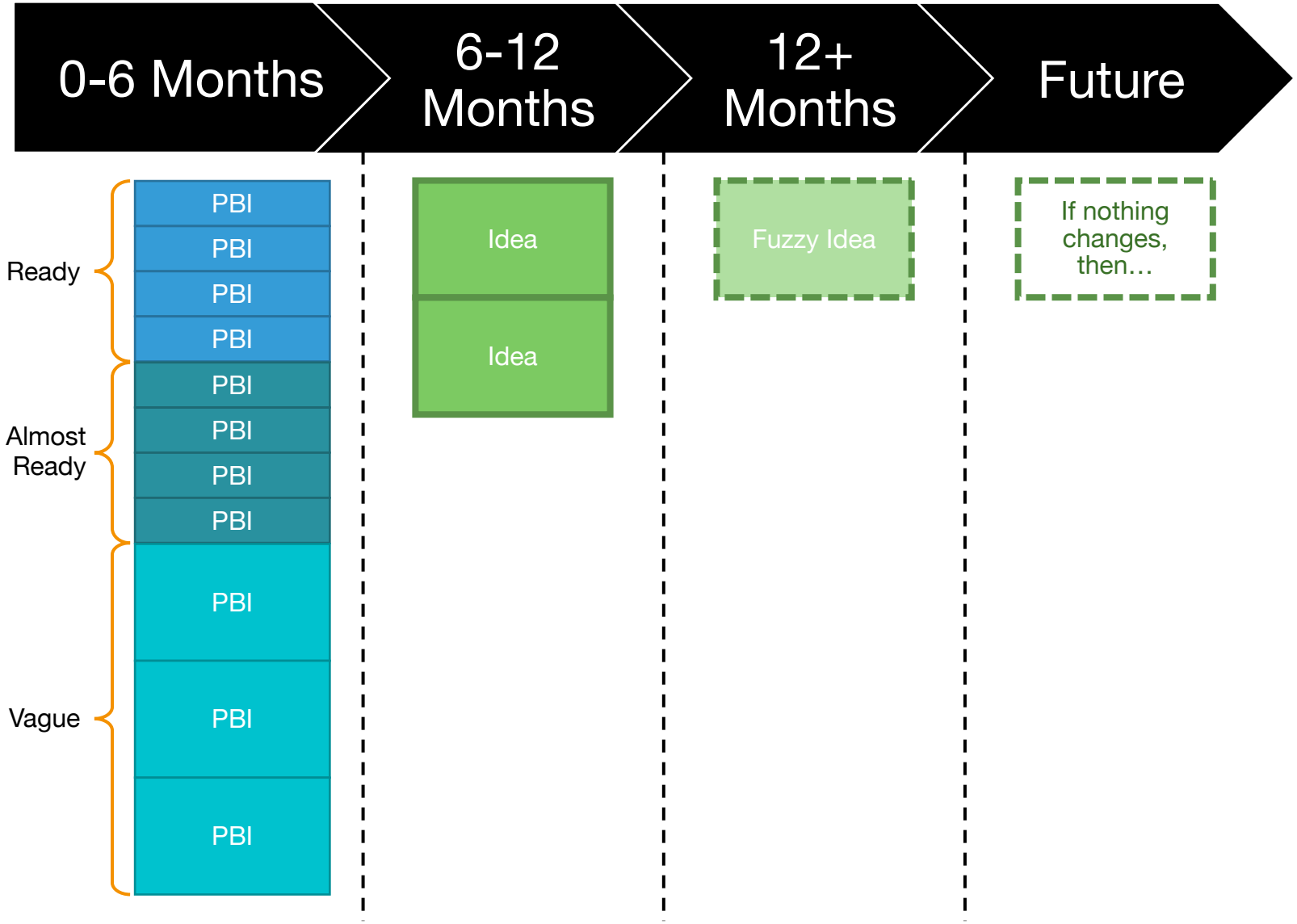
Prepare to present your Product Backlog to the class.

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Use Product Backlog to Create a Quick Roadmap



Roadmaps help align with key stakeholders

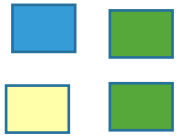
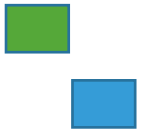
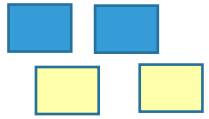
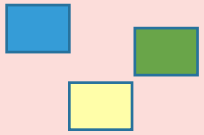
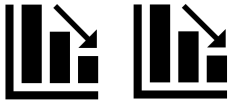
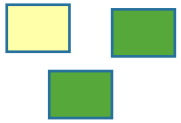
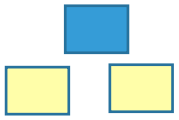
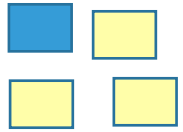
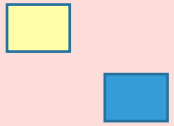


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Make Value & Validation of PBIs Transparent

Product Goal: (this is where the product goal would be communicated)

Current Sprint	Sprint + 1	Sprint +2 - 5	Next Release	By End of Year	Not considered	Value Proposition	Validation (Metrics)
							
							NONE
							
							
						NONE	

 = high value PBI  = medium value PBI  = low value PBI  = area of concern

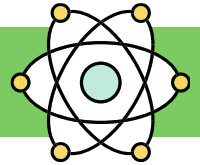
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Product Backlog Management Recommendations



TRY

- Delegating the detailing of PBIs, and/or refining PBIs in multiple rounds, with various audiences
- Deleting PBIs that haven't been touched in the past 9-12 months
- Resolving dependency root causes



FAVOR

- Seeing "Problems to solve" over "Solutions to implement" narrative
- Having Developers assist in ordering the product backlog
- Using tools from this class, help others see the reasons for the Product Backlog order
- Considering more than just value when ordering the product backlog



AVOID

- Making PBIs tasks or component layers
- Using one complementary practice for everything (e.g., User Story)
- Thinking success is completing a full feature
- Having a separate "backlog" for defects, architecture, or other non-functional work

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TAKE AWAY

Product Backlog Management

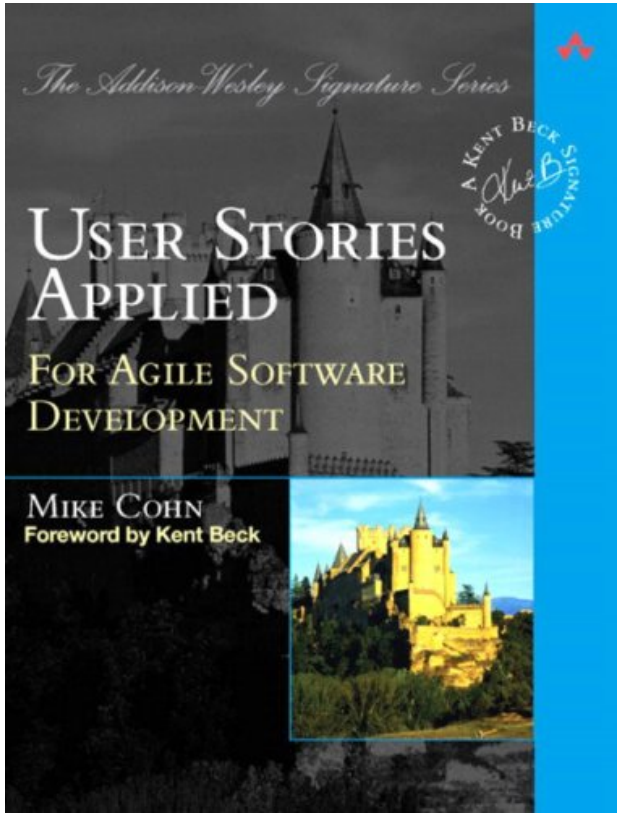
- Product Backlog holds all the work for the Product.
- Product Backlog gives transparency.
- Product Backlog is a living artifact.
- There are many techniques beyond Scrum to help create and order Product Backlogs.



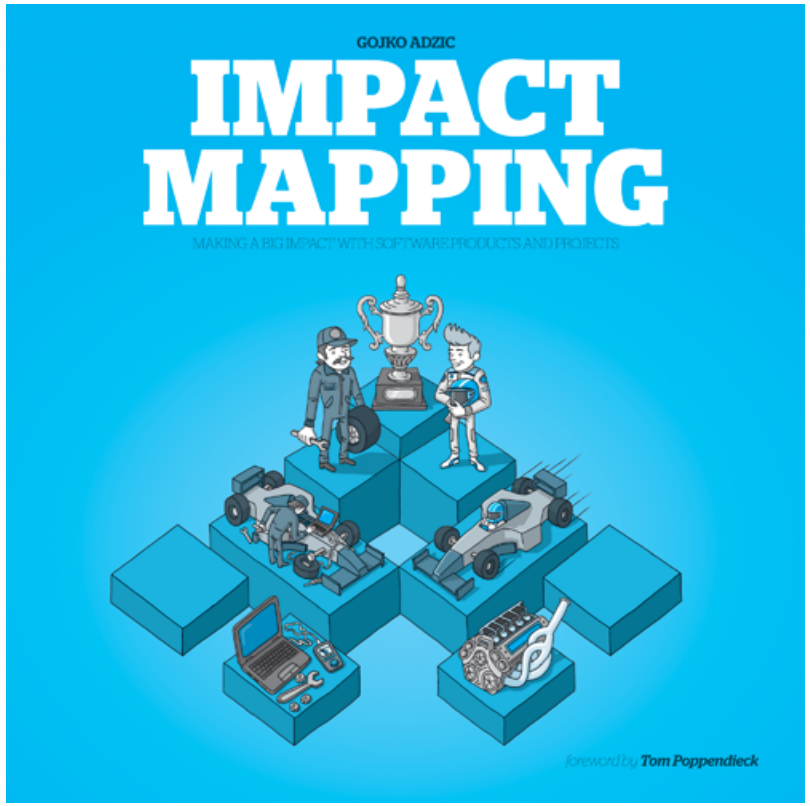
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Suggested Reading

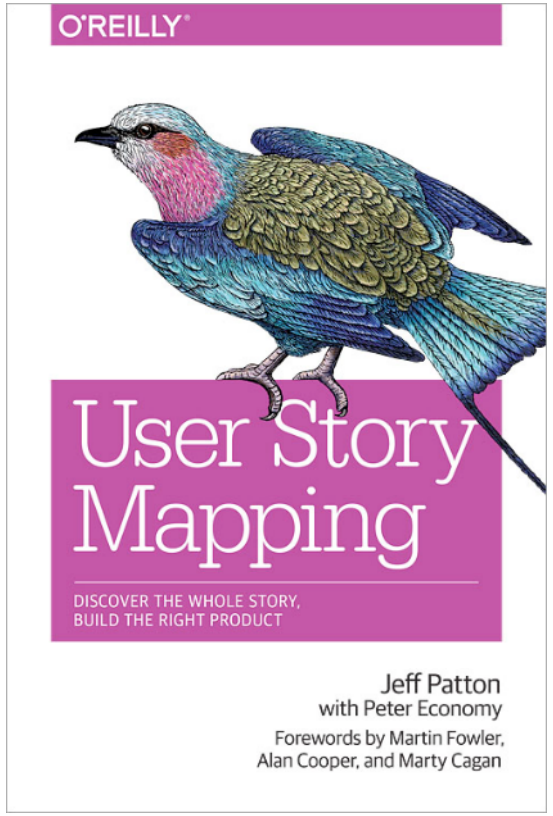
“User Stories Applied”
(Mike Cohn)



“Impact Mapping”
(Gojko Adzic)



“User Story Mapping”
(Jeff Patton)



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“The most reliable form of self-marketing is to have a long history of stunningly great work, shipped.”

- Seth Godin



7

Releases & Forecasting

Release

5 minutes

Release

- Definition of a Release
- Why do we want them?

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Not All Releases are of Equal Desirability …



Customer Desires	• A value that the customer is very passionate and excited about
Market Opportunity	• Changes that take advantage of an opportunity to gain market share or grow the market
Required Release	• Made to comply with a legal requirement
Commitments	• Meets agreement to deliver specific functionality to a customer, prospect, or partner
Competitive Response	• Changes to ensure offering matches or exceeds competitors' capabilities
Major Release	• Commitment to the market to release new features and/or fixes, driven by a certain schedule
Maintenance	• Correction of defects

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Release Strategies

MAJOR



- Many large changes
- Infrequent (often aligns with organization timelines)
- Freezes other work
- High customer absorption costs
- High business risk

MINOR



- Broad changes
- Pre-scheduled (often aligns with Sprint boundaries)
- Often not cohesive
- Often bug fixes and patches
- Less business risk

FUNCTIONAL



- Individual functionality
- Continuous delivery (often during a Sprint, even daily)
- Immediate value
- Low customer absorption costs
- Minimal/no business risk

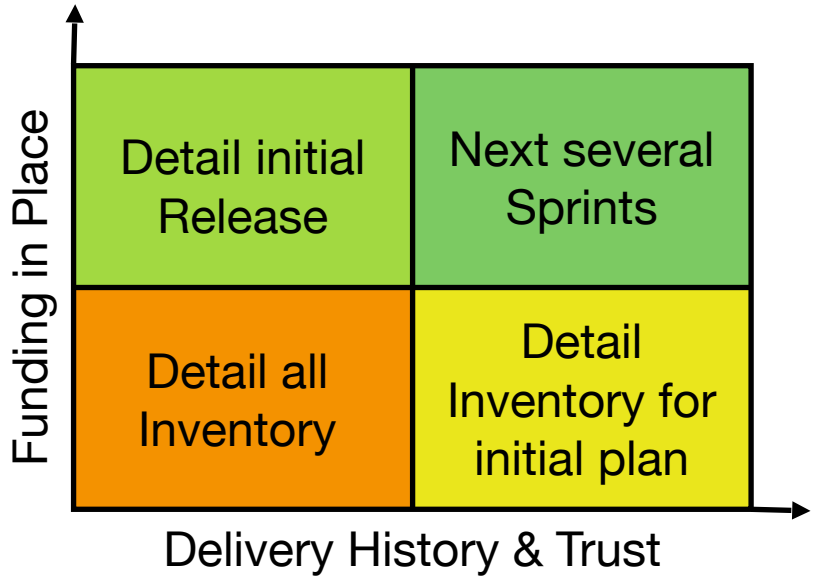
Different release processes involve different investment into testing

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Build Plan as Needed

Minimizing Inventory

Already funded, underway initiative	• Trust and history exist • Detail inventory for next several Sprints
Unfunded, new initiative with history	• Trust and history exist • Detail inventory to level needed to estimate based on history
Unfunded, new initiative without history	• Trust has not been built • Detail inventory to level of reasonable likelihood of meeting initial plan
Unfunded, new initiative with distrust	• Distrust exists • Detail all inventory and build trust during initiative



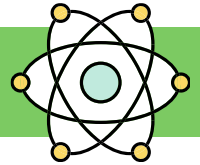
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Releases Recommendations



TRY

- Considering a release an experiment and validation (possibly with feature flags)
- Adopting a flow-based approach to releases and cadence
- Plan follow up of a release to validate the value



FAVOR

- Releasing inspectable product increments frequent
- Explicitly communicating a customer centered reason for the release
- Using technology and practices to help release early and often
- Decoupling releases from Scrum cadence



AVOID

- Assuming your customers can adopt continuously
- Planning too far ahead
- Not having a goal for your release
- Using upfront release plans with fixed scope **and** fixed date
- Not answering questions around delivery

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Size and Estimation

Many teams spend time estimating size or effort of work, for example to create a release plan or schedule.

Connect to the topic of Size and Estimation

2 minutes

Does your team estimate?

Why? What value are you seeking from it?

Should teams always do estimations?

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Let's talk about size and estimation

Absolute Estimation

- Traditional, time or effort based
- Least useful for complex work
- Examples are Gantt charts & Function point analysis

Relative Estimation

- Easy to get started with
- Allows for uncertainty and discussion
- Examples include Story Points, T-shirt sizing and Same-sizing

Flow Metrics

- Easiest to use
- Data-driven
- Value focused
- Uses throughput and rightsizing

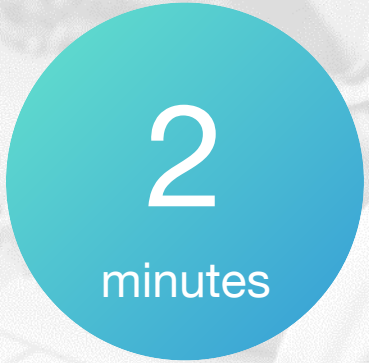
Many sizing and estimation techniques can be used. Work with the Scrum Team to select a technique that would work best in your environment.

For more o this topic



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When Will It Be Done?



The management committee wants to know when your product will be done.

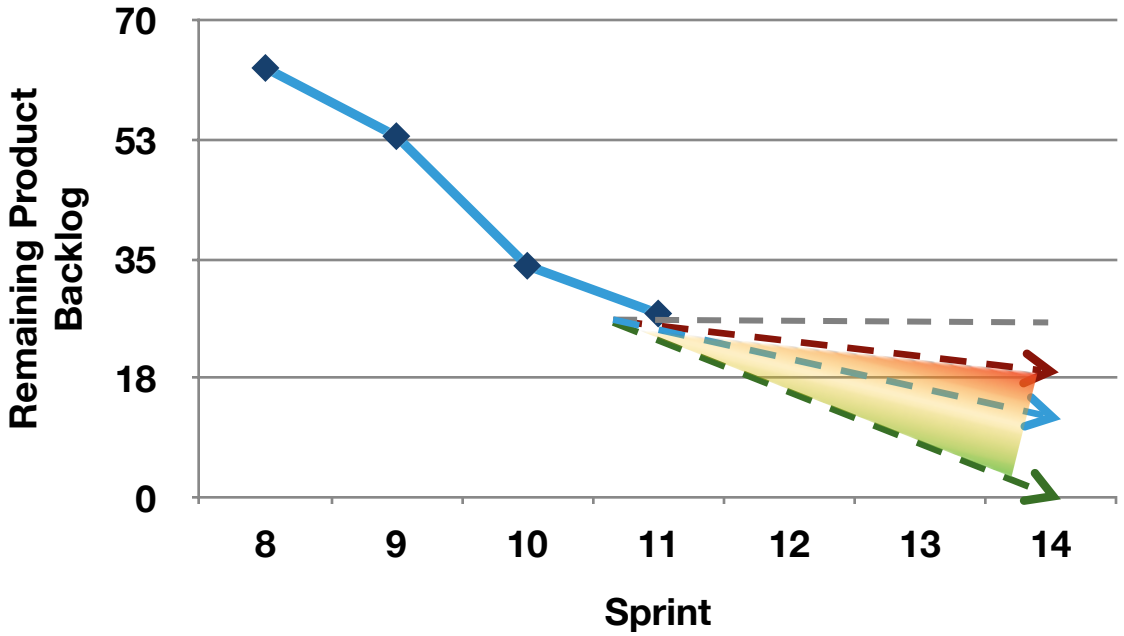
- **What do you say?**
- **How would you proceed?**

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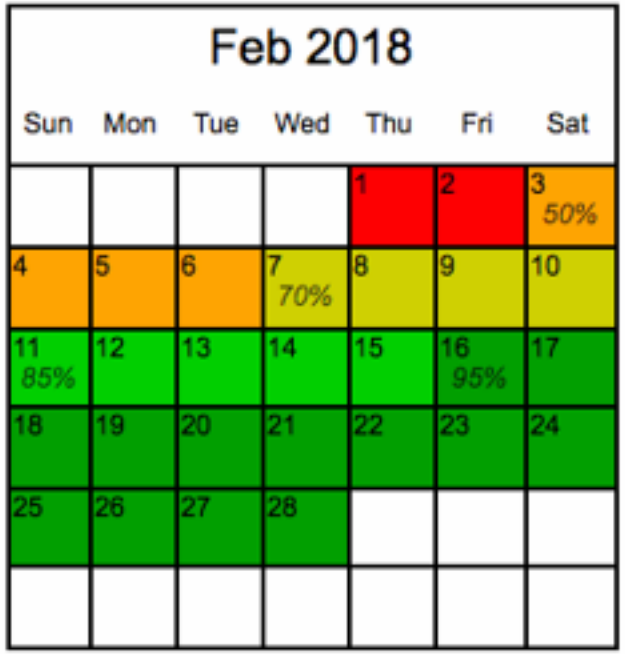
A Product Owner Should Be Able to Measure Progress Against Goals

Different ways for visualizing progress can be used. Some are better than others.
Consider forecasting the number of items, story points, or other techniques.

Cone of Uncertainty
(Release burndown chart)



Probabilistic Forecasting



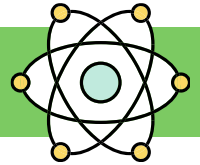
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Forecasting Towards Stakeholders



TRY

- Setting an achievable, valuable Product Goal and Sprint Goals per Sprint that don't depend on meeting the velocity.
- Using a bandwidth when doing forecasting (instead of using averages).
- Using visualization techniques (e.g., burn-up or burn-down charts).



FAVOR

- Talking to stakeholders about the goals to be achieved, and the value to be delivered (instead of the work to be done).
- Visualizing and defining your workflow around delivering valuable work, using both Flow and Outcome metrics
- Communicating in degrees of certainty with Stakeholders



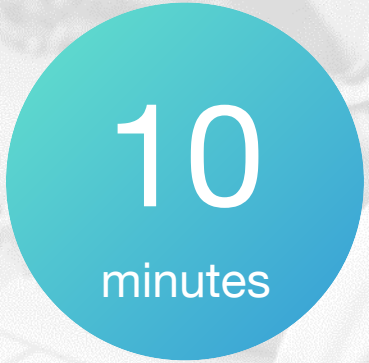
AVOID

- Treating Velocity as a stable, predictable measure of progress.
- Using averages for forecasting.
- Adding-up all the work in the Product Backlog and dividing it by the (average) velocity.
- Talking only about deadlines and delivery dates of work.
- Treating a forecast like a promise or commitment. (It is what it is, a forecast).

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Exercise

Product Owner Choices



Your friend Judi the CEO is joining the Sprint Review with David's Scrum Team. She asks David (the Product Owner) when an important compliance feature will ship. She expresses how critical this feature is to the company and its customers, and how she requires it within 6 weeks.

On average, a feature like this is decomposed into 12 Product Backlog items (PBIs). The Developers forecast that they can complete around 3-5 PBIs per two-week Sprint.

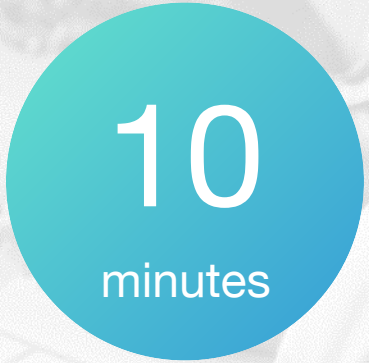
If you were in David's shoes, what would you do?

How would you respond to Judi?

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Product Owner Choices



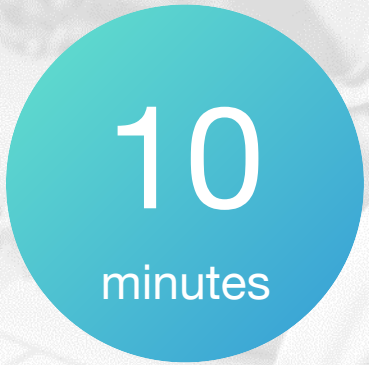
David, the Product Owner of the community portal, has an option of gaining speed (Time-to-Market) in order to validate his assumptions with real customers. Gaining this speed requires the Developers to take temporary shortcuts. The Developers explain that this might result in incurring technical debt for the product (impacting Ability-to-Innovate).

David asks you for your feedback and ideas on this matter.

What would you recommend David to do?

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Product Owner Choices



The Developers keep asking you (the Product Owner) for more details on the requirements, like acceptance criteria and detailed descriptions.

You are now in the Sprint Planning and the Developers refuse to pull any work into the Sprint. They point you to a "Definition of Ready" they created, and they explain how you should spend more time detailing the requirements.

What would you do?

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Exercise

Product Owner Choices

10 minutes

Larry (the product manager) has rebuilt an old legacy system. However, this approach resulted in some major issues. Customer experience is terrible, and the platform's users are complaining all the time.

Larry therefore decided to completely overhaul the platform's digital experience and has hired an external company specialized in this field of work.

You are the internal Product Owner working with Larry on this product. The vendor's UX-experts want to work in Design Sprints, one month ahead of your Developers. The Developers completely agree.

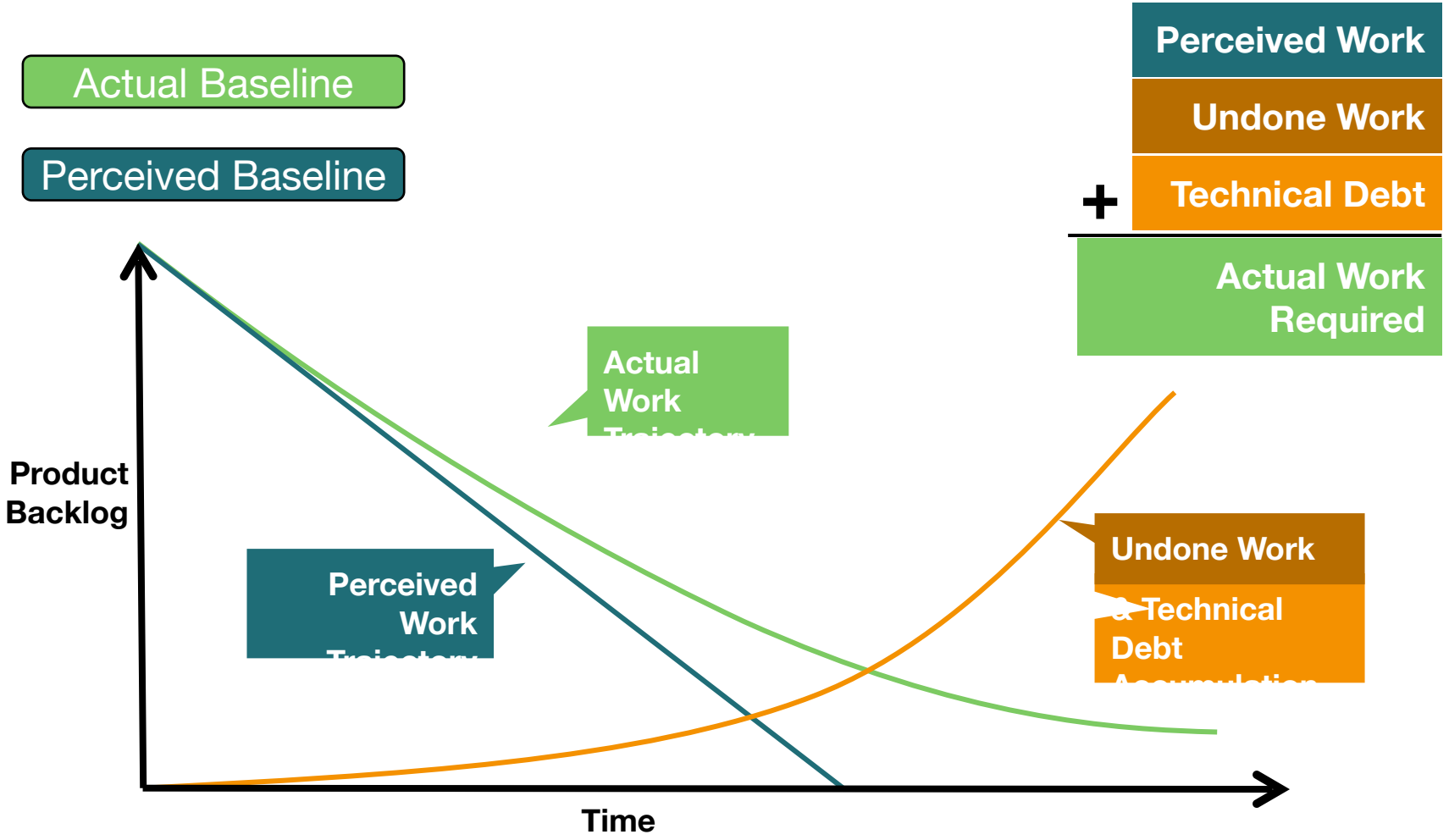
What do you think about this approach?

How does this approach impact value maximization?

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Undone Work & Technical Debt Increase the Actual Work

Remember: Undone Work & Technical Debt do not accumulate linearly



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TAKE AWAY

Releases & Forecasting

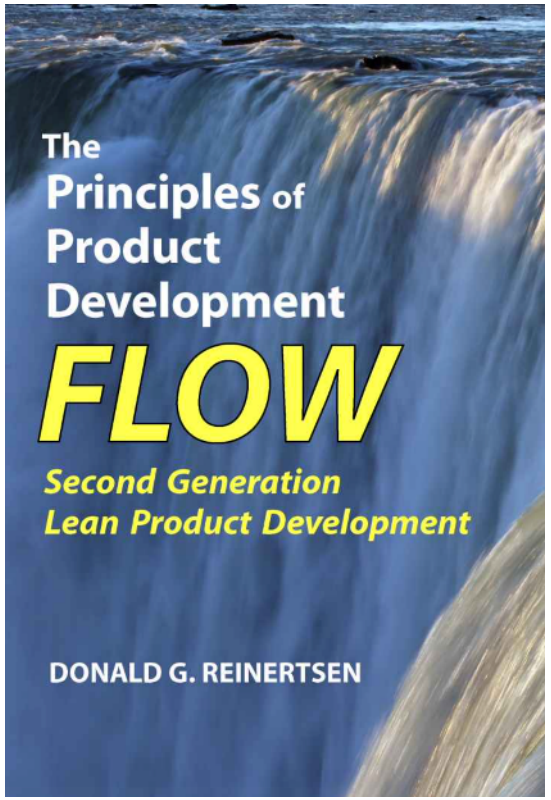
- Product Backlog holds all information needed for forecasting, planning, and reporting.
- Increasing release frequency of new features or enhancements is a competitive advantage.
- Everything in the Product Backlog is a hypothesis of value. We must validate those hypothesis through releases and effective customer/user feedback mechanisms.



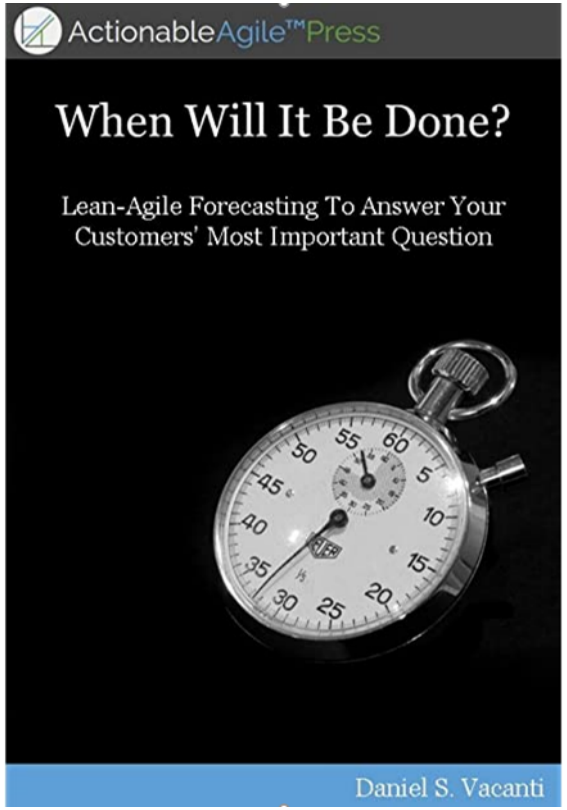
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Suggested Reading

“The Principles of Product Development Flow” (Donald Reinertsen)



“When It Will Be Done?” (Daniel Vacanti)



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"The journey of a thousand miles begins with a single step"

- Lao Tzu

8

Closing

Exercise

Product Owner Skills

10 minutes

List the skills and traits a Product Owner needs to be effective and successful.

SKILLS	TRAITS

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Measuring the Success of a Product Owner



- Poor quality and/ or low value and Inconsistent delivery
- Being a requirements writer (Scribe)
- The organization does not have a shared understanding of the vision
- Dictation of product evolution
- No courage to take ownership of the product
- Perception over reality

- Reliable delivery of quality, valuable Increments
- Relentlessly customer focused (Entrepreneur)
- Product vision and Product Goal supports company vision
- Product evolves through empiricism and evidence
- Willing to take calculated risks
- Transparent

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Want to take your next steps as a PO?

- A Product Owner needs to be versatile in their approach of engaging with many different people and in many different situations.



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Three Things You Wanted to Know (Re-Visit)

- Did we cover what you absolutely wanted to know?
- Did we set some questions aside that we still need to go into?



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Inspect Your Knowledge – Feedback in 14 Days or Less!



Over the past 2 days, you have learned the importance of inspection, adaptation, and fast feedback cycles. To reinforce these concepts, if you attempt the Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) certification assessment within 14 days and do not score at least 85%, you will be granted a 2nd attempt at no further cost.



- Test your basic knowledge of Scrum and learn from immediate feedback by taking an Open assessment: www.scrum.org/assessments/open-assessments
- Use the Open assessments to prepare for Level I assessments

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Professional Scrum Competencies

www.scrum.org/professional-scrum-competencies

The Professional Scrum Competencies help guide an individual's personal development with Scrum.

Benefit from a common understanding of the competencies and focus areas to evaluate and balance your team's proficiencies based on your unique needs.

See how all Scrum.org courses map to the competencies and focus areas by visiting:

www.scrum.org/courses/professional-scrum-training-competency-mapping

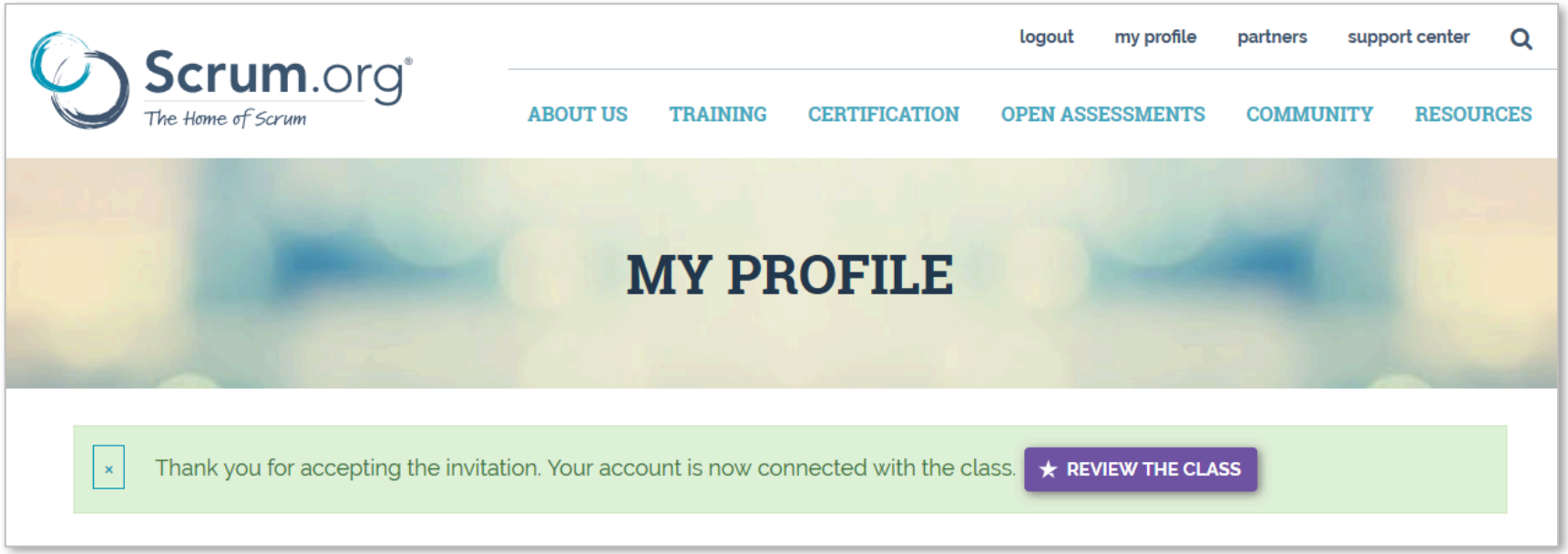


✓ The Focus Area is covered in the class
✓+ The Focus Area has deep coverage in the class

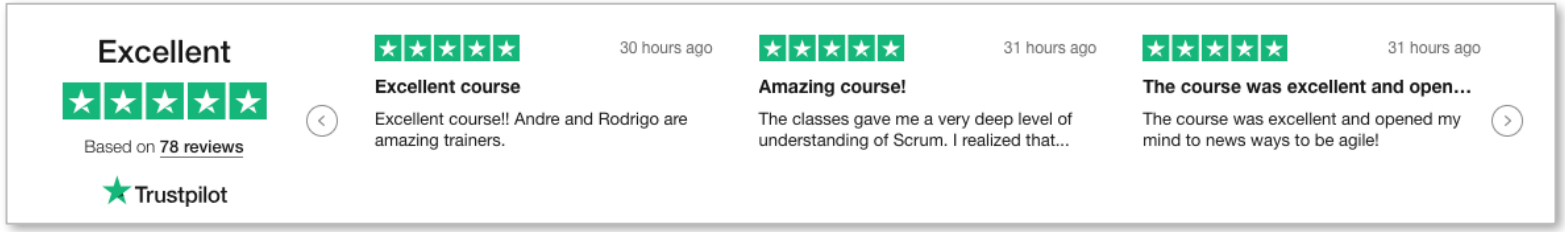
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Review Your Class Experience Using Trustpilot

Share your experience with other potential students!

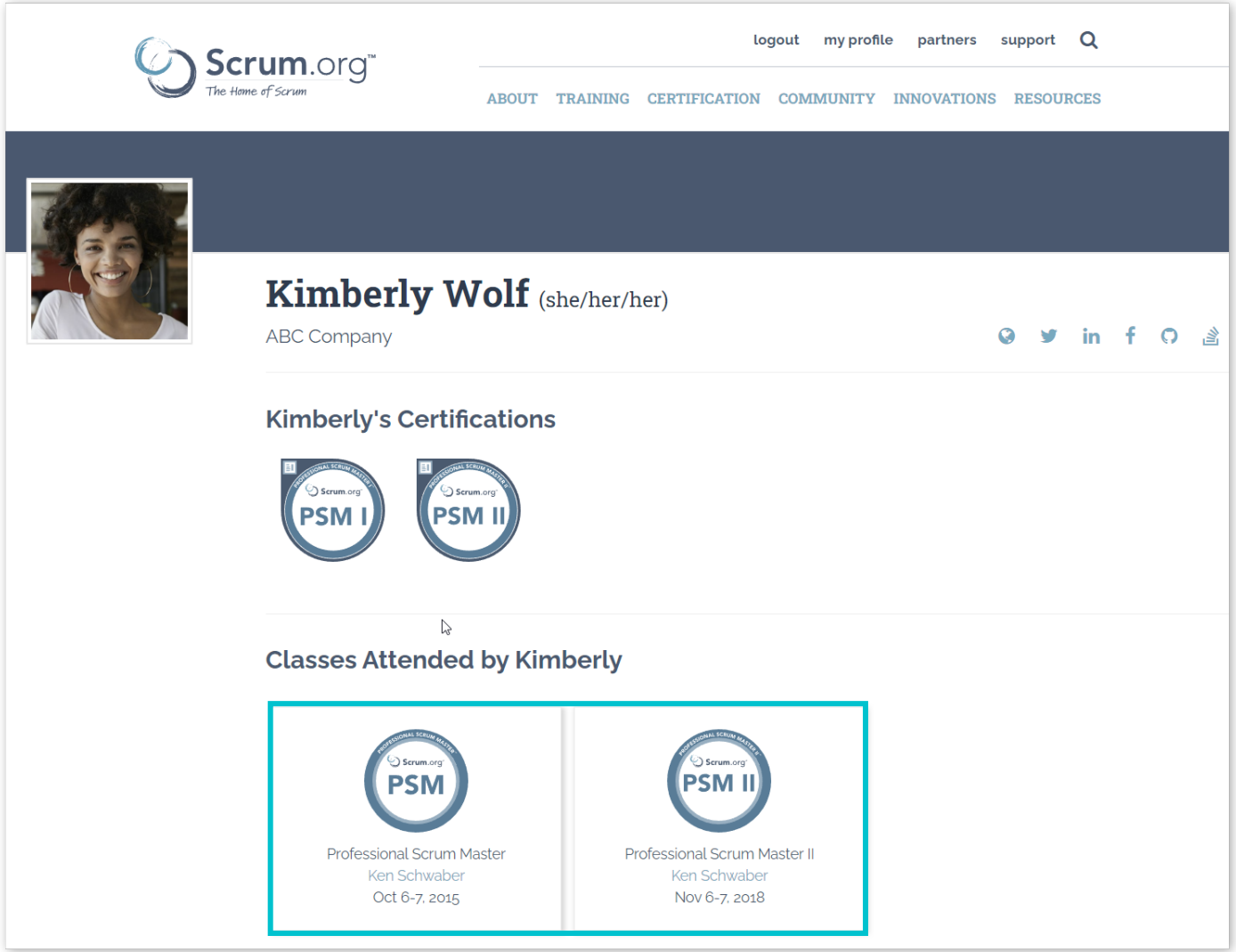


Your review will be visible on our website:



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Your Scrum.org Profile



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Feedback

Feedback is important, and we take it seriously. Your feedback helps us to continually inspect and adapt our courses.

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Thank You!



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